

Autogenous Modernity and the Liminality of Disorder (作亂) in Donghak Thought

Autogenous Modernity in the Siecheonju (侍天主) View of Heaven

The Western Formal (形相的) View of Heaven

The heliocentric theory and Calvin's predestination, which represent Western modernity, were both changes in perspective regarding the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. Because the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity are the most fundamental foundation directly connected to human existence and survival, a change like the modern era, which marks a new epoch, is measured by the change in the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity.³⁴⁰

Although the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity were the main terms for dividing the universe in the Eastern cosmological view represented by the 'Cheon-Ji-In Samjae' (Three Potentials of Heaven, Earth, Humanity), in Western thought, which shares a common origin in religions related to Northern Shamanism, the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity also appeared as a trifunctional system.³⁴¹ The views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity have been the foundational concepts for dividing the universe in the West since the age of myth.³⁴² Accordingly, the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity can be a concept for comparing Eastern and Western thought.³⁴³

That the 'Cheon-Ji-In Samjae' can be called a foundational concept in Western thought is also shown by the fact that the cosmology of Platonic philosophy, which became the root of Western philosophy, is also composed of three dimensions like 'Cheon-Ji-In': the cosmos, God, and human. As is well known, Plato explained that the visible universe is a reflection of the invisible world of Ideas. In this, the invisible world of Ideas corresponds to the East's Heaven (Cheon), the visible world corresponds to the East's Earth (Ji), and the observing being corresponds to the Human (In).³⁴⁴

As Whitehead's saying that "Western philosophy is footnotes to Plato" has long been repeated, the influence of Platonic philosophy on Western thought was significant. Plato's thought was transformed by

³⁴⁰ Lee Jeong-u, *Segyecheolhaksa 3: Geundaeseong-ui Kareutogeulrapi* (A World History of Philosophy, Vol. 3: Cartography of Modernity), Seoul: Gil, 2021, pp.164-165.

³⁴¹ Lee Do-heum, "Talhyeondae sasangeuro-seo dongyang cheolhak-ui ganeungseong-gwa hangye" [The Possibilities and Limits of Eastern Philosophy as Post-modern Thought], *Donghak Hakbo* [Journal of Donghak Studies] 10, 2005, p.9.

³⁴² Charles Harrison, *Modeonijeum* (Modernism), Paju: Yeolhwadang, 2003, p.6.

³⁴³ Weber's argument on modernity is said to be summarized in the famous "Author's Preface" of *Gesammelte Aufsätze zur Religionssoziologie* (Collected Essays in the Sociology of Religion). Cited in Kim Sang-jun, *Maengja-ui ttam Seongwang-ui pi: Jungcheung Geundae-wa Dong-asia Yugyo Munmyeong* (The Sweat of Mencius, the Blood of Sage-Kings: Multilayered Modernity and East Asian Confucian Civilization), Seoul: Acanet, 2011, p.52; Max Weber, translated by Kim Deok-yeong, *Peulloteseutanteu Yunri-wa Jabonjuui Jeongsin* (The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism), Seoul: Gil, 2010, pp.11-38.

³⁴⁴ Vincent Descombes, translated by Park Seong-chang, *The Same and the Other: Modern French Philosophy (1933-1978)*, Seoul: Ingansarang, 1991.

his disciple Aristotle to be more suitable for explaining reality; Aristotle explained Ideas as 'form' and the earth as 'matter.' To Aristotle, the universe, appearing in the form of a formal Heaven and a material Earth, manifested as a world where the form of Heaven transformed the Earth as matter. The human is regarded as a being that helps the form of Heaven manifest on Earth.³⁴⁵

The Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, starting from Aristotle, can be called ontological because they presuppose substance when explaining change. Ontology and 'generativism' (Saengseong-ron) are the major thought systems distinguishing East and West today. In the system of Eastern thought, which thinks from the whole to the part, from top to bottom, a generative thought system is formed where change is explained without substance; whereas in the system of Western thought, which expands from the part to the whole, it becomes an ontological thought system that explains change starting from the part as substance.³⁴⁶

Francois Jullien, who applied Deleuze's theory of immanence to Eastern thought, also regards the West, which explains change through substance, as ontological, and the East, which explains through attributes, as generative. Typically, in the case of medicine, Eastern medicine targets living people, so its anatomical charts are poor, while the West targets dead people, so its anatomical charts are detailed. Viewed from the standpoint of Western ontology, which is represented by substance theory, atomism which represents the modern West, the monotheistic God which represented the medieval West, and Plato's Ideas which represented the ancient West, can all be called a formalistic (Hyeongsang-jeok, form, eidos) view of Heaven (Cheon-gwan) as substance. In the ontological views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, the substance of change was posited as God in the past, but upon reaching the modern era which denies God, change came to be explained only by matter, without God.

Aristotle's substance theory is an ontological theory that states the process of change must be explained by substance to be a logical explanation. For example, for water to change into fire, Aristotle's theory requires a substance with the property of changing water into fire, otherwise, it is not a logical discipline. On the other hand, the fractal correlative principle of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements can change without any substance.³⁴⁷

The substantial cause of this change is the four causes, and the matter that causes change is the four elements. Aristotle is said to have claimed that the universe is composed of the four elements: earth, water, fire, and air (wind). By the same principle, the universe is said to be composed of the four causes: formal

³⁴⁵ Lee Jeong-u, *Segyecheolhaksa 3: Geundaeseong-ui Kareutogeulrapi* (A World History of Philosophy, Vol. 3: Cartography of Modernity), Seoul: Gil, 2021, pp.164-165.

³⁴⁶ Lee Jeong-u, *Segyecheolhaksa 3: Geundaeseong-ui Kareutogeulrapi* (A World History of Philosophy, Vol. 3: Cartography of Modernity), Seoul: Gil, 2021; Lee Jeong-u, *Segyecheolhaksa 4: Talgeundae Sayu-ui Jipyongdeul* (A World History of Philosophy, Vol. 4: Horizons of Post-modern Thought), Seoul: Gil, 2024.

³⁴⁷ Alan Sokal and Jean Bricmont, translated by Lee Hui-jac, Jijeok Sagi: *Poseuteumodeon Sasangadeul-eun Gwahak-eul Eotteoke Namyonghaetneunga* (Fashionable Nonsense: Postmodern Intellectuals' Abuse of Science), Seoul: Hanguk Gyeongje Sinmun Hankyung BP, 2014.

cause, final cause, efficient cause, and material cause. Among the four causes, the material cause and formal cause that constitute things are immanent in the things, but the efficient cause and final cause, which move things and realize their purpose, exist outside the things.³⁴⁸ The difference between the Eastern Yin-Yang and Five Elements theory and the Western four causes theory and four elements theory lay in explaining change through substance.³⁴⁹

If the purpose and action where form and matter combine are the four causes by which substance is formed, then the differentiation of matter constitutes the four great elements (earth, water, fire, air). When interpreting the four-element theory as a cycle, the four elements become the four phases of the cycle: convergence (water) - compression and explosion (earth) - expansion (fire) - inflation (air). Aristotle further substantiated the theory of earth, water, fire, and air that existed before Empedocles. Dumézil is said to have argued that in the anthropological structure of the Indo-European linguistic imaginary, characterized by ascent and descent, the substantialist cosmology was formulated as the four-element theory, with the ascent of fire and air, and the descent of earth and water.³⁵⁰

The four causes theory was considered the most rational Western theory for explaining the universe until the 17th century when Matteo Ricci lived. Therefore, in the Western formal view of Heaven, Plato's Idea or the Christian monotheistic God, as the fifth element separate from earth, water, fire, and air, becomes the center of the view of Heaven. Unlike in the East, the Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which has clear boundaries, establishes a mode of liminality through the substance of the fifth element rather than through immanent liminality.

Aristotle's four causes theory was used by Matteo Ricci in *The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven* (Tianzhu Shiyi) as the basis for arguing that the cosmology of earth, water, fire, and air was more scientific than the cosmology of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. Matteo Ricci proves the existence of the Lord of Heaven (Tian-zhu) using Aristotle's 'four causes theory'. *The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven* is a summary of *Western Learning* (Seohak) written by Ricci; it was the first such work written in the East and subsequently had a significant influence on Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought. The two systems of thought appear similar, but there was a difference in that Yin-Yang and the Five Elements explain change through attributes, whereas earth, water, fire, and air explain it through substance, and this difference led to significant disparities in Eastern and Western modernity. In the West, as seen in medieval architecture and art, the attributes of God also manifest as the four attributes of earth, water, fire, and air.³⁵¹

³⁴⁸ Jeong Il-gwon, René Girard in Dialogue with Modern Thinkers: Mimetic Theory, Post-structuralism, and Deconstructive Philosophy, Seoul: Dongyeon, 2017.

³⁴⁹ Post-structuralism is a second-generation structuralism that regards the possibility of structural change more flexibly. Representative theorists in the broad category include Lacan, Foucault, and Derrida.

³⁵⁰ Lee Do-heum, "Talhyeondae sasangeuro-seo dongyang cheolhak-ui ganeungseong-gwa hangye" [The Possibilities and Limits of Eastern Philosophy as Post-modern Thought], *Donghak Hakbo* [Journal of Donghak Studies] 10, 2005, p.11.

³⁵¹ Eisenstadt, Shmuel N. and Schluchter, Wolfgang, "Introduction: Paths to Early Modernities: A Comparative View", *Daedalus* 127(3), 1998. pp.1-18, and others including Eisenstadt(2002), Eisenstadt, Riedel, Sachsenmaier(2002),

It can be said that the four-element theory and the four causes theory are closely related. In India, which also had a worldview based on earth, water, fire, and air, a logic similar to the four causes theory developed, and it can be said that the process of explaining the change of the four elements directly connects to the four causes theory.

Today, most Easterners prefer the traditional Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which does not recognize spiritual beings (Sinmyeong), as a scientific worldview. However, based on the Eastern view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, the Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity that does not recognize spiritual beings also becomes a view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity established under specific assumptions. The Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity can be called an ontological view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, having the background of ontology, which explains change through substance.

In summary, the Western ontological view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is represented by the worldview of earth, water, fire, and air, starting from Aristotle. In the Western case of observing things from bottom to top, substance is divided into essence and phenomenon; therefore, phenomenon is the essence (form) changing the phenomenon (matter) as substance. In contrast, generation (saengseong) does not presuppose substance, so the East does not distinguish between phenomenon and essence; rather, phenomenon and essence are unified as one, like in Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, and change is explained monistically.

The Eastern Assimilative (同化的) View of Heaven

Traditionally, the Eastern concept of "Cheon" (Heaven) had two meanings: the "Cheon" concept that corresponds to Cheonji (Heaven and Earth) as a pair, and the Cheon of Mugeuk (Limitlessness) and Taegeuk (Great Ultimate) that existed before the division into "Cheonji," which gave birth to Heaven and Earth—in other words, the Heaven above Heaven, Cheon-oe-cheon. This is similar to how in the West, Adam before splitting into Adam and Eve is split into Eve, and even after splitting, is still called by the same name, Adam. Accordingly, in the Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven-Earth-Human) concept, if Cheon is posited as Cheon-oe-cheon outside of Heaven and Earth, then Ji (Earth) becomes the Heaven and Earth created by Cheon-oe-cheon; and if the Cheon that is part of the Heaven-Earth pair is taken as Cheon, then Ji also becomes the Ji concept that is part of the Heaven-Earth pair. This ambiguous use of the Cheon concept is also a reason why discussions of the Eastern views of Heaven and Earth are difficult and confusing. This

Wittrock(1998), Arnason(2001), Kaya(2004), Hung(2004). Cited in Shmuel N. Eisenstadt, translated by Im Hyeon-jin [et al.], *Damunjeok Geundaeseong-ui Tamgu: Bigyo Munmyeongjeok Gwanjeom* (Comparative Civilizations and Multiple Modernities), Paju: Nanam, 2009; Kim Sang-jun, *Maengja-ui ttam Seongwang-ui pi: Jungcheung Geundae-wa Dong-asia Yugyo Munmyeong* (The Sweat of Mencius, the Blood of Sage-Kings: Multilayered Modernity and East Asian Confucian Civilization), Seoul: Acanet, 2011, pp.35-36; S. N. Eisenstadt, *Multiple modernities*. New Brunswick, N.J.: Transaction Publishers, 2002; Johann P. Arnason, Sternberg, Yitzhak and Ben-Rafael, Eliezer, "Identity, Culture and Globalization." *The Multiplication of Modernity*. Brill. 2001; B. Wittrock, "Early modernities: Varieties and transitions." *Daedalus* 127(3), 1998; I. Kaya, "Modernity, openness, interpretation: a perspective on multiple modernities", *Social science information* 43(1), 2004; Hung, "Early modernities and contentious politics in mid-Qing China, c. 1740-1839." *International Sociology* 19(4), 2004.

article intends to specify the distinction between Cheon as Cheon-oe-cheon and Cheon as part of the Heaven-Earth pair before explaining the Cheon concept.³⁵²

This applies equally to the concept of Sin (神, Deity/Spirit). When the concept of Heaven (天) is used as the concept of Cheonoecheon that created Heaven and Earth, the Sin (Deity) signifies "Sangje" (上帝, the Supreme Ruler), and the Sin (Deity) as the subject operating Heaven and Earth within the Heaven-and-Earth created by Cheonoecheon becomes Cheonjisinmyeong (天地神明, Spirits of Heaven and Earth) or Sinmyeong (神明, Spiritual Beings). However, when distinguished from humans, both Sangje and Sinmyeong have been collectively referred to as Sin (Deity/Gods), so the concept of Sin also needs to be differentiated. In Donghak Thought, Sangje or Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) signifies the Deity of Cheonoecheon, thus it is distinguished from the concept of Sin (Deity) in existing Eastern thought, where Sin as Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings) appears frequently. Comparing with the West, the West uniformly emphasized Sin (God) mainly as the Sangje of Cheonoecheon, whereas the Eastern Cheon (Heaven) emphasized the meaning of Cheonoecheon during the Xia, Shang, and Zhou dynasties, but in Neo-Confucianism, it was almost used as the concept of Heaven as one part of Heaven-and-Earth, namely, the Principle-Heaven (理法天, Ibeopcheon).

Ibeopcheon (Principle-Heaven) is a term that emphasizes the principle-aspect (Ichi) of heaven rather than its personal aspect. This reflects the Eastern thought that because the Heaven above Heaven created Heaven and Earth according to principle (Ichi), the Heaven below Heaven moves according to laws. The Heaven below Heaven was made according to principle, so its personal attributes are relatively lacking, but because the Heaven above Heaven exists, the Principle-Heaven (Ibeopcheon) is also variable; however, in Eastern thought, the attributes of Heaven were fixed as the Principle-Heaven.

This applies not only to the concept of Sin (Deity) but also to the concept of Ji (地, Earth). When Cheon (Heaven) is used as Cheonoecheon (Heaven above Heaven), the concept of Ji (Earth) becomes the concept of "Cheon-ji" (Heaven and Earth) created by the existing Cheonoecheon; therefore, Ji at this time appears as the object and result of the action of 'Johwa' (Creation-Transformation) or 'Muwiiwha' (Spontaneous Transformation) by Cheonoecheon, and in Donghak Thought, terms like 'Johwa', 'Muwiiwha', and 'Gihwa' (Qi-transformation) become the terms signifying 'Ji (地)' corresponding to Cheonoecheon.

The ambiguous use of the concepts of Cheon (Heaven), Ji (Earth), and Sin (Deity) is similar in both the East and the West. However, the reason they are used more ambiguously in the East than in the West is that in the East, which changes through resonance (Gam-eung) unlike the substantialist West, Heaven,

³⁵² Appadurai(1996), Gilroy(1993), Ong(1999), Gaonkar ed.(2001). Cited in Kim Sang-jun, Maengja-ui ttam Seongwang-ui pi: Jungcheung Geundae-wa Dong-asia Yugyo Munmyeong (The Sweat of Mencius, the Blood of Sage-Kings: Multilayered Modernity and East Asian Confucian Civilization), Seoul: Acanet, 2011, pp.35-36; A. Appadurai, Modernity at large: Cultural dimensions of globalization. Minn.: University of Minnesota Press, 1996; P. Gilroy, The black Atlantic: Modernity and double consciousness. Harvard University Press, 1993; A. Ong, Flexible citizenship: The cultural logics of transnationality. Duke University Press, 1999.

Earth, and Deity are explained through the changes of correlative thinking. In the East, which explains based on attributes, the specific scope meant by Heaven, Earth, and Deity differs depending on the case, but their attributes are identical.

Correlative thinking corresponds to aesthetic order in Western thought, so the Eastern Cheon (Heaven), Ji (Earth), and In (Humanity) can be more clearly defined using aesthetic terms.³⁵³ Accordingly, the Eastern view of Heaven (天觀), differentiated by Yin-Yang and represented by Cheonwonjibang (Heaven is round, Earth is square) and Cheondojeok (The Way of Heaven, the Virtue of Earth), can be classified as an assimilative (同化的) view of Heaven; the view of Earth (地觀) as a condensative (凝縮的) view of Earth; and the view of Humanity (人間觀) as a grafting (接化的) view of Humanity.³⁵⁴

Assimilation (同化) is a term expressing the common attribute found in Cheonwon (Heaven's roundness) versus Jibang (Earth's squareness) and Cheondo (Heaven's Way) versus Jideok (Earth's virtue); like the 'assimilation' in 'carbon assimilation', it means making heterogeneous properties or forms identical. Assimilation forms a hierarchical relationship as heterogeneous things are integrated into one, thus exhibiting the nature of the circle (Won) of integration and the Way (Do) of order.³⁵⁵ The Eastern spiritual cultures of Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon) also exhibit the nature of assimilation: Daoism assimilates with nature, Confucianism assimilates with the inner self, and Buddhism assimilates with the Dharma (Law).³⁵⁶ The East, unlike the West which analyzes and dominates, pursued assimilation because it had an organic view of nature where nature and humans are one.

Condensation (凝縮) is a term expressing the common attribute found in Jibang (Earth's squareness) versus Cheonwon (Heaven's roundness) and Jideok (Earth's virtue) versus Cheondo (Heaven's Way); like the 'condensation' in 'water vapor condensation', it expresses the phenomenon of different elements intertwining and solidifying together. Condensation, unlike assimilation, does not change the components themselves but compresses heterogeneous beings to form a single small unity, thus, like a square (Bang), it is angular but characterized by the virtue of precision. Both condensation and assimilation aim for unity, but the direction of their force is opposite. If assimilation is a force that continuously expands outward centered on the self, condensation is a force that contracts inward. If assimilation is called Jungwha

³⁵³ Kim Sang-jun, *Maengja-ui ttam Seongwang-ui pi: Jungcheung Geundae-wa Dong-asia Yugyo Munmyeong* (The Sweat of Mencius, the Blood of Sage-Kings: Multilayered Modernity and East Asian Confucian Civilization), Seoul: Acanet, 2011, p.41.

³⁵⁴ The "Axial Age" refers to the period between 800-200 BCE when sages coincidentally appeared almost simultaneously and the world entered a civilization centered on religion; the term was first used by Karl Jaspers (1883-1969).

³⁵⁵ The development of history through the strengthening of divinity via the rearrangement of the sacred and the secular is said to be a hidden formula of development in the history of Chinese thought. (Wang Hui, translated by Park Ja-yeong, Choe Jeong-seop, Jin Seong-su et al., *Geundae Jungguk Sasang-ui Heunggi* (The Rise of Modern Chinese Thought), Paju: Dolbegae, 2024)

³⁵⁶ Kim Sang-jun, *Maengja-ui ttam Seongwang-ui pi: Jungcheung Geundae-wa Dong-asia Yugyo Munmyeong* (The Sweat of Mencius, the Blood of Sage-Kings: Multilayered Modernity and East Asian Confucian Civilization), Seoul: Acanet, 2011, pp.33-79; 172-182.

(Central Harmony), condensation is like Hoegwi (Returning). Eastern material cultures such as art, music, and martial arts sought maximum effect with minimum effort, like the beauty of empty space (Yeobaek).³⁵⁷

Grafting (接化) is a term expressing the coming together of opposing existences, such as Cheonwon (Heaven's roundness) versus Jibang (Earth's squareness) or Cheondo (Heaven's Way) versus Jideok (Earth's virtue), to blend as one; like the 'grafting' in 'Jeophwagunsaeng' (grafting and transforming all living beings), it expresses an integration where two existences meet equally and preserve their heterogeneity. If assimilation aims for the center and condensation aims for perfectionism, grafting advocates for hybridity through the harmonization of conflict (Sanggeuk). This is suitable for the human attribute, which is the fusion of Cheonwon (Heaven's roundness) and Jibang (Earth's squareness) appearing in Wonbangak (Circle-Square-Triangle), and the fusion of Cheondo (Heaven's Way) and Jideok (Earth's virtue) appearing in the virtuous person (Dodeokgunja).

At this time, the Eastern Heaven, Earth, and Humanity form a relationship identical to Lee Young-ran's definition of liminality, where ontogeny (individual development) recapitulates phylogeny (evolutionary history). Geongeongonsun (乾健坤順) means that what Heaven (Geon) decides, Earth (Gon) executes; if Geon (Heaven) is 1 and Gon (Earth) is 2, then Earth's 'Sun' (順, obedience/following) has the meaning of 1+2, incorporating Heaven's 'Geon' (健, strength); similarly, In (Humanity), which grafts Heaven and Earth, forms a relationship of 3, 1+2+3, (1+2+3)' from Heaven (1), Earth (2), and Humanity (3). In other words, condensation includes assimilation, and grafting includes assimilation, condensation, and even a third existence.³⁵⁸

Meanwhile, compared to the generative Eastern thought, the ontological Western thought corresponds to differentiation (異化) or segmentation (分化), which is the opposite of assimilation, and this corresponds to ontological order; therefore, following Aristotle's ontology, which is the cornerstone of Western ontology, the Western view of Heaven can be classified as a formal view of Heaven, the view of Earth as a material (質料) view of Earth, and the view of Humanity as a growth-theoretic (成長論的) view of Humanity.

In the Eastern generative view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which spontaneously differentiates from Mugeuk (Wuji) and Taegeuk (Taiji), the Eastern view of Heaven becomes an assimilative view of Heaven that integrates all things as one; if the Daoist view of Heaven is an assimilative view of Heaven regarding the natural world, which is Heaven's artwork, then the Confucian view of Heaven can be called an assimilative view of Heaven regarding the inner mind of humanity, which is Heaven's masterpiece (名

³⁵⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

³⁵⁸ Ulrich Beck, translated by Hong Sung-tae, Risk Society: Towards a New Modernity, Seoul: Saemulgyeol, 1997.

品). In the East, even the Buddhist view of Heaven, which is closest to ontology, can be called an assimilative ontological view of Heaven regarding the existence called Heaven.³⁵⁹

The Eastern view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity explains change through attributes, unlike the Western Samjae (Three Powers) which explains change through substance; therefore, the laws of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements are applied to the Eastern view of Heaven, just as they are to all things. Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, acting as attributes, apply not only to matter but also to Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings), so the Eastern Heaven is composed of numerous Sinmyeong to whom Yin-Yang and the Five Elements are applied.

The Eastern Sin (Deity) was not a singular concept like the Western absolute God, but a complex concept distinguished into the supreme God Sangje, the Cheonjisinmyeong (Spirits of Heaven and Earth), and ancestral spirits (Josangsin). Unlike the few angels of the West, the numerous Eastern Sinmyeong—so many that it is said there are countless Buddhas even in a speck of dust—filled the universe, operated the universe like a computer, and were beings possessing their own domains according to the laws of Yin-Yang. The Eastern Sinmyeong protected their respective domains, differentiated according to the laws of Yin-Yang, so the Eastern Sangje (Supreme Ruler), even though Sangje, could not interfere in the affairs of the Sinmyeong; thus, in the East, the existence of the supreme God was depersonalized almost to a law, reaching the point of being forgotten.³⁶⁰ In the Eastern relationship between gods and humans, Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings) were beings created by Sangje as Yin-Yang with humans, just like all other existences; and the ancestral spirits (Josangsin), which humans become after death, unlike Sinmyeong, did not participate in the operation of Heaven and Earth but were beings that oversaw the human descendants' cultivation (Sudo) to unite with Sinmyeong as Yin-Yang.³⁶¹

If the organizing principle of the traditional Western ontological Samjae (Three Powers) is the principle of earth, water, fire, and air, then the organizing principle of the traditional Eastern generative Samjae is Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. If the Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which began from the tri-functional system appearing in Greco-Roman mythology and Indian mythology, was established early through earth, water, fire, and air, culminating in Aristotle's ontological view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on matter-form, then the Eastern generative view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity was formed over a long period as Confucianism, Buddhism, Daoism (Yubulseon) and Yin-Yang and the Five Elements interacted with each other.

The traditional Eastern view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is largely divided into the Samjae (Three Powers) view of the I Ching (Book of Changes) and the Samgye (Three Realms) view of Buddhism.

³⁵⁹ Zygmunt Bauman, *Aengche Geundae (Liquid Modernity)*, Seoul: Kang, 2009.

³⁶⁰ Kim Deok-yeong, *Hwanwon Geundae: Hanguk Geundaehwa-wa Geundaeseong-ui Sahoehakjeok Bopyeonsa-reul Wihayeo (Reductive Modernity: Toward a Sociological Universal History of Korea's Modernization and Modernity)*, Seoul: Gil, 2014, p.41.

³⁶¹ Park Yong-sook, *The 81 Characters of the Cheonbugyeong Paramita*, Paju: Sodong, 2018.

If the I Ching's Samjae view, organized by the principles of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, is the traditional Eastern generative Samjae view, then the Buddhist Samgye view is closer to an ontological Samjae view. The traditional Eastern view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity was formed first as the Daoist I Ching's Samjae view, and then, as the Buddhist ontological Samgye view was introduced, it was synthesized into the Neo-Confucian (Seongrihak) Confucian Samjae view; in fact, before the introduction of Buddhism, Confucianism had almost no ontological cosmology, and the generative cosmology of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements was introduced first. It is natural that in the generative Eastern thought system, the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity could only develop into the Samjae view after the introduction of Buddhism's ontological thought system.

Due to differences in natural and cultural environments, the Eastern Samjae-gwan, which developed a more genesis-based view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity compared to the West, was a view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on correlative thought, represented by Cheon-Ji-In and Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. The theories of Yin-Yang, the Five Elements, and the Three Powers (Samjae), which are said to have arisen individually in history, share correlative thought and began to be integrated starting from Dong Zhongshu's Confucianism of Cheon-in-gam-eung-ron (theory of resonance between Heaven and Human), but their full-scale integration begins with Zhou Dunyi's (1017-1073) Taegeuk-do-seol (Explanation of the Diagram of the Great Ultimate), which is the foundation of Neo-Confucianism. The Yin-Yang mentioned in the I Ching develops in the order of the Cheon-Ji-In Samjae of Asian shamanism, which is similar to the European three-function system, and then the Five Elements. The development process of correlative thought can be summarized as follows.

Although Yin-Yang, Samjae (Three Powers), the Five Elements, and the Eight Trigrams (Palgwae) had different origins, they were each differences in perspective looking at the same Samjae, so if the differences in perspective are understood, they can be integrated. Each of these was a minimal system for viewing the Samjae (Three Powers) depending on the perspective. Yin-Yang, Samjae, the Five Elements, and the Eight Trigrams become an integrated principle capable of interpreting the same Samjae in detail according to Shao Kangjie's (So Gang-jeol) principle of "adding one fold" (Ga-ilbaebeop).

First, Yin-Yang is a common element of binary opposition worldwide, serving as the first step in intuitively distinguishing things and as a fundamental attribute. In the generative Samjae view that emphasizes attributes, Yin-Yang becomes the fundamental principle. If Yin-Yang exhibits binary oppositional attributes in a world without form, these attributes must form a solid (three-dimensional body) to have substance in reality, thus developing into Samjae (三才, Three Powers), the minimal system for forming a three-dimensional solid. At this time, Samjae is represented by the Heaven-Earth-Humanity Samjae; as Samjae developed from Yin-Yang into form, in Heaven-Earth-Humanity, Heaven (Cheon) takes

the role of Yang, Earth (Ji) takes the role of Yin, and Humanity (In) takes the role of Jung (中, Neutral/Middle) mediating Heaven and Earth.³⁶²

If a solid (three-dimensional body) is formed by Samjae, just as a particle in matter must simultaneously have the nature of a wave to exist, the particle must form a Sasang (四象, Four Symbols) system that can circulate as waves. Sasang systems like Wonhyeongijeong (元亨利貞; sublime, potential, favorable, correct), Saengjangyeomjang (生長斂藏; birth, growth, harvest, storage), and Chunhachudong (spring, summer, autumn, winter) form a system similar to the Sasang system formed by earth, water, fire, and air. However, the difference here between the Sasang system of earth, water, fire, and air and the Sasang system of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements is that earth, water, fire, and air is a substantial thought system moving from bottom to top, and thus is not an attributive thought system developing into Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, which are attributes common to all things.

The Sasang system, in turn, must achieve mutual conflict (Sanggeuk) and mutual generation (Sangsaeng) to form a continuous cycle, so it develops into the Five Elements (Ohaeng), the minimal system for Sanggeuk and Sangsaeng, requiring the central element, Earth (土, To), for its central role. However, even the Five Elements are existences of "generating numbers" (Saengsu) that do not yet possess the Yin-Yang that constitutes things; therefore, for these generating numbers to acquire the Yin-Yang that possesses change in reality, the Five Elements must change into the 8 Trigrams (Pal-gwae), which, as an even number, can form the minimal system of Sanggeuk and Sangsaeng.³⁶³ The 8 Trigrams again require a center, thus becoming the Gugungpalgwae (Nine Palaces and Eight Trigrams), and this Gugungpalgwae becomes the fundamental system of correlative thinking that explains the universe, developing into the He Tu (River Chart) and Luo Shu (Luo Writing).³⁶⁴

³⁶² It is useful to examine the pioneering approach of Harold J. Berman, who published a study in 1983 on the formation of the Western legal tradition. According to him, when we rewrite the past, we must "go beyond Marx and Weber" and also overcome the errors of various Western nationalisms, religious prejudices, and the historical materialism and ideal-type analysis of the 19th century. Regional designations are one example: the distinction between East Asia and Southeast Asia is not based on historical realities and internal logical structures but is an arbitrary division based on US strategic regional configurations after World War II, which could become a mistaken practice that paralyzes intellectual inquiry. Alexander Woodside, translated by Min Byeong-hui, *Ireobeolin Geundaeseongdeul (Lost Modernities)*, Neomeobukseu, 2012, p.18.; Kim Deok-sam, Lee Gyeong-ja, Choe Won-hyeok, "Geunhyeondae Paereodaim-ui Jeonhwan-gwa Naejaeseong-e Daehan Gochal-Jeontong-gwa Geundae-e Daehan Hangujeok Jaego(再考)-reul Jungsimsim-euro" [A Study on the Paradigm Shift in Modern and Contemporary Times and Immanence — Focusing on the Korean Reconsideration of Tradition and Modernity], *Inmun Gwahak Yeongu [Studies in Humanities]* 23, 2014, pp.115-142.

³⁶³ Wang Hui, translated by Baek Won-dam, *Geundae Jungguk Sasang-ui Heunggi (The Rise of Modern Chinese Thought)*, Paju: Dolbegae, 2024.; Lee Jong-min, *Jungguk Sasang-gwa Daean Geundaeseong: Wang Hui-ui Geundae Jungguk Sasang-ui Heunggi Ilgi-wa Sseugi (Chinese Thought and Alternative Modernity: Reading and Writing Wang Hui's The Rise of Modern Chinese Thought)*, Seoul: Hyeonamsa, 2017.

³⁶⁴ 20th-century modernism, which can be called a symbol of modernity, is also interpreted in the field of fine arts — where it is most clearly manifested in everyday life — as a cultural variant resulting from the spread of Far Eastern Asian culture to Europe beginning in the 16th century. (Yu Hyeon-jun, *Modernism: Dongseoyang Munhwa-ui Haibeullideu [Modernism: A Hybrid of Eastern and Western Culture]*, Seoul: Miseum, 2008, pp.73-92.) Scholars who argue for the Eastern origins of Western modernity maintain that even with respect to multilayered modernity, Western modernity itself is already a cultural

For the Gugung (Nine Palaces) of the Hado and Nakseo to appear as the substance that actually operates Heaven and Earth, the element of time is added, appearing as the 10 Heavenly Stems (Sipgan) and 12 Earthly Branches (Sipiji). In the 10 Stems and 12 Branches, the element of To (Earth), such as Jin, Sul, Chuk, Mi, is placed in time to mediate the changes of time. The 10 Stems and 12 Branches, arranged respectively in Heaven and Earth, perform the Cheonji-hwayuk (Nurturing Transformation of Heaven and Earth) through Cheon-gi-hagang (descent of Heaven's Gi) and Ji-gi-sangseung (ascent of Earth's Gi), that is, Cheonji-seunggang (ascent and descent of Heaven and Earth), which is the action of the Cheonjijiyong (Function of Heaven and Earth), the 12 Unseong (Phases of Fortune): namely, the actions of Potae (Conception), Yangsaeng (Nourishment), Yokdae (Bathing & Girding), Gwanwang (Coming of Age & Prosperity), Soebyeong (Decline & Sickness), and Sajang (Death & Burial).³⁶⁵ If the 10 Stems and 12 Branches are like atoms in physics, the 12 Unseong as the Cheonjijiyong can be likened to molecules, where atoms combine to exhibit completely different properties.³⁶⁶

The 12 phases of Qi (Unseong) express the transformation and nourishment (Cheonjihwayuk) of Heaven and Earth's ascent and descent (Cheonjiseunggang) as the life cycle of a living being.³⁶⁷ Like the meeting of a man and a woman, Heaven and Earth as Yin-Yang begin with conception (Potae)—where Heaven descends and Earth ascends (Cheongangjiseung) and the seed of life is sown in the earth—followed by the earth nourishing (Yangsaeng) the seed of life, the seed emerging outside the earth or body to bathe in Heaven's rain and dew (Uro) and form the phase of bathing and girding (Yokdae) as another girted individual, and then reaching the phase of coming of age and prosperity (Gwanwang) where it takes on work and acts vigorously, before declining, sickening, and being buried (Soe, Byeong, Jang), signifying 12 stages.³⁶⁸ This shows a process similar to the 12 stages of Campbell's monomyth, the 7 characters, or the

variant produced by the spread of Far Eastern Asian culture to Europe and is therefore not a sufficient concept of modernity to explain reality.

³⁶⁵ Yun Seung-yong, "Sinjongyo-ui Ban-gujo(communitas)-jeok Seonggyeok-e Gwanhan Sogo: Joseon Malgi Jonggyo Hyeonsang-eul Jungsimsim-euro" [A Brief Study on the Anti-structural (Communitas) Character of New Religions: Focusing on Religious Phenomena in Late Joseon], Seoul National University Master's Thesis, 1982.

³⁶⁶ Lee Seon-min, Hanguk-ui Jajujeok Geundae-hwa-e Gwanhan Seongreul (Reflections on Korea's Indigenous Modernization), Paju: Nanam, 2021; Jo Hye-in, Dong-eseo Seo-ro Peorin Geundae Gongmin Sahoe (Modern Civil Society That Spread from East to West), Paju: Jimmundang, 2013.; Hwang Tae-yeon, Yugyo-jeok Geundae-ui Ilbaniryon (A General Theory of Confucian Modernity), Seoul: Hanguk Munhwasa, 2023.

³⁶⁷ Lee Seon-min, Reflections on Korea's Indigenous Modernization, Paju: Nanam, 2021.

³⁶⁸ The use of the term "Donghak" can be said to express the unique problematic consciousness of Donghak: un-jeuk-il (運則一, the movement is one), do-jeuk-dong (道則同, the Way is the same), i-jeuk-bi (理則非, but the principle differs). Suun criticizes Western Learning (Seohak) for lacking the principle of won-hyeong-i-jeong (元亨利貞, the fourfold virtue). He sharply points out the weakness of Western Learning — that without the unified principle of won-hyeong-i-jeong, it regards truth situationally and thus lacks a center. (Bae Yeong-sun, "Donghak-gwa Seohak-ui Chabyeolseong Munje [The Problem of the Difference between Donghak and Western Learning: Focusing on 'Un-jeuk-il Do-jeuk-dong I-jeuk-bi']", 理則非 Daegu Sahak [Daegu Historical Studies] 73, Daegu Sahakhoe, 2003, pp.203-210.) Choe Su-un (Suun) in the Nonhangmun (Discourse on Learning) chapter of Donggyeong Daejeon (The Great Scripture of Eastern Learning), argues that the West is analytical, changes its words according to circumstances, seems to believe in God but does not, and thus ultimately falls into nihilism. Among all the world's civilizations that resisted Western imperialism, only Korea's Donghak — like Nisbett — made the methodology of scholarship a central theme of resistance. Since Donghak has until now been studied only from the

Ten Ox-Herding Pictures (Simudo).³⁶⁹ Kim Ji-ha expressed this as Yullyeo (cosmic music/rhythm).³⁷⁰ The function of Heaven and Earth (Cheonjijiyong) shows that the operation of Heaven and Earth is not mechanical by nature, but is due to the utmost Seong-Gyeong-Sin (Sincerity, Reverence, and Trust) of Heaven and Earth. From the perspective of Eastern thought, what Western atomistic modernity most overlooked was the omission of the Seong-Gyeong-Sin of the Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings) in its mechanistic view of nature. This is referred to as the "disease of lack of Dao" (Mudobyeong) in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought.³⁷¹

The function of Heaven and Earth (Cheonjijiyong) influences not only everyday things but also thought systems, so Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon) appear as reflections of this function. The conception (Potae) of Heaven and Earth is expressed as the Dao of Immortals (Seondo) of emptiness (Heomu); the nourishment (Yangsang) of Heaven and Earth is expressed as the Buddhist Dao (Buldo) of cessation (Jeokmyeol); and the bathing and girding (Yokdae) of Heaven and Earth is expressed as the 'Ijo' (以詔, decree/instruction) of the Confucian Dao (Yudo). If the Western view of Heaven explains Heaven's characteristics through the substantial attributes of earth, water, fire, and air, the East expresses Heaven's attributes through the four attributes of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. If the Western view of Heaven is substantialist and thus, since modernity, has differentiated countless and individually like atomism, the Eastern view of Heaven shows a unified structure—such as Yin-Yang, Samjae (Three Powers), Five Elements, Eight Trigrams, 10 Stems, and 12 Branches—within each unit, including atoms, molecules, individuals, and society.³⁷²

The Clash and Mutual Antagonism (相克化) of East-West Views of Heaven in Modernity

perspective of popular resistance movements, it needs to be newly discussed from the standpoint of immanence in terms of paradigm and the methodology of thought.

³⁶⁹ Kim Deok-sam, Choe Won-hyeok, Lee Gyeong-ja, "Geunhyeondae Paereodaim-ui Jeonhwan-gwa Naejaeseong-e Daehan Gochal — Jeontong-gwa Geundae-e Daehan Hangujeok Jaego(再考)-reul Jungsimsim-euro" [A Study on the Paradigm Shift in Modern and Contemporary Times and Immanence — Focusing on the Korean Reconsideration of Tradition and Modernity], *Inmun Gwahak Yeongu* [Studies in Humanities] 23, 2014, pp.115-142.

³⁷⁰ Jeong Jae-sik, *Continuity and Change in Tradition*, Seoul: Acanet, 2004.

³⁷¹ Weber argues that early capitalism, which began with the Puritan spirit of Protestantism, is distinct from modern capitalism, which today focuses solely on economic efficiency. (Daniel Pals, translated by Jo Byeong-ryeon and Jeon Jung-hyeon, *Jonggyo-e Daehan Yeodeolb Gaji Irondeul* [Eight Theories of Religion], Goyang: Hanguk Gidokgyo Yeonguso, 2013.) Weber's observation that the nature of capitalism, a characteristic of modernity, has changed is correct, but his theory that capitalism can only arise from a Western Christian standpoint has been refuted both theoretically and practically by the East's overtaking of the West today. (Thomas Metzger, *Gongyeong-ui Talpyi: Juhui-Wangyang-myeongbuteo Tang Jyun-i-Peng Yu-lan-kkaji Sinyuhak-gwa Jungguk-ui Jeongchi Munhwa* [Escape from Predicament: Neo-Confucianism and China's Evolving Political Culture, from Zhu Xi and Wang Yangming to Tang Junyi and Feng Youlan], Minumsa, 2014, pp.62-65.)

³⁷² Ko Nam-sik, "Suun-gwa Jeungsan-ui Minjokjuuijeok Yoso Bigyo" [A Comparison of Nationalist Elements in Suun and Jeungsan], *Sinjongyo Yeongu* [Studies in New Religions] 26, Hanguk Sinjongyo Hakhoe [Korean Association for the Study of New Religions], 2012; Lee Gyeong-won, "Daesun Jinri-ui Geundaeseong-gwa Byeohyeok Sasang" [The Modernity and Thought of Reform in Daesoon Truth], *Donghak Hakbo* [Journal of Donghak Studies] 10, Donghak Hakhoe, 2005. There is also an analysis that the Korean Wave's global boom is due to Korean religious philosophy, as exemplified in Daesoon thought. (Park Jong-hyeon, "Hallyu Munhwa Hyeonsang-ui Jonggyo Cheolhakjeok Giwon-gwa Bunseok" [The Religious-Philosophical Origins and Analysis of the Korean Wave Cultural Phenomenon], *Sinhak Nondan* [Theological Studies] 76, Yonsei University School of Theology and Graduate School of Theology, 2014.)

Clash of Views of Heaven

The Western view of Heaven, expressed through the attributes of earth, water, fire, and air, and the Eastern view of Heaven, expressed through Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, had similarities. In fact, Ricci, who embarked on the Eastern mission, was impressed that the Eastern view of Heaven appearing in the Classic of History (Seogyeong), a Confucian classic predating Neo-Confucianism, was similar to the Western view of Heaven and even had superior points, and he held hope for the Eastern mission.

I have never seen, among all the nations of gentiles known in Europe, any whose ancient ideas had fewer errors than those of the ancient Chinese. In fact, I discovered in their books that they always revered the supreme being, whom they called the King of Heaven (天帝) or Heaven and Earth (天地). Perhaps, in their view, Heaven and Earth constituted a single living body (體), and the supreme being of that body was something like its soul.³⁷³

Matteo Ricci pursues the Eastern mission with the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on earth, water, fire, and air. The view of Heaven in the Classic of History that Matteo Ricci discovered—Heaven as Creator, the providence of Heaven, the judgment of Heaven, and the attributes of Heaven as Ruler—appeared almost identically to Western Learning (Seohak).³⁷⁴

Heaven and Earth are the parents of all things, and the human being is the most numinous of all things. — Heaven as Creator³⁷⁵

August Heaven watched over and gave its command, so that he became the sovereign of all under Heaven who governs the whole world. — The providence of Heaven³⁷⁶

Heaven punishes because there is sin. — The judgment of Heaven³⁷⁷

The Way of Heaven is such that it bestows blessings upon the good and sends down calamity upon the wicked. — The attribute of Heaven as the presiding ruler³⁷⁸

³⁷³ Jeon Su-jun, *Singwahak-eseo Dongyanghakreulo* (From New Science to Oriental Studies), Seoul: Daewon Chulpan, 1995, pp.281-283.

³⁷⁴ Zhu Qianzhi, translated by Jeon Hong-seok, *Jungguk-i Mandeun Yureopeui Geundae: Geundae Yureopeui Jungguk Munhwa Yeolpung* (China-Made European Modernity: The Craze for Chinese Culture in Modern Europe), Cheongye, 2003.

³⁷⁵ Thomas Metzger, Gongyeong-ui Talpyi: Juhui-Wangyang-myeongbuteo Tang Jyun-i-Peng Yu-lan-kkaji Sinyuhak-gwa Jungguk-ui Jeongchi Munhwa (Escape from Predicament: Neo-Confucianism and China's Evolving Political Culture, from Zhu Xi and Wang Yangming to Tang Junyi and Feng Youlan), Minumsa, 2014.

³⁷⁶ Kim Deok-sam, Choe Won-hyeok, Lee Gyeong-ja, "Geunhyeondae Paereodaim-ui Jeonhwan-gwa Naejaeseong-e Daehan Gochal — Jeontong-gwa Geundae-e Daehan Hangujeok Jaego(再考)-reul Jungsimsim-euro" [A Study on the Paradigm Shift in Modern and Contemporary Times and Immanence — Focusing on the Korean Reconsideration of Tradition and Modernity], *Inmun Gwahak Yeongu* [Studies in Humanities] 23, pp.115-142.

³⁷⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9; An Sin, "Mateo Richi-wa Daesun Sasang-ui Gwangyesong-e Daehan Yeongu: Daesun Sasang-ui Gidokgyo Jongjang-e Daehan Jonggyo Hyeonsanghajeok Haeseok" [A Study on the Relationship between Matteo Ricci and Daesoon Thought: A Religious Phenomenological Interpretation of the Christian Founder in Daesoon Thought], *Daesun Sasang Nonchong* [Studies in Daesoon Thought] 36, 2020.

³⁷⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-15; Kim Tae-su, "Jinmuk Josayujeokgo-wa Jeongyeong-e Natanan Jinmuk Seolhwa-ui Chai-e Daehan Jaehaeseok: Munheon Jeonseung-gwa Gujeon Jeonseung-ui Chai-reul Jungsimsim-euro" [A Reinterpretation of the Differences in the Jinmuk Legend as Appearing in Jinmukjosayujeokgo and

Matteo Ricci considered it a corruption and lamented that the idea of Heaven in the Classic of History, which he found similar to the Western view of Heaven, lost its personal divine attributes and changed into a Principle-Deity (Ibeopsin) as it progressed through the Zhou dynasty, Confucius, and Neo-Confucianism. However, from today's perspective, which understands it as an attribute of multiple modernities where the secular (Sok) encompasses the sacred (Seong), divinity is seen as having been rather strengthened.³⁷⁹

In fact, intellectuals in Joseon, which was the most Neo-Confucianized society in East Asia, encountered The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven and sometimes welcomed it as an ideology that could reveal the original meaning of Confucianism. Contemporary intellectuals such as Gwangam Yi Byeok and Jeong Yak-yong even risked their lives to accept Western Learning (Seohak). On the other hand, many intellectuals, represented by Sin Hudam (1702-1761) who wrote the Critique of Western Learning (Seohakbyeon), also expressed concern about Western Learning.³⁸⁰

However, the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on earth, water, fire, and air, where the attribute of the fifth element as Heaven was maximized, and the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, where the attribute of Earth (To) as land was maximized, collide head-on. Fortunately, during Matteo Ricci's time, the two views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity maintained a cooperative relationship under the pretext of the theory of complementing Confucianism (Boryuron), but after Matteo Ricci, due to the Rites Controversy (Boryuron nonjaeng), the two views mutually rejected each other and rushed into a relationship of confrontation, eventually leading the East to face a crisis of civilization annihilation by the West, much like the Inca or Maya empires. The East could not overcome the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism, and the West could not tolerate the East.

In particular, the question of whether the "Li" (理, Principle) of Taegeuk (Taiji) was a self-subsistent existence (substantia) emerged as the core issue between the two views of Heaven. In the Western formal view of Heaven, which explains change through substance, all things are created, so the "Li" of Taegeuk cannot be a self-subsistent existence; however, in the Eastern assimilative view of Heaven, which took charge of the operation of Heaven and Earth through the creation (Gaebyeok) of Heaven and Earth, the "Li" of Taegeuk is self-subsistent, so the two views of Heaven were bound to collide.

In response to Matteo Ricci's argument in The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven—which sought to clarify the Western substantialist position that "Li" (Principle) cannot subsist on its own by distinguishing whether "Li" is a self-subsistent existence (substantia) or an accidental existence (accidentia)—the Neo-Confucian scholar Sin Hudam replies in his Critique of Western Learning (Seohakbyeon) with the Eastern

Jeongyeong: Focusing on the Differences between Literary Transmission and Oral Tradition], Daesun Sasang Nonchong [Studies in Daesoon Thought] 41, 2022.

³⁷⁹ Lee Bong-ho, The Philosophy of Seo Myeong-eung, King Jeongjo's Teacher (A Joseon Scholar's Response to Western Science), Goyang: Donggwa Seo, 2013.

³⁸⁰ Hwang Tae-yeon, Yugyo-jeok Geundae-ui Ilbaniron: Seogugukga-ui Yugyo-jeok Geundaehwa-wa Yugyogukga-ui Seogujeo k Geundaehwa (A General Theory of Confucian Modernity: The Confucian Modernization of Western States and the Western Modernization of Confucian States), Seoul: Hanguk Munhwasa, 2023.

attributive logic that as much as Li and things (事物) are completely connected, if there is Li, there are things, and if there are things, there is Li.³⁸¹³⁸²

The general populace, who had been favorable toward the West, also shifted to a negative stance regarding the Western view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity after the Treaty of Beijing, when Western domination began in earnest. The East, suppressed by Western power, now required the liminality of a rite of passage and the revitalization of a new view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity to counter Western power. Consequently, in East Asia, movements such as China's Yiguandao, the Taiping Rebellion, and the Xinhai Revolution arose, and in Japan, new religious movements like the Meiji Restoration and Tenrikyo either emerged or spread.

The place that reacted most sensitively to the collapse of the Yin-Yang and Five Elements view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity was Korea, the most Confucianized of the three East Asian countries. Korea further developed the theory that Western Learning originated in China (Seohakjungwonron) and interpreted Western Learning from an Eastern perspective. The Korean version of Seohakjungwonron, starting from Seo Myeong-eung, passed through Jeong Yak-yong and Choe Han-gi, and then reached a critical turning point upon reaching Donghak Thought. Donghak Thought presents the harmony between the personal God of earth, water, fire, and air and the Principle-Deity (Ibeopsin) of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements through the liminality called Siccheonju (Bearing the Lord of Heaven).³⁸³

In the case of the East, the creator of the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity hides; instead, unlike the West, the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity are divided by Heaven-Earth-Humanity and Yin-Yang, like in the I Ching (Book of Changes), forming an autonomous and coherent system of Spiritual Beings (Sinmyeong). Whereas in Western Learning (Seohak), other gods of the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity disappear due to the monotheistic God, in Daoism, under the influence of the I Ching, the gods of the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity function as an autonomous and coherent system called Yin-Yang. This connects to the Donghak thought of Johwa (Creation-Transformation), namely Muwiiwha (Spontaneous Transformation) and Cheonjigwisin (Heaven-Earth-Ghosts-Spirits).³⁸⁴

After Seohakjungwonron (theory that Western Learning originated in China) was introduced to Joseon, a counterargument based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements theory was raised against Ricci's criticism of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. Seo Myeong-eung refutes Matteo Ricci's The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven using Shao Kangjie's (1011-1077) theory of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. Meanwhile, Jeong Yak-yong (1762-1836) partially accepted Matteo Ricci's opinions and criticized Neo-Confucianism (Seongrihak), but this was in order to defend Eastern values. As such, before Donghak, the East-West

³⁸¹ Han Tae-dong, Sayuui Heureum (The Flow of Thought), Yonsei University Press, 2003.

³⁸² Han Jang-gyeong, Juyek·Jeong-yeok (The Book of Changes and the Correct Change), Samgwa Kkum, 2001.

³⁸³ Han Dong-seok, Ujbyeonhwaui Wonri: Eumyang Ohaeng Wonri (The Principles of Cosmic Change: The Principles of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements), Daewon Publishing, 2003.

³⁸⁴ Lee Seung-soo, The Principle of Jung (Center/Balance), Seoul: GG.com, 2008.

debate on correlative thinking was becoming an important issue in the academic world at that time. "Donghak" (Eastern Learning) was born in the atmosphere of the times that emphasized the unique methodology of Eastern scholarship in response to "Seohak" (Western Learning).

For Easterners at that time, establishing East Asia's indigenous modernity was a matter of survival, beyond a matter of choice. The East, having realized Western power through the Opium War, sensed the danger that if it failed to establish indigenous modernity, Asia could also degenerate into a state of civilization loss, like Africa or the indigenous peoples of the Americas. Furthermore, for Easterners who had lived more diligently than Westerners, the shock from the West was not only a great material threat but also approached as a spiritual threat of demoralization, seeing all their efforts come to nothing.

During the imperialist era, Easterners faced a spiritual crisis of losing not only material well-being but also their identity, leading them to either uncritically accept Western Learning (Seohak) or rely on Eastern mysticism. Establishing indigenous modernity based on correlative thinking, the Eastern form of rationality, was increasingly becoming a core issue for East Asia's survival. Donghak was founded bearing a heavy task. Once the Donghak concept, based on the correlative thinking of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, was established, concepts such as 'Mugeukdaedo' (Great Dao of the Non-polar), 'Cheonjigwisin' (Heaven-Earth-Ghosts-Spirits), 'Sangwongap' (First Cycle of Sixty), and 'Dasi Gaebyeok' (Re-Creation) were newly established.

Mutual Antagonism of Views of Heaven

As the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, and those based on earth, water, fire, and air collided, the mutual conflict (Sanggeukhwa) of the view of Heaven intensified. The two thought systems, Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, and earth, water, fire, and air, not only share similar ideal views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, but their patterns of mutual conflict (Sanggeukhwa) are also similar. In the worldview of earth, water, fire, and air, the ideal world falls into mutual conflict (Sanggeukhwa) as the three calamities (Samjae) of water, fire, and wind due to human sin; in the worldview of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, it falls into mutual conflict as the disorder of Yin and Yang (Eumyangnanjap) due to an incomplete world structure. Due to the East-West exchange that unfolded after Matteo Ricci, the mutual conflict (Sanggeukhwa) of the view of Heaven, denying God for different reasons, proceeds in both the East and the West.

The confusion in the East-West relationship between gods and humans that unfolded after Matteo Ricci began in the area of the theory of the soul's immortality after death.³⁸⁵ After Matteo Ricci, in the East, the Li-Qi theory (Igi-ron), which held that the soul also disappears as Qi dissipates after four generations (代), was doubted; and in the West, the idea that the world of God consists of one absolute God and a few angels was doubted. After Matteo Ricci, in the East, Yin-Yang and the Five Elements and the

³⁸⁵ Kim Seung-ho, Juyeok Wonron (The Original Principles of the Book of Changes) (vols. 1–6), Seonyeongsa, 2009.

Cheonjisinmyeong (Spirits of Heaven and Earth) were denied, and in the West, an atheistic worldview, composed of numerous principle-deities (Ibeopsin) or mechanisms like in the East, was formed.³⁸⁶

The difference in the modes of thinking between the East and the West is revealed in detail in Matteo Ricci's *The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven* and the debates surrounding it. By today's standards, the worldview of earth, water, fire, and air seems more similar to the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, which Matteo Ricci criticized, than to the modern mechanistic view of science; however, as François Jullien pointed out, in its emphasis on substance in explaining change, the worldview of earth, water, fire, and air was closer to the modern mechanistic view of science.³⁸⁷ In fact, Ricci, despite the common attribute of the Eastern Yin-Yang and Five Elements view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity being a science of correlative thinking, criticizes the Eastern Yin-Yang and Five Elements view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity as an unscientific explanation because it explains change through attributes instead of substance.³⁸⁸

As seen in the Rites Controversy (Boryuron nonjaeng), Catholicism rejected the Eastern worldview transmitted by Matteo Ricci, but secular society, on the contrary, welcomed it. Starting with Descartes, represented by "Cogito ergo sum," the West bleached its existing view of God and proceeded to construct a mechanistic worldview without God (神).³⁸⁹ On the other hand, in morality, theories emphasizing the Gospel over the Law (Yulbeop) expand. In other words, Calvin's predestination theory changes into empathy (Gonggam) in a society without God.³⁹⁰ Modernity converges into a new liminality. From a human perspective, this change in the view of God had been interpreted as a positive change, but today, with the problems of modernity maximized, it has become an occasion for reflection and a motive for seeking a new, alternative modernity.

In the mutually conflicting (Sanggeukhwa) Heaven-human relationship of "God is high, man is low" (Sinjoninbi), humans become beings who must leave the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity through liberation (Haetal), renunciation (Talsok), or death to escape the suffering of birth, aging, sickness, and death. In the mutually conflicting view of Heaven, the Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings) are also bound, each taking charge of their own boundary, becoming existences trapped within their own fields and domains in a state of misfortune/blockage (Bigeop). Humans, consequently, under the influence of their respective earth energies, give rise to different civilizations and conflict with one another. Furthermore, in the mutually conflicting Heaven, due to the disharmony of rain and dew (Uro), humans come to live in the suffering of

³⁸⁶ Yun Jong-bin, *Jeong-yeokgwa Juyeok* (The Correct Change and the Book of Changes), Sangsaeng Publishing, 2009.

³⁸⁷ Yi Hyeon-jung, *Yeokgyeonggwa Saseo* (The Book of Changes and the Four Books), Yeoknak, 2004.

³⁸⁸ Im Byeong-hak, *Yeokhaggwa Hadollakseo* (The Studies of Changes and the River Diagram and Luo Writing), Korean Studies Information, 2008.

³⁸⁹ Yun Jong-bin, *Hanguk Yeokak Yeongui Gicho* (Foundations of Korean I Ching Studies), Mungyeong Publishing, 2012.

³⁹⁰ Kim Sang-il, *Yeokgwa Talhyeondaeui Nonri* (The Book of Changes and the Logic of Post-Modernity), Knowledge Industry, 2006.

the three calamities (Samjae) of water, fire, and wind. Mutual conflict (Sanggeuk) begets mutual conflict, and it becomes today's reality that Heaven-and-Earth and humanity fall into tragic confusion (Changnan) and transition to a state of annihilation (Jinmyeoljigyeong).

Liminality in the Siecheonju (侍天主) View of Heaven in Donghak Thought

The Siecheonju (侍天主) View of Heaven in Donghak Thought

When Neo-Confucianism's Principle-Heaven (Ibeopcheon) reached a stage where it could not solve the problems of the new era in East Asia, especially in Joseon society, Donghak presented a solution with a new view of Heaven: the Heaven above Heaven (Cheonoecheon), namely, the Heaven of the Non-polar (Mugeuk). Donghak seeks to embrace the learning of Seohak (Western Learning) within its view of Heaven. This is similar to how the Western invasion by the Mongols and Islam became the background for Western modernity. The new view of Heaven presented by Donghak, unlike Neo-Confucianism's Principle-Heaven, was direct communication with the Heaven above Heaven, namely, Cheonoecheon (天外天). The Cheon (Heaven) of Siecheonju (Bearing the Lord of Heaven) is the concept of Heaven as Cheonoecheon.

Donghak Thought emphasizes the concept of Cheonoecheon, which had not been highlighted in the existing views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, thereby promoting the indigenous modernity of the view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. In the theory of multiple modernities, modernity arises from encompassment (Tongseop) and liminality, which, as in Donghak Thought, reactivates the parts alienated in the existing view of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, changing the hierarchy of the sacred and secular (Seong-Sok) to transition so that the secular can accommodate the sacred. Donghak Thought pursues a rearrangement of the sacred-secular hierarchy, experiencing the sacred in everyday secular life through direct communication with Cheonoecheon, and attempts liminality to solve existing, overlapping problems through "guarding the mind and rectifying the Qi" (Susimjeonggi).

Suun (Choe Je-u) expresses the direct communication with the 'Heaven above Heaven', which is different from the 'Heaven' of existing Neo-Confucianism, as Siecheonju (Bearing the Lord of Heaven). Suun invests all his capabilities throughout his life for direct communication with the 'Heaven above Heaven'. Suun, who had striven for nearly 40 long years, finally arrives at the 'Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers' (Cheonsamundap) in the Gyeongsin year (1860). The Donghak view of Heaven is established through the Cheonsamundap, the encounter with Sangje (the Supreme Ruler). It is said that Suun received the first revelation from Sangje on the 5th day of the 4th lunar month in 1860 (Gyeongsin year).³⁹¹

³⁹¹ An Seong-ho, "The Theological Continuity Between the Term 'Shangdi (上帝)' Used in Matteo Ricci's The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven in the Early 17th Century and in James Legge's English Translation of Chinese Confucian Classics in the 19th Century," *Hanguk Gidokgyowa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 32, Korean Institute of Church History, 2010, pp.302–304; Chan Kei Thong, *Godai Junggugsogui Hananim* (Faith of Our Fathers: God in Ancient China), Seoul: Sun Publishing, 2009.

不意四月 心寒身戰 疾不得執症 言不得難狀之際 有何仙語 忽入耳中 驚起探問則 曰勿懼勿恐 世人 謂我上帝 汝不知上帝耶 問其所然 曰余亦無功故 生汝世間 教人此法 勿疑勿疑 曰然則 西道以教人乎 曰不然 吾有靈符 其名 仙藥 其形 太極 又形 弓弓 受我此符 濟人疾病 受我呪文 教人爲我則 汝亦長生 布德天下矣

Unexpectedly in April, when my heart grew cold and my body trembled, so much so that I could not diagnose what illness it was nor describe it in words, there was some immortal's saying that suddenly entered my ear; startled, I inquired about it, and he replied, "Do not fear, do not be afraid. "The people of the world call me Sangje (上帝, the Supreme Ruler). Do you not know Sangje?" I asked the reason, and it said, "I also have no achievement, therefore I have brought you forth into this world to teach people this law. Do not doubt, do not doubt." I asked, "Then, shall I teach people with the Western Dao (Seodo)?" It replied, "No. I have a spirit talisman (Yeongbu); its name is elixir (Seonyak), its shape is the Great Ultimate (Taegeuk), and its shape is also Gunggung (弓弓, Bow-Bow). Receive this talisman from me and save people from disease; receive my incantation (Jumun) and teach people for my sake, then you too shall live long and spread virtue throughout the world."³⁹²

Suun's Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers (Cheonsamundap) continued for about six months, and after pondering for about a year, Suun expressed this in detail in the Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam) and the Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Scripture of Eastern Learning). That is why Yi Don-hwa divides Suun's practice into the Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers period and the internal strengthening period. However, it is said that the Dowon Giseo (Record of the Origin of the Way), written after the Yongdam Yusa and Donggyeong Daejeon, contains passages describing Suun communicating with Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) multiple times thereafter, right up until his arrest.³⁹³

It is said that the most characteristic feature of Donghak Thought in the history of modern religion, and furthermore in the religious history of all times and places, is that the founder's religious experience is expressed in great detail and over a long period. It is said that Islam is almost the only religion, like Donghak Thought, that begins with the founder's religious experience, while other religions, like Buddhism, begin with the founder's ascetic experiences, and thus records of the religious experience do not appear. Also, in Islam, the experience is expressed very briefly. The fact that Donghak Thought gained many

³⁹² An Seong-ho, "John Ross's Theological Position on Primitive Chinese Monotheism in Confucianism and the Terminology Debate in Chinese Bible Translation," *Hanguk Gidokgyowa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 40, (Korean Institute of Church History, 2014), p.228.

³⁹³ Legge, *The Notions of the Chinese concerning God and Spirits*, p.33, cited in An Seong-ho, "The Theological Continuity Between the Term 'Shangdi (上帝)' Used in Matteo Ricci's *The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven* in the Early 17th Century and in James Legge's *English Translation of Chinese Confucian Classics* in the 19th Century," *Hanguk Gidokgyowa Yeoksa* (Christianity and History in Korea) 32, Korean Institute of Church History, 2010, pp.315–316.

supporters in a short period in Korean society, which was a deeply-rooted Confucian society, is largely because these detailed Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers inspired trust.³⁹⁴

Donghak was established in the process of Suun interpreting the dialogues that took place during the six-month period of the Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers. In the "Nonhangmun" (On Learning), Suun first emphasizes the distinction from Western Learning (Seohak) as the epistemological background of Donghak. Suun proclaims that the Sangje he met is the Heaven above Heaven, integrating the heavens of East and West, and particularly insists that this Heaven is superior to the Heaven of Western Learning. Suun defines this based on the nature of "Learning" (Hak, 學). As seen in the title "On Learning," among all the world's civilizations that resisted Western imperialism, only Korea's Donghak uniquely took the epistemological theme of "learning" (Hakmun) as its main subject. The claim regarding the East—that the difference between East and West lies in the fundamental aspect of cognitive structure—first appears in Donghak's "Nonhangmun."

In the Donggyeong Daejeon's "Nonhangmun," Suun mentions that the West is analytical, changes its words according to the situation, and seems to believe in God but does not, thus ultimately falling into nihilism. First, Suun clarifies the difference between Donghak and Seohak with the words "Un jeuk il, Do jeuk dong, I jeuk bi" (運則一 道則同 理則非; "The fate (Un) is one, the Way (Do) is the same, but the principle (I) is not").

日與西道 無異者乎

Question: Is it no different from the Western Dao?

日洋學 如斯而有異 如呪而無實 然而運則一也 道則同也 理則非也

Answer: Western Learning (Yanghak) is similar to this but different; it seems like praying, but there is no substance.

However, the fortune (Unsu) is one, and the Way (Do) is the same, but the principle (Ichi) is different.³⁹⁵

In the excerpt above, Suun is said to state that Eastern and Western learning have the same goal but are methodologically different. Bae Young-soon has summarized previous research on this topic. Bae Young-soon explains the differences in detail, stating that existing preceding studies did not clearly elucidate the differences among Un (運, Fate/Fortune), Do (道, Way), and I (理, Principle) as spoken of in

³⁹⁴ Sun Jiang, "The Yellow Emperor (Huangdi) Came from Babylon: Lacouperie's 'Theory of Western Origins of Chinese Civilization' and Its Dissemination to East Asia," *Gaenyeongwa Sotong* (Concepts and Communication) 5, 2010, pp.79–126.

³⁹⁵ Hundreds of thousands of heavenly beings perform celestial music, and holding mandara flowers (mandarava flowers) and maha-mandara flowers of heaven, they scatter them upon him and say in praise: 'Excellent, excellent! Good man, because you have widely cultivated meritorious karma in Jambudvipa, you have come to be born here. This place is called Tusita Heaven, and the name of the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju) here is Maitreya; you should take refuge in him.' (Sutra on the Visualization of Bodhisattva Maitreya's Ascent to Tusita Heaven [佛說觀彌勒菩薩上生兜率天經]; Dongguk University Buddhist Records and Cultural Heritage Archive). Gucheon Daewon Johwajushin can also be called 'Cheonju' by combining the 'cheon' of Gucheon (the Ninth Heaven) and the 'ju' of Johwaju (the Lord of Creation).

Donghak. Bae Young-soon analyzes Sicheonju (Bearing the Lord of Heaven) through the correlative thinking of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity (Cheon-Ji-In), suggesting that in the phrase "Sicheonju Johwajeong Yeongsebulmangmansaji" (Bearing the Lord of Heaven, the Creation-Transformation is set; Eternally not forgetting, all things are known), 'Sicheonju' corresponds to Heaven (天), 'Johwajeong' to Earth (地), and 'Yeongsebulmangmansaji' to Humanity (人).

Bae Young-soon then applies Sicheonju to Un (Fate), Do (Way), and I (Principle), assigning Do (道) as 'Sicheonju' (侍天主), Un (運) as 'Johwajeong' (造化定), and I (理) as 'Yeongsebulmangmansaji' (永世不忘萬事知). Ultimately, it is said that the difference between Donghak and Seohak is that while Heaven and Earth are the same and one, the difference lies in the human principle (Ichi) of bearing the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju). Bae Young-soon is said to state that in Donghak, the Heaven (Do) of spring, summer, autumn, and winter is the same for both East and West, but the lands (運) of the East and West differ according to their Ki (energy/fortune).³⁹⁶

The difference in principle (Ichi) between Donghak and Seohak is explained in Donghak as follows.

曰何爲其然也 曰吾道無爲而化矣 守其心正其氣 率其性受其教 化出於自然之中也 西人 言無次第 書無皂白而 頓無爲天主之端 只視自爲身之謀 身無氣化之神 學無天主之教 有形無迹 如思無呢 道近虛無 學非天主 豈可謂無異者乎

"Why is it so?" "The Way (Do) I receive naturally enlightens the world according to the will of Haneullim (Lord of Heaven)." If each person guards their original mind, rectifies their Qi, and follows their innate nature (Cheonseong), thereby receiving the teaching of Haneullim, enlightenment will naturally be achieved. In contrast, Western people who believe in Western Learning (Seohak) have no proper order in their words and no clear logic in their writings. And they have no substance of serving Haneullim at all, but only pray for means for their own profit. Therefore, there is no wondrous state of the body uniting with spiritual energy (Yeonggi) and no true teaching of Haneullim; there is only form and no substance. It seems like they think of Haneullim, but they do not truly serve Haneullim. Thus, their Way (Do) is almost empty of content, and their religion does not serve Haneullim. How can one say there is no difference?³⁹⁷

The above excerpt is considered the most difficult part of the Donggyeong Daejeon, and it is said the reason is that the target of criticism in the excerpt was mainly understood as Catholicism or Catholics; it is

³⁹⁶ Choe Jong-seok, "Buddhist Elements in Jeungsan Religion (甌山教): Focusing on the Acceptance of Maitreya Faith," Seon Munhwa Yeongu (禪文化研究; Journal of Seon Culture Studies) 23, 2017, pp.254-255.

³⁹⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. The Heavenly Use (天用), Earthly Use (地用), and Human Use (人用) equalize the foundational order (Ganggi), thereby governing Heaven and Earth. This is called the means (Sudan) of Creation-Transformation (Johwa 造化). (Yang Mu-mok, "Salvation Truth [救援 真理] as Yin-Yang Unity of Virtue [陰陽合德] and Democracy [民主主義]," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Daesoon Thoughts) 2, 1997, pp.175-176)

said that if the target of criticism in the excerpt is viewed as Westerners in general and Western learning as a whole, it becomes understandable.³⁹⁸

In the excerpt above, Bae Young-soon is said to state that the decisive difference between Donghak and Seohak pointed out by Donghak is the "spirit of Qi-transformation" (Gihwajisin). Here, Gihwa (氣化, Qi-transformation) means the condensation of Heaven's Qi (energy) in the body. It means that Western Learning (Seohak) only prays to the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju) but lacks the incantations (Jumun) to spontaneously achieve Gihwa and lacks the training of "guarding the mind and rectifying the Qi" (Susimjeonggi). Just as Suun criticized the strict vertical division between priests and laypeople in Western Learning, he criticizes Western Learning here with the same logic for its lack of Gihwa.

It is said that what Suun actually took most pride in regarding the founding of Donghak was Susimjeonggi (guarding the mind and rectifying the Qi), and he spoke of this not only in relation to Western Learning but also in relation to Confucianism (Yuhak).³⁹⁹ Suun's view that the difference between Donghak and Seohak lies in the presence or absence of a training method was a penetrating insight into Eastern and Western learning. The renowned transpersonal psychologist Ken Wilber (1949-), who is said to have integrated Eastern and Western spirituality, has also pointed out that the greatest weakness of Western thought is the lack of a cultivation theory (Suryangnon), even in systematic philosophies like German Idealism.⁴⁰⁰ Ken Wilber is said to state that the most urgent problem in modern thought is to redirect the Western epistemological approach to a cultivation-based (Suryangnon) approach.⁴⁰¹

The appearance of Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) in Donghak Thought was, from the standpoint of orthodox Neo-Confucianism (Seongrihak), an unusual and heretical phenomenon, belonging to the category of "extraordinary phenomena, feats of strength, disorders, and spirits" (Goeryeoknansin). Suun's Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers seemed even more unusual because Suun's lineage belonged to the orthodox line of Korean Neo-Confucianism. Although Suun's birth as the child of a remarried woman (Jaeganyeo), lower than an illegitimate son (Seoeol), was unfortunate, the scholarly lineage of his father, Geunam Choe Ok (近菴 崔鑒, 1762-1840), belonged to the orthodox line among the master-disciple lineages of Toegye Yi Hwang (李滉, 1501-1570). The appearance of Sangje was an unusual situation not

³⁹⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

³⁹⁹ It is said that Jeongeup, where Daesoon Thought originated, had a tradition of substantialist Li-Qi theory (siljilon-jeok i-giron), specifically that of Iljae Yi Hang. Kim Ik-du, Choe Yeong-seong, Yi Seon-a, Kim Beom-su (authors), Iljae Ihangeui Sasang, Hangmun, Iron-e Gwanhan Saeroun Sikakdeul (New Perspectives on the Thought, Scholarship, and Theories of Iljae Yi Hang), Seoul: Munyewon, 2014.

⁴⁰⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. Li shu gao, chu yu wuji taiji zhi biao, bu li hu riyong shiwu zhi jian. The principle (i), though lofty, emerges from the surface of Taegeuk and Mugeuk, and does not depart from the midst of everyday (il-yong) affairs.

⁴⁰¹ Zhu Xi's expression 'Gakgu Taegeuk, Tongche Taegeuk (各具太極, 統體太極; Each thing possesses the Supreme Ultimate, the Supreme Ultimate encompasses the whole)' is connected to the Avatamsaka Sutra's concept of Jungjiung Mujin (重重無盡; infinitely interrelated layers). (Kim Jong-uk, "The Ecosystem and Dharmadhatu as Complex Systems," Cheolhak Sasang (Philosophical Thoughts) 41, 2011, pp.7-36)

only for Confucian scholars but also for the common people, yet surprisingly, Suun's Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers, in which he conversed with Sangje, was recognized regardless of social class. Donghak Thought overcomes this, supported by the many traditions of Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon).

Regarding the background of the wide acceptance of Suun's Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers, recent research points to the influence of Chinese Daoism, which was newly flowing in at the time of Donghak's emergence. In particular, the influence of Nandan Daoism (鸞壇道教, Phoenix Altar Daoism) in the late Joseon period has been highlighted. This is attributed to the less-known transmission of Chinese Daoism today; it is said that due to the chaos of the Qing dynasty, many Qing Daoist masters entered Joseon, and at that time, the first Daoist group called "Musangdan" (無相壇, Formless Altar) was formed in Joseon. Even King Gojong went so far as to publish Daoist scriptures as a national project. It is said that the background allowing Suun's Heavenly Master's Questions and Answers to be recognized as questions and answers with Sangje included the changing atmosphere of Joseon society at that time, due to the transmission of Nandan Daoism.⁴⁰²

The influence of Daoism on the establishment of Donghak also appears in the incantation training (Jumunsuryeon) and the Donghak Gasa (Songs of Donghak). It is said that Donghak could be accepted in a Confucian society due to the influence of Daoism, which was flowing in. Donghak Thought included Daoism, which encapsulated the traditional civilization of East Asia at that time. The "Donghak Gasa" can also be interpreted as "Gangpil" (spirit-writing) resulting from contact with Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings). It is said that Jeungsan (Kang Il-sun) also revealed the three essences of East Asian intellect—namely, the three Ki (energies): the knowledge of Shao Kangjie (Gangjeol), the poetry of Li Bai (Yi Taeback) and Du Fu (Dubu), and the eloquence of Su Qin (Sojin) and Zhang Yi (Jangui).⁴⁰³ In fact, Suun is later appointed by Jeungsan as the Jongjang (Patriarch) of the Later World's (Hucheon) Seondo (Way of Immortals), which is related to Daoism.⁴⁰⁴ This indicates that Donghak inherited the essence of Daoism. Jeungsan expressed this as Potae (Conception, 胞胎) in terms of the 12 Phases of Qi (Unseong), which is the function of Heaven and Earth (天地之用), and in concrete form, as "Johwa" (Creation-Transformation).⁴⁰⁵

⁴⁰² Jang Ip-mun et al. (authors), An Yu-gyeong (trans.), Riui Cheolhak (Philosophy of Li/Principle), Seoul: Yemunseowon, 2004, pp.30-36, 46, 49, 106.

⁴⁰³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-33. Wonhyong ijong, Daegyeong Daebeop, Do jeong Cheonji, Su jeong Cheonbeop, I jeong Simbeop. The Way (道) rectifies Heaven and Earth, the Numbers (Su 數) fix the Thousand Laws (Cheonbeop 千法), and the Principle (I 理) governs the mental teachings (Simbeop). (Choe Chi-bong, "A Study on Taeguk in Daesoon Thought," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Daesoon Thoughts) 23, 2014, p.403)

⁴⁰⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 2-42.

⁴⁰⁵ Contemporary Western 'thanatology' (death studies) has also come to acknowledge the existence of ancestral spirits (seonnyeongsin). Though originating in the hospice movement aimed at 'well-dying', modern Western thanatology, through tens of thousands of near-death experience cases, is demonstrating that in the West too, just as in the East, people encounter in the afterlife ancestral spirits they had never met during their lifetime. (Eben Alexander and Ptolemy Tompkins [co-authors],

In Eastern thought, the view of Heaven (Cheongwan) is related to the method of cultivation (Suryeon). In the method of cultivation, the view of Heaven has a concentrated aspect. The biggest characteristic of Donghak cultivation was incantation training (Jumunsuryeon). Even from the standpoint of orthodox Neo-Confucianism, this was exceptionally accepted. Incantations (Jumun) were also partially adopted in Confucianism, as in the case of the 'Jeongyeok' (Correct Change) in Yeonggamudo (Chanting and Dancing) or the case of Sijo (Korean classical poem) recitation. "Incantations" (Jumun), while already widely used in Buddhism as Yeombul (chanting), were exceptional in the mainstream Confucian society of Joseon, but this very exceptionality caused Donghak to spread even more widely.⁴⁰⁶ In the case of incantation training, although it was a universal cultivation method of all times and places, also used in modern Western spiritual training, in Korea's case, it was first introduced into the self-cultivation of the general public by Donghak and was later widely used in new religions.⁴⁰⁷

Confucianism also played a large role in the establishment of Donghak. Donghak is actually evaluated by Jeungsan as not having overcome the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism. First, Donghak emphasizes the role of Ki (氣), which is also emphasized in Neo-Confucianism, as seen in the content of the representative incantation Sicheonju's case, "Jigigeumjiwonwidaegang" (至氣今至願爲大降; May the Ultimate Ki descend greatly now).⁴⁰⁸ Like "Dogijangjonsaburip" (道氣長存邪不入; When the Ki of the Dao is preserved long, evil cannot enter), Donghak was in a position to emphasize "Ki" (氣) more than "I" (理, Principle), but in that Donghak rarely contains content about Daoist Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings) except for Sangje (the Supreme Ruler), it does not significantly deviate from the "Ki" at the Confucian level.⁴⁰⁹

Suun's view of Sangje, which does not emphasize Daoist Sinmyeong, also does not largely deviate from the influence of the Confucian view of Heaven. Ahn Yoo-kyung is said to state that although Donghak emphasizes "Ki," the background of Donghak's establishment shows a connection extending from the establishment of "I" (理, Principle) originating from Toegye (Yi Hwang) to Dasan (Jeong Yak-yong). It is said that Donghak was possible in Korea largely due to Toegye's influence.⁴¹⁰

Ko Mi-ra and Yi Jin [co-translators], *Naneun Cheonguk-eul Bo-atta* (Proof of Heaven), Paju: Gimyoungsa, 2013, pp.124-130, 190)

⁴⁰⁶ Michel Serres regards the concept of angels, just as the Eastern concept of Sinmyeong (divine spirits), not as a simple concept but as a decisive occasion that shapes the Western epistemological framework. (Michel Serres, Yi Gyu-hyeon (trans.), *Heolmeseu* (Hermes), Seoul: Minumsa, 2009, pp.299-303)

⁴⁰⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-55.

⁴⁰⁸ Baek Min-jeong, "The Thought of Jeong Yak-yong and Choe Je-u Compared through the Concepts of Shangdi (上帝) and Mind (心)," *Minjok Munhwa* (民族文化; National/Korean Culture) 61, 2022, p.149.

⁴⁰⁹ Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Scripture of Eastern Learning), "Nonhangmun" (Discussion on Learning).

⁴¹⁰ Son Byeong-uk, "A Comparison of the Cultivation Systems of Donghak and Buddhist Yeombul-Seon (念佛禪; Chanting-Meditation)," *Donghak Hakbo* (Journal of Donghak Studies) 23, 2011, p.107.

Overall, in Suun's understanding of Donghak, theoretical aspects such as the view of Sangje remain within the limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism, while in metaphysical (Hyeonggihakjeogin, below-form) aspects such as occult arts (Sulsu), Daoism was actively accepted. In fact, it is said that the power of "occult arts" (Sulsu) was also a significant factor in Donghak becoming widely known to the general public. Even in the Donghak Peasant Movement, one of the great strengths that allowed the movement to persist was the belief in occult arts.⁴¹¹

That Donghak was, on the metaphysical level, within the Confucian canon, while on the physical level it was adept at the occult arts of Daoism, in fact served to reinforce Donghak's Confucian canonical character all the more. As appears in Hwang Hyeon's (黃琰, 1855-1910) Ohagimun (梧下記文), Donghak was indeed joined by people of various classes, whose purposes for joining were extremely diverse. Jeungsan highly esteemed Jeon Myeong-suk (全明淑, 1855-1895), who strove for the emancipation of the lowborn even while being a fellow Donghak participant, and he saw through the fact that many Donghak participants outwardly cried out 'supporting the nation and comforting the people' (boguk-anmin) while inwardly dreaming of becoming kings, marquises, generals, and ministers (wanghu-jangsang). Those who joined Donghak coveting such high station judged that they could fully achieve their dreams within a Donghak skilled in the occult arts. Yun Yi-heum therefore holds that to the general populace Donghak appeared as an expansion of the thought of the Jeonggammok, and that it thereafter became a model for the new religions.⁴¹²⁴¹³⁴¹⁴

The influence of Buddhism on the establishment of Donghak was indirect. The influence of Buddhism is limited to the connection that the place Suun took refuge was Eunjeogam (hermitage), and that Donghak's incantations (Jumun) are similar to Buddhist chanting (Yeombul). The Donghak Peasant Movement also began to first activate when the Jeopju (local leader) Son Hwa-jung (1861-1895) removed the book written by Yi Seo-gu (1754-1825), which was inside the stomach of the Maitreya statue at Seonunsa Temple. However, beliefs in past lives and ancestors, such as the law of karma (Inyeonbeop), were not emphasized in Donghak, so the Haewon (Resolution of Grievances) thought, like that in Daesoon Thought, did not appear in Donghak Thought either.

What greatly influenced the establishment of Donghak, besides Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon), was Yin-Yang thought. Yin-Yang thought can also be included in the broad category of Daoism, but if considered separately, Donghak does not largely deviate from the Confucian Yin-Yang view, like the Heaven-Earth view appearing in the I Ching (Book of Changes) thought of Confucianism, that "Heaven and Earth are Gwisin (ghosts/spirits), and Gwisin are Heaven and Earth." Although Donghak

⁴¹¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 2-3.

⁴¹² The mural paintings of Daesoon Jinrihoe depict Oseon-wigi (Five Immortals Playing Baduk; 五仙圍棋), which represents Haewon Sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances and Mutual Beneficence), through the metaphor of a game of Go (baduk/wigi).

⁴¹³ Kim Yong-ok, Donggyeong Daejeon 2 (Great Scripture of Eastern Learning, vol. 2), Tongnamu, 2021, p.135.

⁴¹⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

began by emphasizing the Heaven outside of Heaven, criticizing Western Learning (Seohak) and Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon) and trying to transcend them, Donghak Thought, which failed to introduce concepts like Sinmyeong (Spiritual Beings), still does not largely deviate from Confucianism. This was a somewhat different character from the Yin-Yang view of Daesoon Thought, which emphasizes Sinmyeong.

It is said that Donghak was established not only against the ideological background of Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism, but also due to the influence of the fear of foreign powers and the resulting nationalist sentiment at that time, leading to the appearance of a consciousness of resistance against Western aggression during the port-opening period in the thoughts of Suun and Jeungsan.⁴¹⁵

I, too, was born in the East and received it in the East; so, although the Way (Do) is the Way of Heaven (Cheondo), the Learning (Hak) is Eastern Learning (Donghak).⁴¹⁶

Donghak expands from opposition against Japan to opposition against the West. It is said that after Donghak, the concept of "East" (Dong) changed from meaning Korea in relation to China to meaning the East (Orient) in relation to the West. However, Donghak, which began with the concept of "Hak" (Learning) as a social movement like "Seongrihak" (Neo-Confucianism), is said to have become internalized during the Japanese colonial period.⁴¹⁷

At the time of Donghak's establishment, the Donghak leaders' perception of the international situation was limited to the scope of China. The Donghak gasa (songs) show great hostility towards Japan, and this is also close to the Confucian convention of interpreting the world with China at the center.

Ultimately, Suun's understanding of Donghak is formed against the background of his turbulent life history, profound learning, and pure heart, as well as the influence of nationalism from the Jeonggammok, the will to abolish the caste system, and ignorance of the international situation. This background of establishment also has a significant impact on the subsequent development of the Donghak Peasant Movement. Donghak emphasizes gi (energy/spirit) rather than i (principle/reason) compared to Daesoon Thought, and Kim Ji-ha states that compared to Donghak Thought, Daesoon Thought emphasizes daily life.

The Donghak view of Heaven emerges as a solution within the conflict between the Western view of Heaven, which emphasizes the transcendent Heaven (Cheonoecheon, Heaven beyond Heaven) and does not emphasize the immanent Heaven divided into Heaven and Earth, and the Eastern view of Heaven, which emphasizes the immanent Heaven divided into Heaven and Earth and does not emphasize the transcendent Heaven (Cheonoecheon). The indigenous modernity of Donghak's view of Heaven, in this solution, reorganizes the sacred and the secular, encompassing and transcending the views of Heaven from all times

⁴¹⁵ 『朱子語類』 卷3, 中華書局, 33 夸."鬼神事自是第二著.那箇無形影底,是難理會底.末消去理會,且就日用緊切處做工夫".

⁴¹⁶ Choe Jin-deok, "The Li-Qi Theory (理氣論) and Ghost-Spirit Theory (鬼神論) in Zhu Xi Studies (朱子學)," Yangmyeonghak (Yangming Studies) 23, Korean Yangming Studies Association, 2009, pp.381-382.

⁴¹⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 2-16.

and places (East, West, past, present). Donghak's view of Heaven attempts to accommodate the strengths of Eastern Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon) to the fullest, while also seeking to embrace the merits of the Western view of Heaven. This duality possessed by Donghak's view of Heaven was previously termed panentheism by Kim Kyoung-jae and others. However, the existing panentheistic view has a shortcoming in that its background of emergence has not been sufficiently revealed through its connection with modernity.⁴¹⁸

Modernity was a matter of science in the West, but for Easterners, it was a matter of survival—whether or not to face ethnic cleansing. Today, the issue of modernity is discussed at an academic level, but at that time, modernity involved the problem of survival. Furthermore, today modernity has expanded beyond being an Eastern problem to become a problem of human extinction. The view of Heaven in Donghak Thought, established with difficulty, is revealed in various aspects.

Aspects of Liminality in the Siecheonju (侍天主) View of Heaven

At a time when indigenous modernity was needed, Donghak first proposed the concept of 'Mugeukdaedo' (Great Dao of the Ultimate Void) as a new view of Heaven. 'Mugeukdaedo' is related to the Heaven above Heaven, that is, the primordial universe. This can be compared to how Western modernity, in the situation of East-West conflict involving the invasions of Islam and the Mongols, developed into a new view of Heaven, namely atomism. Donghak's view of Heaven, which encompasses and transcends the Eastern and Western views of Heaven through the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond Heaven), repeats the phylogeny (phylogenesis) manifested in the Eastern and Western views of Heaven as ontogeny (ontogenesis). This shows the indigenous modernity of liminality, which is achieved by rearranging the boundaries of the sacred and the secular.

My body trembled violently; outwardly a numinous energy made contact, and inwardly words descended as teaching. I tried to see it but could not see it, I tried to hear it but could not hear it, so my mind grew all the more strange and doubtful. Composing my mind and rectifying my energy, I asked, “Why is it so?” [He] replied, “My mind is precisely your mind [吾心即汝心]. How could humans know this? They know Heaven and Earth but do not know the gods and spirits, yet the gods and spirits too are I. You have reached the infinite, boundless Way; cultivate and refine it, compose writings to teach people, and rectify the Law and spread virtue, and I shall cause you to live long and to shine throughout the world.” I too cultivated and pondered it for nearly a year, and found that there was nothing in it that was not a natural principle. So, on the one hand I composed an incantation, on the other a method for receiving the numinous energy [降靈, descent of the spirit], and on the other writings for not forgetting the Lord of

⁴¹⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 1-2.

Heaven (Cheonju); the procedure and method of the Way amounted to nothing more than the twenty-one characters [of the incantation].⁴¹⁹

The passage above is the part describing the time when Suun received the Boundless Great Dao (Mugeuk-daedo). What the 'Boundless Great Dao' is, and why Donghak can be expressed as the 'Boundless Great Dao,' appears clearly in the passage above from the Donggyeong Daejeon, "Nonhangmun." The part expressing Donghak as the Boundless Great Dao also appears several times in the Yongdam Yusa, but the passage above is the most detailed.⁴²⁰

Mugeuk (Ultimate Void) refers to the state even before Taeguk (Supreme Ultimate), which is the state before Yin and Yang were divided, and thus it is related to the primordial universe. From the perspective of the view of Heaven, it corresponds to the Heaven beyond Heaven, the Cheonoecheon. Therefore, Mugeukdaedo signifies the Dao of the Heaven beyond Heaven, surpassing existing Neo-Confucianism, which claimed to reveal the principle of Taeguk, Seohak (Western Learning), which claimed to reveal Cheonju (the Lord of Heaven), or Buddhism, which sought to realize the substance of the universe. Accordingly, as in the excerpt above, "You have reached the infinite and boundless Dao," Mugeukdaedo becomes the 'infinite and boundless Dao'.

The reason the Boundless Great Dao becomes the 'infinite, boundless Way' is explained in the passage above by "My mind is precisely your mind [吾心即汝心]." Here, "my mind (osim 吾心)" is the mind of the "heaven above heaven," that is, the heaven-beyond-heaven (cheonoecheon), while "your mind (yeosim 汝心)" is the human mind represented by Suun. This means that the mind of the heaven-beyond-heaven—that is, the mind of the Limitless (Mugeuk)—becomes precisely the human mind. Since this says that the mind of the heaven-beyond-heaven, which is the origin of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, is the same as the human mind, it means that humanity's status in the cosmos becomes that of a being whose mind communes with the Limitless; hence it becomes the "Boundless Great Dao."

The most significant difference between the conventional Mugeuk and Donghak's 'Mugeukdaedo' regarding the view of Heaven is the first appearance of 'Mugeuk', or Sangje (the Supreme God), who communicates directly with humans, as seen in the Cheonsamundap (Q&A with the Heavenly Teacher) and Gangpil (divine brush). Furthermore, in the early Cheonsamundap, Suun continuously doubted Sangje's intentions and pressed his own arguments, thereby conversely gaining Sangje's trust. Donghak's view of Heaven, as a Mugeuk that communicates directly with humans, appears as a view of Heaven that harmonizes the Eastern assimilative view of Heaven and the Western formal view of Heaven without conflict.

In the case of the East, 'Mugeukdaedo', in its very name, first typically manifests the tradition of Mugeuk-Taeguk-EumyangOhaeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements), which is representative of Eastern

⁴¹⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-6.

⁴²⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

correlative thinking. This aligns with the Eastern assimilative view of Heaven. The expression 'Mugeukdaedo, unprecedented in myriad ages' can be seen as meaning the completion of correlative thinking. Furthermore, the expression 'Mugeukdaedo' is also an expression that Donghak Thought inherits the correlative thinking of Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism (Yubulseon), which developed as religions in the East.⁴²¹ In reality, Yubulseon is based on the correlative thinking of the unity of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, and there have been preceding studies suggesting that Donghak's representative Sicheonju thought is a form in which Yubulseon, having developed in the direction of internalizing the absolute being, matures into a transcendent Heaven.⁴²²

Next, the case of the Western formal view of Heaven appears in Donghak's concept of 'Muwiyihwa' (natural transformation without action). "Muwiyihwa," used for the first time in Donghak, can be thought of as a concept linking Daoism's "Muwijayeon" (naturalness without action) and Seohak's "Johwa" (creation/harmony). Muwiyihwa has the significance of connecting the harmony within the realms of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, known as the harmony of Yin and Yang, to the harmony of the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) that connects the Creator and the Three Realms. Donghak revitalizes the concept of the personalistic Cheonoecheon as a Josaengja (Creator) who emphasizes the concept of creation within harmony. Suun, when interpreting the incantation, explained that 'Johwa' (creation) means 'Muwiyihwa' (natural transformation without action), and 'Jeong' (determination/fixation) means 'Hapgideok' (uniting with its virtue) and 'Jeonggishim' (fixing one's mind).⁴²³

It is said that the differentiating point between Donghak's view of Heaven and the traditional Eastern view of Heaven is the concept of "Johwa" (creation/harmony) that appears in Sicheonju. Johwa was a core keyword in Donghak Thought, a key theme that transcended the Eastern view of Heaven to connect the Eastern and Western views of Heaven.⁴²⁴

Johwa (harmony/creation) appears in various forms in traditional Eastern and Western thought. First, etymologically, it is an abbreviation for creation (changjo) and evolution (jinhwa); this appears variously as principles of being (doem) and becoming (saengseong), preservation and creation, and Yin and Yang. Second, in actual religious terminology, it appears as the harmony of Yin and Yang, the Johwasinjang (Harmonizing Divine Generals) of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, and so on. In Daesoon Thought, both Donghak Thought's 'Jakran' (disruption) and Daesoon Thought's 'Chiran' (alleviation/governance) are called

⁴²¹ Choe Su-un took pride in the fact that his seventh-generation ancestor Jin-rip (震立) had performed great meritorious deeds and died in battle during the Japanese Invasions (Imjinwaeran) and Manchu Invasions (Byeongja Horan), posthumously receiving the title of Minister of War (Byeongjo Panseo) and the posthumous name Jeonmu-gong. Through expressions in the "Ansimga" (Song of Solace) such as "You dog-like Japanese invader (倭敵)!" and "He too is an enemy," Choe Su-un cast Japan as an adversarial relationship. (Bak Gwang-su, Hanguk Sinjonggyo-ui Sasang-gwa Jonggyo Munhwa (The Thought and Religious Culture of Korean New Religions), Seoul: Jibmundang, 2012, pp.199-201).

⁴²² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 74.

⁴²³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 57.

⁴²⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-4.

Johwa, and it is said that the original name of the Johwaju (Lord of Creation), corresponding to the Creator in Seohak, was 'Gucheon Daewon Johwajushin' (Great Primal Lord of Creation of the Nine Heavens).⁴²⁵⁴²⁶

In the case of the West, "Harmony" was a key theme in the Bible, signifying "peace." In the Bible, harmony was a symbol of Heaven, meaning "order" and "peace." In Seohak and Eastern Daoism, harmony was also emphasized as an attribute of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity; however, the harmony of Seohak was a harmony of analytical thought, while the harmony of Daoism was a different harmony of correlative thinking. Anthropology has understood new combinations of opposing elements, such as harmony, as liminality, which signifies boundaries, but Donghak Thought connects the two types of harmony with a new correlative concept of harmony. The harmony of Donghak Thought appears distinguished as 'Sicheonju', 'Muwiyihwa', 'Cheonjigwisin' (Heaven-Earth spirits), and 'Naeyushinryeong Oeyugihwa' (Indwelling Divine Spirit, Externalizing Qi-transformation). These four types of harmony are concepts that connect the existing harmony of Daoism and Seohak; they are views of Heaven, but from the perspective of the transcendent Heaven, they correspond to the nature of Heaven and Earth, and thus can also correspond to the view of Earth.⁴²⁷

First, "Johwa" (harmony/creation) appears in Donghak Thought in the form of 'Muwiyihwa' (natural transformation without action).⁴²⁸ Looking at 'Muwiyihwa', it is said that Suun summarized the core of Donghak as 'Muwiyihwa'. Suun calls Donghak 'Muwiyihwa', and explains that Muwiyihwa refers to the entire harmonizing action of the divine Earthly Gi (energy), and that if one guards the mind, corrects the energy, follows one's innate nature, and receives the teaching, harmony emerges from within naturalness.⁴²⁹ He says the Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) he revered is the divine spirit (Shinryeong) of Gihwa (Qi-transformation) that presides over all things in the universe, and the god he received acts through the harmony of Muwiyihwa and is omnipresent everywhere in the world.⁴³⁰ He states, "Gi (energy) is

⁴²⁵ Gang Don-gu, *Hanguk Geundae Jonggyo-wa Minjokjuui* (Korean Modern Religion and Nationalism), Seoul: Jibmundang, 1992.; Bak Jae-hyeon, "The Characteristics of Daesoon Thought in the Modern Korean Period - Focusing on Super-Nationalism and Modern and Post-Modern Values," *Daesoon Sasang Nonchong* (Daesoon Thoughts) 24, 2014.

⁴²⁶ Hwang Jong-won, "A Critical Study on the Innaecheon Doctrine and Theory of Mind-Nature (Simseongnon) of Cheondogyo in the Early 20th Century," *Daedong Cheolhak* (Daedong Philosophy) 44, 2008, pp.92-93.

⁴²⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-47. Sa ji dang wang jae eo cheonji, pil bu jae in, yeon mu in mu cheonji, go cheonji saeng in yong in, i insaeng bul cham eo cheonji, yong in ji si ha ga wal insaeng ho. When any matter comes to be accomplished, its fundamental cause lies in Heaven and Earth, not necessarily in human beings. However, since Heaven and Earth would be useless without human beings, Heaven and Earth (Cheonji) bring forth people and make use of them. This being so, when Heaven and Earth wish to make use of people, if a person does not follow the will of Heaven and Earth, how can this be called a human life? (Gyomuby, "Cheonji Saengin Yongin" [Heaven and Earth Bring Forth People and Use Them], *Daesoon Hoebo* [Daesoon Newsletter] 13, 1989)

⁴²⁸ Yi Gyeong-won, "The Modernity and Transformative Thought of Daesoon Truth," *Donghak Hakbo* (Journal of Donghak Studies) 9(2): 43. 2005.

⁴²⁹ Yi Gyeong-won, *Daesoon Jonghak Wonron* (Fundamental Principles of Daesoon Religious Studies), Seoul: Munsacheol, 2013.

⁴³⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

Heoryeongchangchang (vacuous, spiritual, and vast), involved in all affairs, commanding all affairs, a single primordial Gi (Honwonhan Ilgi)."⁴³¹

Donghak's connection of East and West through Muwiyihwa is a process of attempting to mediate the dualistic opposition between tradition and modernity through liminality. In fact, it is said that Sangje as the Creator in the Eastern tradition, revealed in the Shijing (Book of Odes), shares five personalistic attributes with the Creator in the Book of Psalms in the Bible. Among these, phrases revealing the attribute as Creator are said to be clearly evident in Chinese classics through the Shuowen Jiezi (Explaining Graphs and Analyzing Characters) and the Shijing.⁴³²⁴³³⁴³⁴

Even after his communion with the personal Heavenly Spirit (cheollyeong), Suun, connecting it with Daoism, explains the teaching of the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju) in terms of the impersonal harmony and motion-principles of nature. When asked how Suun's experience differed from Western Learning (Yanghak 洋學, Seohak), he added that the heavenly fortune (cheonun 天運) is the same and the Way of Heaven (cheondo 天道) is the same, but that their principle [理] is different. The difference of principle that Suun mentioned can be seen as pointing to a difference in the method of learning—that is, a difference of 'learning (hak 學).'⁴³⁵

Suun's Cheonsamundap (Q&A with the Heavenly Teacher) also, conversely, allows one to guess the reason why Heaven chose Suun. Like Jesus who defeated the devil's temptations, Suun rejected all of Sangje's suggestions proposing realistic success, and even refused success through the existing Yubulseon (Confucianism, Buddhism, Daoism). The Donghak concept of Sicheonju (Serving the Lord of Heaven) is based on this background of sincere dialogue with Sangje. This relationship of trust expanded to the belief, during the Donghak Peasant Movement, that participants in the Donghak Peasant Movement could even block bullets.⁴³⁶

The reason Suun's Cheonsamundap could gain the trust of others was that Heaven chose the most problematic figure, like Suun, as the person through whom to reveal itself. Heaven appeared to Suun, a very intermediate being who was neither the existing establishment nor the lower class.

Suun was the most unfortunate Homo sacer that era could produce at the time. Although Suun had a father who was the most outstanding scholar in the most orthodox Neo-Confucian lineage, he had to live with the status of a descendant of a remarried woman (Jaeganyeo), lower than an illegitimate son (Seoja);

⁴³¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30.

⁴³² Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), "Chwinji" (Aims).

⁴³³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-19.

⁴³⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁴³⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-3.

⁴³⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-47. Sa ji dang wang jae eo cheonji, pil bu jae in. When any matter comes to be accomplished, its fundamental cause lies in Heaven and Earth, not necessarily in human beings. (Gyomuby, "Cheonji Saengin Yongin" [Heaven and Earth Bring Forth People and Use Them], Daesoon Hoebo [Daesoon Newsletter] 13, 1989)

furthermore, after his father passed away and even his house burned down, Suun had to wander the country to maintain his livelihood. Eventually, even wandering proved too difficult, and Suun returned home. People actually placed more trust in the fact that the one to whom Heaven appeared was a being like Suun. Although Suun was unfortunate, he also possessed an extraordinary nature no less than his father's, and he even had the ho (style name) 'Boksul', meaning he was skilled in divination arts (Sulsu).⁴³⁷

The difference between Donghak Thought's concept of harmony and the Western one is that it is a harmony of correlative thinking. In addition to preceding studies showing that the correlative thinking displayed by Donghak's Siccheonju thought, as a continuity and change of tradition, is more clearly revealed in the tradition of Yubulseon (Confucian, Buddhist, Daoist) thought, preceding studies from an epistemological perspective are also active. There are many preceding studies on the continuity and change of the epistemological aspects of correlative thinking in Donghak Thought, so an overview can first be examined through an analysis of those preceding studies.

To examine the preceding studies on correlative thinking in Donghak Thought, it is necessary to first understand the definition of correlative thinking. Correlative thinking, represented by Yin-Yang and the Five Elements (Eumyang Ohaeng), is correlative thinking that uses the term sanggwon (correlation), meaning parts are mutually related; however, the connection of parts to parts, and ultimately the connection of parts within the whole, can be called an organismic theory that views the whole and parts unitarily, or a holistic theory, or a holographic (Jeonshikjeok) perspective that examines parts from the viewpoint of the whole. In other words, correlative thinking, if defined broadly, includes organismic thinking or holographic (Jeonshikjeok) thinking.

If Eastern thinking, or correlative thinking, is expanded to include holographic theory (Jeonshikron) or organismic theory, the preceding research on Donghak from a correlative cognitive perspective expands into very extensive research both domestically and internationally. Having examined overseas cases earlier, if we look at the domestic cases, we can mention, in a narrow scope, the research of Lee Chang-il, who translated and introduced correlative thinking to Korea. Although not actively applied to Donghak Thought, Lee Chang-il's research introduced to Korea the main Western methodology for studying Eastern thought—that research on Eastern thought must primarily be approached through correlative thinking—and analyzed the philosophy of Shao Kangjie (So Gang-jeol), which greatly influenced Donghak Thought, using the methodology of correlative thinking.⁴³⁸

Although Donghak, through the term 'Gaebyeok' (Great Opening/Creation), seems to advocate an ideology disconnected from East Asian tradition, the definition of Donghak presented in Donghak Thought—as seen in "Nonhangmun" (Discussion on Learning), the text where the term 'Donghak' first

⁴³⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-47. Mansa bun i jeong, bu saeng gong ja mang. All matters have their portions already fixed, yet the people of the world busily move about to no avail. (Gyomuby, "Mansa Bun I Jeong" [All Matters Have Their Portions Fixed], Daesoon Hoebo [Daesoon Newsletter] 148, 2013)

⁴³⁸ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), p.7.

appears—defines Donghak as a learning based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, which is a representative theory of correlative thinking. In fact, Shao Kangjie, the Yin-Yang and Five Elements theorist of Neo-Confucianism, who was identified by theorists of correlative thinking as a representative theorist of correlative thinking, is also noted as a thinker who had a great influence on Donghak Thought.⁴³⁹ The term 'Dasi Gaebyeok' (Re-Creation/Re-Opening) in Donghak Thought was also a term widely used by late Joseon intellectuals who were under the influence of Shao Kangjie.⁴⁴⁰⁴⁴¹

If expanded to holographic theory (Jeonshikron) or organismic theory, pioneering domestic research on the correlative thinking manifested in Donghak Thought was conducted by Kim Sang-il. Kim Sang-il defines Donghak as 'New Western Learning' (Shinseohak) and interprets Donghak as a pioneering Eastern version of Whitehead's process thought. Afterward, Kim Sang-il names Eastern thought "Han Philosophy" (Hancheolhak) and expands Eastern thought to fractal science, theoretically developing the characteristics of Donghak's correlative thinking in comparison with the entirety of past and present Western thought.⁴⁴²

In the East, the most representative term in which 'creative transformation' (johwa) appears is Sicheonju (Bearing the Lord of Heaven). Donghak's view of Heaven, which appears as the Eastern Boundless Great Dao and the Western 'non-doing and self-transformation' (muwi-ihwa), is synthesized in Sicheonju. Sicheonju is especially the concept representing the view of Heaven in Donghak Thought. As appears in Donghak's representative incantation "Sicheonju Johwajeong," Sicheonju is the foundation of creative transformation. Researchers who have studied the commonalities between Donghak and Neo-Confucianism hold that the johwa of Donghak's Sicheonju is, in content, similar to johwa in the Neo-Confucian sense, and that it is the concept encompassing Donghak's other phrases "gihwa" and "muwi-ihwa." In Donghak's "Nonhangmun," 侍 (si, 'bearing') is glossed as "having the divine spirit within, the qi-transformation without, and each person in the world knowing this and not departing from it (內有神靈, 外有氣化, 一世之人, 各知不移)." This means that all people in the world realize that the meaning of "Sicheonju" is to possess a divine-spirited mind and a qi-transforming body, and maintain that state—that is, all alike return to unity (gwil 歸一) in the creatively evolving [造化] substance [體], namely the "utmost qi (jigi)." Therefore Sicheonju is precisely the returning of all to one body (donggwi-ilche) and is "creative transformation (johwa)."⁴⁴³⁴⁴⁴

In that Sicheonju is precisely immanent transcendence, Donghak Thought shares methods of cultivation with existing Confucianism and Daoism. However, Donghak Thought, unlike Confucianism,

⁴³⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-42.

⁴⁴⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁴⁴¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁴⁴² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

⁴⁴³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-19.

⁴⁴⁴ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), p.20.

substantivized the Ibeop (Principle-Law) similarly to Daoism, and unlike Daoism, a personal God, the Creator, appears. In the johwa (harmony/creation) of Donghak Thought through "Sicheonju," a "hidden God" appears, unlike in Confucianism or Daoism. In Donghak Thought, the aspect of creation is emphasized from the perspective of East-West convergence, more so than in the Daoist tradition where only the aspect of evolution within johwa was stressed.⁴⁴⁵

The common point "Sicheonju" shares with Seohak (Western Learning) is not only the appearance of a personal God but also the scene of encounter with that personal God. Regarding this, researchers emphasizing the commonality with Seohak say that Suun's Cheonsamundap (Q&A with the Heavenly Teacher) is similar to the experience of the Apostle Paul. It is said that in the past religious experiences of Koreans, there were no cases of directly encountering God like Suun did. From this point, Donghak's Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) is also evaluated as having been influenced by Christianity. However, Suun explains that he harmonized immanent transcendence, an Eastern method of self-reflection, with the traditional Korean belief in God (Haneunim).⁴⁴⁶

The indigenous modernity apparent in Donghak Thought's view of Heaven is the communication between the Cheonoecheon (Heaven beyond Heaven) and the human mind, and from this, the rearrangement of the sacred and the secular, namely, the emergence of a trans-boundary liminality. In terms of political and social thought, this also means the rise in status of making a commoner (sangnom) into an aristocrat (yangban), and the rise in status of the Earth and Humanity, which had been neglected in the relationship of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. Donghak's view of Heaven, which encompasses and transcends the Eastern and Western views of Heaven through the emergence of the Cheonoecheon, repeats the phylogeny manifested in the Eastern and Western views of Heaven as ontogeny, showing indigenous modernity through liminality.

Indigenous Modernity of the Johwajeong (Creation is Determined) View of Earth (Jigwan)

The Western Material (Jillyojeok) View of Earth (Jigwan)

The view of Earth (Jigwan) also changes depending on whether the view of Heaven (Cheongwan) emphasizes the transcendent Heaven (Cheonoecheon) or the immanent Heaven divided into Heaven and Earth. From the perspective of the transcendent Heaven, Ji (Earth) becomes an expression encompassing all of Heaven-and-Earth as divided from Heaven-and-Earth; and in the Western substance-oriented ontological worldview, which does not regard Heaven-and-Earth as the immanent Heaven of Yin and Yang, Heaven-and-Earth, especially the Earth, becomes a material existence where form is realized.

⁴⁴⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-11.

⁴⁴⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

The Western material view of Earth differed depending on whether it regarded the transcendent Heaven (Cheonoecheon) as Idea, as the One God, or as materialistic reason. Today's material Western view of Earth, which regards the transcendent Heaven (Cheonoecheon) as materialistic reason, has become an atomistic worldview.

Until the emergence of the modern atomistic worldview, which held that all things are composed of atoms and molecules that cannot be broken down further, the West, as seen in the case of Matteo Ricci, also engaged in the ontological correlative thinking of Earth, Water, Fire, and Wind (Jisuwhapung); however, the difference between the Western correlative worldview of Jisuwhapung and the Eastern correlative thinking of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements (Eumyang Ohaeng) was, as Jesuit priests like Matteo Ricci discussed, that Jisuwhapung was correlative thinking based on substance, whereas Eumyang Ohaeng was correlative thinking based on attributes.⁴⁴⁷ The atomistic worldview was a theory that maximized the substantialist attributes of Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) through analytical methods.⁴⁴⁸

Thales' worldview that "the origin of all things is water" is a representative example of substantialist correlative thinking, explaining all things through the substance of "water." Afterward, Empedocles' four-element theory was expanded, and the four-element theory was accepted by Plato and Aristotle, constituting the Western worldview up to Matteo Ricci. Earth, Water, Fire, and Wind (Jisuwhapung) were also applied in Plato's world of Ideas and Aristotle's theory of Form, forming a system where the fifth element, existing amidst the four elements, balances the other four.⁴⁴⁹⁴⁵⁰

Although Empedocles introduced Jisuwhapung, it had already been transmitted as a common worldview of the Indo-European language family before him; Jisuwhapung also appears in the cosmology of ancient Indian Brahmins, and the Buddhist worldview that inherited this is also composed of Jisuwhapung. Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) even influenced China, becoming the Chinese theory of the Three Calamities (Samjae) of Water, Fire, and Wind. In the worldview of the Abhidharmakośa-sāstra, where the Buddhist view of the heavenly realms appears, the world is depicted as an existence floating on the wheel of Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind), and above it, "Geumgangsān" (Diamond Mountain), also called "Cheorwisan" (Iron Encircling Mountain), defends the center of the universe, and above that center, Mount Sumeru exists, forming 28 heavens. This Jisuwhapung view of the heavenly realms combines with the Chinese Daoist view of the Three Powers (Samjae) to become 36 heavens, and it also appears in the later Daesoon Thought's view of the heavenly realms.⁴⁵¹⁴⁵²

⁴⁴⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁴⁴⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 1-10.

⁴⁴⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 1-54.

⁴⁵⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-35.

⁴⁵¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 1-42.

⁴⁵² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

What allows Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) to be connected to the Western correlative theory of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is the correlative principle inherent in Jisuwhapung. Another commonality that appears throughout the Indo-European language family is the tripartite functional system, which was revealed by Dumézil. Dumézil revealed that the background for the development of the Indo-European mythology's tripartite functional system into the European views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is that the tripartite functional system and Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) are composed of the same principles of ascent and descent.⁴⁵³

Dumézil states that in the anthropological structure of the Indo-European imaginary, the religious function of the upper level, the military-political function of the middle level, and the production-aesthetic function of the lower level appear in the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. Dumézil revealed that the three functions of the three goddesses appearing in the Trojan War of Greco-Roman mythology—Hera (religion), Athena (politics), and Aphrodite (production)—are the same as the Mitra-Varuna-Aryaman structure of Indian mythology. The tripartite functional system also appears in a structure similar to the Buddhist Three Realms (Samgye) of Kāmadhātu (Realm of Desire), Rūpadhātu (Realm of Form), and Ārūpyadhātu (Realm of Formlessness).⁴⁵⁴

Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) and the tripartite functional system originated in Central Asia and widely influenced both East and West. That influence also appears in East Asia's Samjae (Three Powers) of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. The Eastern Three Realms (Samgye)—namely, the Heavenly Realm (Cheongye), Earthly Realm (Jigye), and Human Realm (Ingye)—which are based on the Heaven-Earth-Humanity Samjae, are similar to the Western tripartite functional system in spatial division, but differ in that they emphasize "attributes" rather than "substance." Although they are the same "Su" (Water) and "Hwa" (Fire), the "Su" and "Hwa" of Jisuwhapung and the "Su" and "Hwa" of Eumyang Ohaeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) being different is a difference of substance and attribute. Therefore, if the two systems are compared, the functions of "Su" (Water) and "Hwa" (Fire) may appear opposite to each other.

The Western material view of Earth, in the sense that the form of the Heaven beyond Heaven (transcendent Heaven) is realized, contributed to the development of modern material civilization. However, the Western material view of Earth, biased toward matter, completely collapsed the divine realm system (Shinmyeongchehye) of the new universe, becoming a catalyst that instead led the world to the brink of annihilation and became the starting point of the crisis of modernity.

The Eastern Condensational (Eungchukjeok) View of Earth (Jigwan)

⁴⁵³ Dang Hyeon-seon, Jilberey Dwirangui Sangsanggye Yeongu (A Study on Gilbert Durand's Imaginary), Master's thesis, Hongik University Graduate School, 2009, pp.28-30.

⁴⁵⁴ Bak Jeong-jin, (Yesul Illyu Hak Seosel) Hanguk Munhwa Simjeong Munhwa ([Introduction to Art Anthropology] Korean Culture and the Culture of Simjeong [Heart-Mind]), Miraemunhwasa, 1990, pp.130-146.

Unlike the Western material view of Earth, which appeared differently as a material view of Earth according to the attributes of the Heaven above Heaven (transcendent Heaven)—such as Idea, the One God, or materialistic form—the Eastern condensed view of Earth appears in three different ways according to the transcendent Heaven, the immanent Heaven divided into Heaven and Earth, and the role of the Cheonjishinmyeong (Spirits/Gods of Heaven and Earth).

First, when Heaven (Cheon) is seen as the transcendent Heaven, Earth (Ji) encompasses all of Heaven-and-Earth, and Heaven-and-Earth, as the concept of Earth relative to Sangje (the Supreme God) who is the transcendent Heaven, appears as Shinmyeong (Divine Spirits) who execute Sangje's will of Cheonjihwayuk (Transformation and Nurturance of Heaven and Earth) by dividing the roles. At this time, Heaven plays the role of assimilation, and Earth plays the role of condensation, so Earth becomes the existence that realizes the Gi (energy) of Heaven and Earth as form, or a vessel (Gi). In Yeokhak (I Ching studies), this has been expressed as Geon (Heaven) and Gon (Earth). As the roles are divided, the shin (spirit/god) of Heaven takes on the role of assimilating, and the shin of Earth takes on the role of condensing. However, since the Shinmyeong (Divine Spirits) who perform those roles are appointed from Heaven, traditionally, the shin of Heaven has been described as Cheonshin (Heavenly God), the shin of Earth as Jigi (Earthly Spirit/Indicator), and in the case of humans, In'gwi (Human Spirit/Ghost).⁴⁵⁵

Today, the Samjae (Three Powers) of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity and Eumyang Ohaeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) establish a common theoretical system and emphasize "attributes" more than "substance." Yin-Yang, Samjae, and Ohaeng (Five Elements) each express the relationship between Heaven and Earth from different perspectives. In the case of Yin-Yang, it is further divided: on one hand, there is Yin-Yang as a material concept of Earth, similar to the West, which includes a formal transcendent Heaven and an immanent Heaven-and-Earth; on the other hand, similar to the East, it is divided into the assimilative Heaven, which emphasizes the immanent Heaven, and the condensed Earth. On the other hand, Samjae (Three Powers) has the aspect of integrating both these Eastern and Western views of Heaven. That is, the transcendent Heaven, the immanent Heaven, and the immanent Earth gather as three to form the Sam-Taegeuk (Triple Supreme Ultimate) Samjae. Ohaeng (Five Elements) becomes an expanded concept where this Yin-Yang and Samjae meet, the Samjae view becomes Yin-Yang, and Yin-Yang becomes the Samjae view. If the origins of the three thoughts are traced, it appears that the three thoughts met from different starting points. It is not clear from which side Jisuwhapung (Earth, Water, Fire, Wind) and

⁴⁵⁵ The Yin-Yang Five Elements theory (Eumyang Ohaengseol) has both positive and negative aspects; in the case of Western scholars, they evaluate the Yin-Yang Five Elements as objectively as possible, appraising them at least as a primitive form of science. Representative figures include Marcel Granet, Angus Graham, Benjamin Schwartz, and Joseph Needham. (Kim Gi, "A Study on the Aspects of Application of Yin-Yang Five Elements Theory in Neo-Confucianism (Zhu Xi Studies)," doctoral dissertation, Sungkyunkwan University, 2012, p.4) On the other hand, Eastern scholars tend to regard Yin-Yang Five Elements as more superstitious. (Bang In, "Yin-Yang Five Elements Theory [陰陽五行說] as a Form of Ancient Chinese Cosmology [宇宙論]," *Jonggyo Yeongu* [宗教研究; Journal of Religious Studies] 4, 1988, p.71)

Eumyang Ohaeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) influenced the other, but in their mutual relationship, the thoughts of Yin-Yang, Ohaeng, and Samjae arose, and they appear combined in the aspect of attributes.⁴⁵⁶

Since the Eastern Heaven, Earth, and Humanity (Cheon, Ji, In) involve ontogeny repeating phylogeny, Geon-geon Gon-sun (Heaven is strong, Earth is receptive), which explains the relationship of Heaven and Earth, means that Earth's condensation includes Heaven's assimilation. Traditionally, the Eastern Way of Gon (Earth, 坤道) appears in detail in the Yeokjeon (Commentaries on the I Ching).

Supreme indeed is the Originating Power of Kun (坤元, Earth)! All things owe their birth to it, and thereby it obediently continues the Way of Heaven (天道). The thick virtue of Kun (坤), which bears all things, is without limit; embracing, broad, brilliant, and great, it causes all things to attain to full prosperity.⁴⁵⁷

In the excerpt above, Earth appears, through the action of Gon, as the action of a vessel and form that condenses the Gi (energy) assimilated by Heaven. From the perspective of Lee Young-ran's interpretation of liminality, this is Heaven (1) developing into Earth (1+2) through liminality.⁴⁵⁸

In traditional East Asian mythology, the division of the Heavenly Realm (Cheongye), Earthly Realm (Jigye), and Human Realm (Ingye) appears originating from the Gonggong (共工) clan, who were the most civilized people during the Yao and Shun era.⁴⁵⁹ According to artifacts and records, it is said to appear from the Warring States period. Like the underground civilization gods (Jihamunmyeongshin) appearing in Daesoon Thought, the Gonggong clan, the first civilized people of East Asia, appears in mythology as underground gods (Jihashin).⁴⁶⁰ The appearance of civilization gods underground stems from the correlative thinking that views Heaven and Earth correlatively.

The Earth viewed from the perspective of the immanent Heaven is much more related to life and its importance is magnified, compared to the Earth viewed from the perspective of the transcendent Heaven. Pungsujiri (Feng Shui) and Jesa (ancestral rites) were icons of traditional culture. In ecology, the Earth is emphasized as being as important as Heaven today. Pungsujiri, which can be called the indigenous geography of East Asia, was the traditional East Asian view of Earth, and this appeared in Eumyang Ohaeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) as the importance of To (Earth), which signifies the center of Eumyang Ohaeng. The reason correlative thinking is important in the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity is that correlative thinking provides the basis for Sangsaeng (mutual beneficence/coexistence). The importance of the Earth occupies a major part of the Sangsaeng-oriented views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. In particular, the rise in status of the Earth, which had more capability but a lower status—

⁴⁵⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁴⁵⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-14.

⁴⁵⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-1.

⁴⁵⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 3-53.

⁴⁶⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

namely, Jeongeumjeongyang (Correct Yin and Correct Yang)—becomes central also for the Haewon (resolution of grievances) of humanity, that is, Sangsaeng. The great difference between Donghak Thought's 'Dasi Gaebyeok' (Re-Creation) and Daesoon Thought's 'Samgye Gaebyeok' (Creation of the Three Realms) also lies in Sangsaeng. Daesoon Thought's Samgye Gaebyeok discusses Sangsaeng, and for Sangsaeng, it discusses Haewon. Haewon is possible through the Shinmyeong (Divine Spirits), and Sangsaeng is achieved through Haewon after the balance of Yin and Yang status is achieved.

In the traditional East Asian view of Earth, the importance of the Earth appeared in the term represented by the word Cheonji (Heaven-Earth). Representatively, Cheonwonjibang (Heaven is round, Earth is square) does not refer to the erroneous claim of the geocentric theory (Cheondongseol), which was revealed by the heliocentric theory (Jidongseol), that the sky is round; rather, it can be said to be an abbreviation for "Cheondojiwiwon Jidojiwibang" (The Way of Heaven is called Round, The Way of Earth is called Square), referring to the one-dimensional nature of "Ju" (duration), which represents time, and the two-dimensional nature of "U" (expanse), which represents space. The Heaven of the Juyeok (I Ching) is called "Geon" (乾), and this "Geon" (dry) represents the dry attribute of time, which performs the "Sae Eul" (乙, second heavenly stem) action.⁴⁶¹

Samcheon-Yangji (Three Heavens, Two Earths) is a core concept of the Juyeok, meaning Heaven moves by the principle of 3 and Earth by the principle of 2. The Juyeok has understood Heaven, Earth, and Humanity (Cheonjiin), which symbolize nature, as the family relationship of father-mother-son, and has abundantly created propositions contrasting the attributes of Heaven and Earth, corresponding to father and mother. Samcheon-Yangji (Three Heavens, Two Earths), Cheonwon-Jibang (Heaven Round, Earth Square), Cheonjang-Jigu (Heaven lasting, Earth enduring), and Cheondo-Jideok (Way of Heaven, Virtue of Earth) all indicated that the father-Heaven signifies Sam (Three), Won (Round), Jang (Lasting), and Do (Way), and the mother-Earth possesses the attributes of Yang (Two), Bang (Square), Gu (Enduring), and Deok (Virtue). The complex-system interpretation of Cheonjiin (Heaven, Earth, Humanity) and psychoanalysis can be said to be almost similar to the Oedipus Complex. The Sam-su Bunhwa (three-number differentiation) system, as a complex-system understanding of psychoanalysis, can be seen as a part of fractal aesthetics, and the symmetry possessed by the Sam-su Bunhwa system was a fundamental proposition of Greek aesthetics.

In traditional thought, Earth played a role as one axis of the correlation with Heaven and Humanity. Traditional thought was understood as theology or mythology rather than as indigenous modernity, but there was a movement to understand it as indigenous modernity through Daejonggyo (Great Ancestral Religion) and others. The three-number differentiation system is a system that views all things as a

⁴⁶¹ Yi Eo-ryeong, *Dijirogeu: Hangugin-i Ikkeyneun Cheomdan Jeongbo Sahoe, Geu Miraereul Ilkneun Keyword* (Digilog: The Keyword for Reading the Future of the Advanced Information Society Led by Koreans), Seoul: Saenggak-ui Namu, 2006.

complex-system expansion of the three components: Heaven, Earth, and Humanity.⁴⁶² The three-number differentiation system has been recognized as the common inner structure of all things in the West as Kant's three-element system, Freud's father-mother-son, Father-Son-Holy Spirit, and in the East as the Cheon-Ji-In system. The three-number differentiation system is common to both East and West from the perspective of the symmetry possessed by the Oedipal structure.⁴⁶³ The three-number differentiation system integratively illuminates the humanities, social sciences, and natural sciences.

Jeong Jaeseo states that Chinese mythology is an anti-Oedipus mythology, distinct from Western mythology. In Christian theology, Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven-Earth-Humanity) theology is emerging as a theology that emphasizes not only the role of the father but also the roles of Earth and Humanity.⁴⁶⁴ The opportunity to integrate the emphasis on the roles of Earth and Humanity in ecological theology, etc., with existing theology appears in the Dangun myth and the Cheon-Ji-In thought, which is Korea's unique three-number differentiation worldview.⁴⁶⁵ However, since Cheon-Ji-In theology is also a Christian theology without a Daoist view of divine beings, it cannot go so far as to claim that the god of the Earth is a god like a mother.⁴⁶⁶ Heo Ho-ik mentions Yoon Sung-bum, Kim Kwang-sik, Park Jong-chun, Yu Dong-sik, Lee Jung-yong, Lee Eun-sun, and Seo Nam-dong as theological researchers related to Cheon-Ji-In theology.⁴⁶⁷ Kim Heup-young, with similar logic, requests a shift from existing theology—Logos-centered theology emphasizing the father, Praxis theology centered on the mother—to a desirable theology, Do (Tao)-theology emphasizing the universe-Christ, which emphasizes the third party.⁴⁶⁸ Lee Eun-sun, as a feminist scholar, sometimes interprets the characteristic of Korean theology, along with Hwang Pil-ho, as the *gajong* (adding religion) of Cheon-Ji-In.⁴⁶⁹

⁴⁶² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 46.

⁴⁶³ Kim Ji-ha, (Mihak Gangui) Huin Geuteul-ui Mihageul Chajaseo ([Aesthetics Lectures] In Search of the Aesthetics of White Shadow), Seoul: Silcheon Munhaksa, 2005.; Kim Ik-du, "Reconciliation and Mutual Beneficence (Sangsaeng) in East Asian Thought — The Ideological Movements of Modern Jeollabuk-do and Their Development," Proceedings of the 93rd Academic Conference of the Society for Ancient East Asian Studies, 2023.

⁴⁶⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-66.

⁴⁶⁵ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), "Hunhoe" (Precepts).

⁴⁶⁶ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), "Sinjo" (Creed).

⁴⁶⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-6.

⁴⁶⁸ Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam), "Dodeokga" (Song of Virtue).

⁴⁶⁹ Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Scripture of Eastern Learning), "Jwajam" (Seated Admonition). O do bak i yak, bul yong da eon ui, byeol mu ta do ri, seong gyeong sin sam ja. Our Way is broad yet simple; there is no need for many words. There is no other path — it is but three characters: Seong (sincerity), Gyeong (reverence), and Sin (faith).

⁴⁷⁰ A. N. Whitehead, D. R. Griffin and D. W. Sherburne, Process and Reality, New York: Free Press, 1929. pp.10-11. Cited in Roger Ames and David Hall (authors), Jang Won-seok (trans.), Ilsangsa-e Chocheom Matchugi: Jungyong-ui Beonyeok-gwa Cheolhakjeok Haeseok (Focusing on Everyday Affairs: A Translation and Philosophical Interpretation of the Zhongyong [The Doctrine of the Mean]), Seongnam: Academy of Korean Studies Press, 2019. pp.50-51.

⁴⁷¹ Nam Hyo-on (author), Bak Dae-hyeon (trans.), Chugang Jip (Collected Works of Chugang), Seoul: Minjok Munhwa Chujinhoe, 2007, vol. 5, 35b.

⁴⁷² Hanguk Sasangsa Yeongu-hoe (Korean Intellectual History Research Association), Joseon Yuhak-ui Gaenyeomdeul (Concepts of Joseon Confucianism), Yemunseowon, 2002.

The concept of yin-yang, which allows Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate) to be understood as a complex-system scientific concept of creation and preservation principles, was first proposed by the Chinese philosopher Mou Zongsan, who studied Eastern philosophy ontologically. He states that while Western philosophy understands a personal God through the concept of 'substance' (實體), Chinese philosophy understands the Way of Heaven (天道) through the concept of 'function' (作用). He says that when viewed from the perspective of such function, Geon-won (Creative Principle of Heaven) is the principle of creativity, and Gon-won (Receptive Principle of Earth) becomes the so-called principle of preservation. Since Daesoon Thought states that Taegeuk originates from the circle (Won), this aligns with Mou Zongsan's view of Taegeuk as the function of circular motion, and since it views all things as complex-system circular motion, it can be said that it viewed Taegeuk as the basic principle of a complex system. It can be said that symmetry, asymmetry, and supersymmetry arise from circular motion.⁴⁷⁷

Unlike the West, which views Earth as the material for form from the Heaven-beyond-Heaven, the Eastern view of Earth, as the place where the practice of the transcendent Heaven's creative transformation is condensed, did not regard Earth as an object of domination and conquest like the West, but rather regarded it as an object of worship, as in Pungsu-jiri (Geomancy). However, as Neo-Confucianism excluded the transcendent Heaven, the Eastern Earth was relegated merely to the partner of the immanent Heaven, and Eastern correlative thinking became fixed. As Western substantial thinking had a tendency to strengthen the keynote of sanggeuk (mutual conflict), the two views of Earth came to clash in the modern era.

The Collision and Mutually Overcoming Conflict (Sanggeukhwa) of Eastern and Western Views of Earth (Jigwan)

The Clash of Views of Earth (Ji-gwan)

To Easterners who regarded Earth as an object of worship, Westerners who treated Earth as material came as a great shock. The two forces, which had been mutually balanced, rapidly tilted toward the West after Matteo Ricci. The East-West clash regarding the view of Earth appeared largely in two stages. The first was the worldview clash presented by the material view of Earth based on the transcendent Heaven, which appeared in Matteo Ricci's *The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven* (Cheonju Sil-ui), and the

⁴⁷³ Kim Yun-gyeong, *Hanguk Dogyosa* (History of Korean Taoism), Seoul: Munsacheol, 2020.

⁴⁷⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁴⁷⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁴⁷⁶ Go Hoe-min (author), Gwak Sin-hwan (trans.), *Sogangjeol-ui Seoncheon Yeokhak* (Shao Yong's [Shao Kangjie's] Anterior Heaven Yi Studies), Seoul: Simsan, 2007.

⁴⁷⁷ In practice, the concept of Wonhyong Ijeong (Yuan Heng Li Zhen; Origination, Flourishing, Advantage, Correctness) is used to refer to the four common attributes of cyclical periods such as spring-summer-autumn-winter, morning-noon-evening-night, and early youth-young adulthood-middle age-old age. It is said that, like an infinitely layered cycle, every single thing and every single matter contains Wonhyong Ijeong. (Yun Yong-nam, "Reconsidering Zhu Xi's [朱子's] Theory of Li [理說]," *Dongyang Cheolhak Yeongu* [東洋哲學研究; Studies in East Asian Philosophy] 8, 1988, pp.52-54)

second was the material clash that occurred when the West, having retreated from the East after the Boryu-ron (Supplementary Confucianism) debate, reappeared with weapons.

First, looking at the worldview clash, it was a clash between the ontological worldview presupposed in the Western material view of Earth and the condensational view of Earth inherent in the Eastern view of Earth. Although the Eastern I-Gi-ron (Theory of Principle and Material Force) was the closest ideology among Eastern thoughts to Aristotle's ontology, it collapsed under Matteo Ricci's criticism because Aristotle's four-element theory (earth, water, fire, wind) and four-cause theory seemed to explain God logically well at the scientific level of the time.⁴⁷⁸ At the scientific level of the time, the Eum-Yang O-Haeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) theory and the I-Gi-ron, which did not separately recognize substance, became illogical theories according to Aristotle's theory.⁴⁷⁹

When compared with the West's earth, water, fire, and wind, the relationship between To (Earth element) and Mok-Hwa-Geum-Su (Wood-Fire-Metal-Water elements) in Eum-Yang O-Haeng is a part where East and West clearly differ.⁴⁸⁰ The West's earth, water, fire, and wind also had a fifth element, ether, which played the same role as the To (Earth element) of the East's Eum-Yang O-Haeng. However, the West's fifth element was a separate existence from earth, water, fire, and wind, like the monotheistic God, whereas the To of Eum-Yang O-Haeng was different in that it was an immanent existence that, while being a separate existence, also operated together with Wood, Fire, Metal, and Water.⁴⁸¹ Shao Kangjie's (Sogangjeol) Eum-Yang O-Haeng relationship between divine beings and humans is re-examined later because it could simultaneously accommodate the transcendent Western relationship and the immanent Eastern relationship between divine beings and humans.

When Matteo Ricci criticized Eum-Yang O-Haeng, he argued that, unlike earth, water, fire, and wind, the Eum-Yang O-Haeng theory could not be interpreted by Aristotle's four-cause theory.⁴⁸² The four-cause theory was regarded as the most rational Western theory for explaining the universe until the 17th century, when Matteo Ricci lived. Although Matteo Ricci was also a top-level scientist of his time, his criticism of Eum-Yang O-Haeng was not from the standpoint of atomism, but from the theory of earth, water, fire, and wind, which, from today's perspective, does not seem much different from Eum-Yang O-Haeng.⁴⁸³⁴⁸⁴

⁴⁷⁸ Choe Jin-deok, "The Li-Qi Theory (理氣論) and Ghost-Spirit Theory (鬼神論) in Zhu Xi Studies (朱子學)," Yangmyeonghak (Yangming Studies) 23, Korean Yangming Studies Association, 2009, pp.381-383.

⁴⁷⁹ Do gi jang jon sa bul ip, segan jung in bu dong gwi. If the energy of the Way is preserved for long, evil (satuk) cannot enter; and one shall not wander about like the common people of the world.

⁴⁸⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 2-3

⁴⁸¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 1-34

⁴⁸² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38. Dong yu daeseong in wal donghak, seo yu daeseong in wal seohak. In the East there is a great sage who says: [it is] Donghak; in the West there is a great sage who says: [it is] Seohak (Western Learning). (Gyomuby, "Dolbyeongpung" [Stone Screen], Daesoon Hoebo [Daesoon Newsletter] 119, 2011)

⁴⁸³ Hanguk Sasangsa Yeongu-hoe (Korean Intellectual History Research Association), Joseon Yuhak-ui Gaenyeomdeul (Concepts of Joseon Confucianism), Yemunseowon, 2002.

To the contemporary Eastern intellectuals who first encountered an ontological view of nature after Buddhism, earth, water, fire, and wind, although a correlative way of thinking, came as a great shock, enough to lead to the collapse of their worldview. The biggest problem in the Eastern acceptance of Western Learning (Seohak) was the issue of ancestral rites. For the West, the Rites Controversy was a matter of the Holy See's stance, but the newly emerged Eastern followers of Western Learning had to believe in Western Learning at the risk of their lives. The clash of worldviews seemed to result in an Eastern victory due to the prohibition of Western Learning.

The next material clash appeared rapidly around the time Su-un founded Donghak (Eastern Learning). China's defeat to the West, such as in the Treaty of Beijing, was a shock as if the sky was falling. As vividly depicted in Lu Xun's (1881-1936) *The True Story of Ah Q*, the shocked Chinese people, fearing they would face ethnic cleansing under Western rule, reached a state of schizophrenia, akin to "spiritual victory." China faced the experience of Heaven collapsing once again, just as the feudal system of the Zhou Dynasty collapsed during the Warring States period. It was like the situation where all Americans had to tremble at the threat of Russian nukes when the Soviet Union sent a rocket to the moon. It is said that Su-un was able to learn about Western information early through his wandering life. In the *Yongdam Yusa* (Songs of Yongdam), there are parts that well describe the clashes of that time. Accordingly, indigenous modernity emerged as a very urgent issue in the East.

The Mutual Conflict (Sanggeuk-hwa) of the Heaven-Earth Relationship

The change in the views of Heaven and Earth also changed the traditional Heaven-Earth relationship. First, in the case of the West, Matteo Ricci's introduction of Eastern culture led to the introduction of the East's immanent views of Heaven and Earth into Western civilization, which consisted of transcendent views of Heaven and Earth, resulting in the rapid development of science and technology. Eum-Yang O-Haeng, originally devised to explain the attributive relationship of Heaven and Earth, crossed over to the West and was applied to the natural sciences explaining substantial relationships, bringing about the development of science and technology. In the West, after Matteo Ricci, new scientific concepts different from Aristotelian science, such as mass, element, volume, gravity, and velocity, were introduced, rapidly applied to science and technology, and society quickly became capitalist.⁴⁸⁵

Although material civilization developed as immanent Heaven was introduced into science and technology, in the case of the West, the Heaven-Earth relationship, represented by the fifth element and

⁴⁸⁴ Kim Seon-hui, "The Theistic World as Seen by Confucian Scholars," *Proceedings of the Korean Association for the Study of Religion*, Korean Association for the Study of Religion, 2014; Jeon Seong-geon, "The Theological Possibility of Dasan's Theory of Yeongji (Spiritual Knowledge)," *Proceedings of the Korean Association for the Study of Religion*, Korean Association for the Study of Religion, 2014)

⁴⁸⁵ Go Nam-sik, "Patterns and Significance of Japan-Related Records in the Kang Jeungsan (姜飢山) Transmission in the Modern and Contemporary Period: Focusing on Daesunjeongyeong (大巡典經) (1929-1965)," *Ilbon Geundae Hak Yeongu* (Journal of Modern Japanese Studies), 2023.

earth, water, fire, and wind, rather degenerated into a sanggeuk (mutual conflict) relationship between the monotheistic God and all things. Subsequently, the Heaven-Earth relationship becomes even more characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict) with an atomistic worldview, where even the correlative attributes of earth, water, fire, and wind have disappeared. Modern science removed the attributes of earth, water, fire, and wind from the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity under the pretext of objectivity, but from the aspect of sanggeuk (mutual conflict), objectivity can also be seen as a pretext.

In the case of the Heaven-Earth relationship, the sanggeuk-hwa (mutual conflict) of the earth-water-fire-wind Heaven-Earth relationship appears as cheonjon-jibi (Heaven revered, Earth base) towards the monotheistic God. In the Western concept of earth, water, fire, and wind, Heaven corresponds to the fifth element, and Earth corresponds to earth, water, fire, and wind. At the time earth, water, fire, and wind appeared, the fifth element was the central element connecting the existing earth, water, fire, and wind, as seen in the movie "The Fifth Element." This fifth element was replaced by reason, namely material and profit (財利).

The West's fifth element is similar in role to the East's 'To' (Earth element) concept, but the West is different in that, unlike the East, the fifth element is a transcendent solid (three-dimensional entity). The West developed more than the East by recognizing the solid (three-dimensional entity) through the concept of the fifth element. However, the problem is that the West failed to connect this fifth element back to being immanentized as a plane, but rather remained fixed in the solid (three-dimensional entity). As the fifth element combined with Christianity, the fifth element became fixed as transcendence.

In the case of the West, the sanggeuk-hwa (mutual conflict) of earth, water, fire, and wind appears as particle theory. Earth, water, fire, and wind, deprived of their status as divine beings, are now relegated to components like atoms and molecules, placed under human domination. The relationship between Heaven and Earth becomes jeolji-tongcheon (severed from Earth, communicating with Heaven), their mutual relationship is severed, humans seek to dominate, and Heaven and Earth, renamed as nature, become beings that take revenge on humans, as described in ecology.

The Eastern Heaven-Earth relationship, which rejected the Western transcendent Heaven, also rapidly became fixed. The Heaven-Earth relationship, with the transcendent Heaven excluded, became fixed as the element of liminality was omitted. The classic Eastern Heaven-Earth relationship, represented by cheonwon-jibang (Heaven round, Earth square), cheonmun-jiri (astronomy and geography), etc., becomes characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict) through the cheonjon-jibi (Heaven revered, Earth base) and yangjon-eumbi (Yang revered, Yin base) Heaven-Earth relationship.⁴⁸⁶

The traditional Eastern Heaven-Earth relationship of Eum-Yang O-Haeng is also excluded by the worldview of eogeum-jonyang (suppressing Yin, revering Yang) and yangjon-eumbi (Yang revered, Yin

⁴⁸⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-4.

base), despite the situation of jijon (Earth revered) where divine beings are enshrined on Earth. The Heaven-Earth relationship was a horizontal corresponding relationship, as in the concepts of I-reum-i-ryang-ji-wi-do (One Yin and One Yang is called the Dao), cheondo-jideok (Heaven's Way, Earth's Virtue), and cheonwon-jibang (Heaven round, Earth square), but as history progressed, the cheonjon-jibi (Heaven revered, Earth base) relationship became formalized. In the East, although it was known to be the era of jijon (Earth revered) according to the concepts of sinbong-eo-cheon (divine beings enshrined in Heaven) and sinbong-eo-ji (divine beings enshrined on Earth), the jijon divine beings enshrined on Earth were relegated to objects of fortune-seeking (gibok), known as myeongdang (auspicious sites).

In the case of the East, the progression of sanggeuk-hwa (mutual conflict) as cheonjon-jibi (Heaven revered, Earth base) is, contrary to the case of earth, water, fire, and wind, attributed to the forgetting of the Sangje (Supreme Ruler) concept due to the immanentization of To (Earth element). In the case of the Eum-Yang O-Haeng views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, the sanggeuk-hwa (mutual conflict) Heaven-Earth relationship appears as the substantialization of To (Earth element). The To (Earth element) concept of Eum-Yang O-Haeng, which originally signified both Heaven and Earth, becomes characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict), the concept of Heaven fades, and it is relegated to the concept of Earth. The exact opposite sanggeuk-hwa (mutual conflict) to that of the West, where the fifth element was extremist as the monotheistic God, unfolds in the Eum-Yang O-Haeng Heaven-Earth relationship. As seen in the Baopuzi's To-geuk-su (Earth overcomes Water), To (Earth element) in Eum-Yang O-Haeng is a core element, like the yin-yang of the five elements. This materialization of To-geuk-su (Earth overcomes Water) is only converted into revitalization in Daesoon Thought.⁴⁸⁷

Liminality in the Johwajong (造化定) View of Earth in Donghak Thought

Donghak Thought's Johwajeong (Fixing the Creation-Transformation) View of Earth (Ji-gwan)

In accordance with Donghak Thought's emphasis on the transcendent Heaven, Donghak Thought also shows a view of Earth (Ji-gwan) different from the existing view of Earth. If Heaven is assumed to be the Heaven-beyond-Heaven, i.e., the transcendent Heaven, then Earth appears as the existing Heaven-and-Earth, i.e., the object of the transcendent Heaven's creation-transformation, the existence of muwi-ihwa (non-acting transformation) and gihwa (material force transformation). Therefore, in Donghak Thought's view of Earth, the meaning of Earth is not clearly revealed, and concepts such as johwa (creation-transformation), muwi-ihwa (non-acting transformation), and gihwa (material force transformation) are emphasized.

While Donghak Thought's view of Heaven (Cheon-gwan) began with the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master), Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) is gradually formed as Su-un's deep contemplation and experience follow after the cheonsa-mundap. Su-un's extensive

⁴⁸⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 1.

experience and knowledge fuse with the cheonsa-mundap and become established as the view of Earth (Ji-gwan).

In reality, the establishment of Donghak Thought was influenced not only by the West, namely Western modernity, but also by the immanent development of Eastern thought. While the external environment surrounding Donghak Thought was as such for the establishment of Donghak's indigenous modernity, internally, there was an influx of Nandan-doggyo (Luntan Daoism), etc., established in modern China. It has been studied that the influence of Daoism was emphasized not only in the formation of the view of Heaven (Cheon-gwan) but also in the view of Earth (Ji-gwan).

Looking at this in detail, it can be divided into the influx of Tongsin Daoism (通神道教, Spirit-Communicating Daoism) and Naedan Daoism (内丹道教, Internal Alchemy Daoism). The existing Daoism introduced to Joseon was Naedan Daoism, focused on cultivation, as seen in Bukchang Jeong Ryeom's (北窓 鄭礪, 1506-1549) Yongho Bigyeol (Secret Teachings of the Dragon and Tiger) or Gwon Geuk-jung's (權克中, 1585-1659) Juyeok Chamdonggye Juhae (Commentary on the Book of Changes and the Triplex Unity). However, after the Imjin War (Japanese invasions of Korea, 1592-1598), faith in Guan Yunchang (Guan Yu) was introduced, and the Okchu Bogyeong (Precious Scripture of the Jade Pivot), which was banned in China, became widely spread through shamanism and other channels, leading to the widespread dissemination in Joseon of Tongsin Daoism and Nandan Daoism—Daoism that communicates directly with gods through incantations and talismans—as opposed to Naedan Daoism. Tongsin Daoism, which emphasizes communication with gods, and Nandan Daoism, which has a name related to talismans, have different names but share the commonality of emphasizing gods compared to Naedan Daoism. Chronologically, Naedan Daoism was introduced earlier than Tongsin Daoism. While Naedan Daoism was primarily transmitted to the yangban (nobility), Tongsin Daoism influenced the masses. The introduction of these two types of Daoism into the Neo-Confucian-centric Joseon society was not widely known, but they had as much influence on the intellectual society of the time as Seohak (Western Learning). It is also said that many Daoist masters migrated to Korea from China during the chaotic period of the Qing Dynasty.

The newly introduced Daoism showed a new development in Joseon in connection with Western Learning (Seohak). At that time, as appears in the records of foreigners who came to Joseon in the late Joseon period, the people of Joseon had lost all hope and, their will to labor exhausted, most of the populace had given up on work. At the 'Haemi International Catholic Shrine,' one of Korea's representative Catholic sites, there are many graves of common people who were martyred, such as the 'Yaso (Jesus) graves.' Since it was a time when, for the common people, death was better than life if only it were guaranteed, the communicative Daoism of Nandan Daoism and the Lord-of-Heaven faith of Western Learning won great response from the common people.

The traditional value system centered on Neo-Confucianism, which had been accumulated over a long time, faced a crisis, and Joseon society as a whole was facing an identity crisis. In Joseon's case, an identity

controversy arose as Cheonju Sil-ui (The True Meaning of the Lord of Heaven) and Seohak Jungwon-ron (Theory of Western Learning Originating from China) were accepted simultaneously. As seen in the case where Yeonam Park Ji-won (朴趾源, 1737-1805), while serving as the county magistrate of Myeoncheon in 1798, persuaded and leniently released Catholics, the Neo-Confucian intellectuals of the time were well aware of the methodological differences between Seohak (Western Learning) and Donghak (Eastern Learning) and had much interest in Seohak.

Accordingly, the newly introduced Daoism attracted attention as a response to Seohak (Western Learning). The influx of Nandan Daoism also explains why some segments of the yangban class accepted Donghak's rituals of incantations and spiritual talismans, which were unconventional for the time, without significant resistance. Even during the Donghak period, groups centered around some yangban that independently practiced cultivation related to Nandan Daoism also appear in the later denominational histories of Donghak or Daesoon. In the end, Donghak is an ideology presented amidst the clash of Eastern and Western worldviews, as the harms of Western modernity were exposed, and with the aim of saving the endangered East.

If the background of Donghak Thought's establishment includes the Eastern origins of Western modernity, the influx of Nandan Daoism, and the prevalence of Seohak (Western Learning), then in terms of correlative thinking, the conceptual establishment of Donghak Thought appears largely in the order of Donghak (Eastern Learning), Mugeuk Daedo (Great Dao of the Ultimate Void), Cheonji Gwisin (Heaven-Earth Ghosts-Spirits), and the Dasi Gaebyeok (Re-Opening) of the Sangwon-gap (First Cycle). Although much preceding research has been conducted on the establishment of Donghak in chronological order, not much has been done regarding the order of conceptual establishment, making it somewhat difficult to grasp the outline of Donghak Thought. The history of concepts is particularly important when comparing the two ideologies.

Looking at the order of conceptual establishment above, first, in the case of 'Donghak,' preceding research explains the reason Su-un adopted the term "Donghak" from two main standpoints. First, it is said to be represented by the meaning of Donghak (Eastern Learning) as opposing Seohak (Western Learning), and second, by the stance of Donghak as integrating Eastern and Western learning.⁴⁸⁸⁴⁸⁹⁴⁹⁰

Although Daoism's influence was significant in the background of the establishment of Donghak's view of Earth, the actual establishment of the view of Earth occurred with the development of Donghak Thought after Su-un's year-long contemplation following the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master). The development of Donghak Thought, examined in relation to the establishment of

⁴⁸⁸ 'Sindo' (Divine Way) is regarded as the ultimate reality and also as the basis for Haewon Sangsaeng (Resolution of Grievances and Mutual Beneficence). (Kim Ui-seong, Daesoon Sasang-ui Cheolhakjeok Tamgu [大巡思想의 哲學的探究; A Philosophical Inquiry into Daesoon Thought], doctoral dissertation, Sungkyunkwan University, 2017)

⁴⁸⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 73.

⁴⁹⁰ Daesoon Jichim (Daesoon Directives), Chapter 1, Section 1.

indigenous modernity, appears largely in four stages. The first stage is when the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master) disappears and he writes at Eunjeogam (Hermitage of Seclusion); the second stage is when he only teaches the method to avoid siseok (execution); the third stage is the one leading to the Donghak Peasant Revolution after Su-un's death; and the fourth stage is the transition to Cheondogyo (Religion of the Heavenly Way) after the failure of the Donghak Peasant Revolution.

If the establishment of Donghak Thought was from the mystical experience on April 5, 1860, to Eunjeogam, then the development of Donghak Thought can be said to be from after Eunjeogam to the establishment of Cheondogyo. The Donghak Gasa (Donghak Songs) are established from the cheonsa-mundap (conversations with the Heavenly Master) and Su-un's writings up to his arrival at the Daegu governor's office (Daegu Gamyong) in 1864, as well as the memories of Choe Si-hyeong and the Donghak followers regarding lost materials. In Daesoon Thought, it is also said that Su-un was receiving the Cheonmyeong (Heavenly Mandate) and Singyo (Divine Teaching) during this period. It is said that Su-un, after attaining the words of the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju) for himself on the 15th day of the 9th month of the Gyeongsin year (1860), no longer needed to have the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master).⁴⁹¹ It is said that it was from this time that Su-un was encouraged by Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) to propagate the Way (podeok), proclaimed "Donghak," and began writing the Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Eastern Scripture) and Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam).⁴⁹² Consequently, the later Donghak heavily reflected Su-un's thought.

In the Jeon-gyeong, it is said that Su-un's understanding of Donghak Thought, which developed subsequently, was initially an excellent understanding containing the three gi (energies)—the knowledge of Shao Kangjie (Kangjeol), the poetry of Li Bai (Ibaek) and Du Fu (Dubo), and the eloquence of Su Qin (Sojin) and Zhang Yi (Jang-ui)—but unfortunately, as it failed to overcome the limitations (jeonheon) of Confucianism, the Cheonmyeong (Heavenly Mandate) and Singyo (Divine Teaching) were inevitably

⁴⁹¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-34.

⁴⁹² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43. Su saeng eo hwa, hwa saeng eo su, geum saeng eo mok, mok saeng eo geum, gi yong ga yong yeon hu, bang ga wi sin in ya. Eum sal yang saeng, yang sal eum saeng, saeng sal ji do, jae eo eum yang, in ga yong eum yang yeon hu, bang ga wi in saeng ya. In wi yang, sin wi eum, eum yang sang hap yeon hu, yu byeon hwa ji do ya. Bul cheuk byeon hwa ji sul, do jae eo sin myeong, gam tong sin myeong yeon hu, sa gi sa cheuk wi ji dae in dae ui ya. Water (Su 水) arises from Fire (Hwa 火), Fire arises from Water, Metal (Geum 金) arises from Wood (Mok 木), and Wood arises from Metal; only after one understands the functioning (Yong 用) of these can one be called a Divine Person (Sinin 神人). If Yin is killed, Yang lives; if Yang is killed, Yin lives; the path of creation and destruction (Saengsal 生殺) lies in Yin and Yang. Only after a person can properly employ Yin and Yang can that person be called a human being (insaeng). People become Yang and spirits (Sin 神) become Yin; only after Yin and Yang are mutually harmonized is there a path of transformation (Byeonhwa). Otherwise, all arts of transformation (Bangsul 方術) lie with Sinmyeong (Divine Spirits), and if, after achieving communion (Gamtong 感通) with Sinmyeong, a matter is accomplished, this is called Great Benevolence and Great Righteousness (Daein Daeui 大仁大義). (Yang Mu-mok, "Salvation Truth [救援真理] as Yin-Yang Unity of Virtue [陰陽合德] and Democracy [民主主義]," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Daesoon Thoughts) 2, 1997, pp.175-176)

withdrawn.⁴⁹³ In reality, on the 28th day of the 10th month of the Gyehae year (1863), after having a dream at his birthday banquet, Su-un only came to hear the method of avoiding arrows through the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master).⁴⁹⁴ It is said that upon parting with Choe Si-hyeong, Su-un could no longer even know the method to avoid arrows, and Sangje's assistance was cut off. Su-un was arrested in Gyeongju on December 20, 1863, by Jeong Un-gu (鄭雲龜), a seonjeon-gwan (royal envoy) sent by the royal court. It is said that Su-un actually did not expect his own arrest at this time at all. In the Dowon Giseo (Record of the Origins of the Way), which contains the content of Choe Si-hyeong's meeting and Q&A with Choe Su-un, there is the following record.

Before long, the 28th day of the 10th month arrived, marking his 40th birthday. "Although the Teacher (Seonsaeng) originally felt uncomfortable holding banquets" (including Sinsa), the disciples secretly prepared and arranged a large feast at the Yeongdeok-jeop (gathering place). The Teacher, upon receiving the feast table, picked up his spoon and chopsticks and said, "The world shall call me Cheonhwang-ssi (Mr. Heavenly Emperor)." Cheonhwang-ssi refers to the first emperor who opened the era of culture from the pre-cultural era. It is interpreted that the Great Divine Teacher (Daesinsa) claimed to be Cheonhwang-ssi in the sense that he himself had opened a new world again. After the feast table was cleared, the Great Divine Teacher (Daesinsa) received lectures (gang) one by one from the disciples on the <Heungbiga> (Song of Rising Joy) and then told them about a strange dream he had a few days prior. "In the dream, the killing energy (salgi) of the sun shone, then turned into fire and drew the character in (人, person) on my thigh for a long time. When I woke up and examined my thigh, a purple mark remained, and it did not fade for three days. After that, there were no more teachings from Sangje (the Supreme Ruler)."⁴⁹⁵

The mention of Cheonhwang-ssi (Heavenly Emperor) appears in Daesoon Thought in connection with Geumsan Temple. It is a coincidence that the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master) ceased from the day he said he would be called Cheonhwang-ssi. It is also said that Su-un boasted that if one practiced Donghak cultivation, one would tong (attain enlightenment/mastery) within three years, and these parts are related to the limitations (jeonheon) of Confucianism.⁴⁹⁶

From Eunjeogam, Su-un began to leave records of the Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam) and the Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Eastern Scripture), and various places in the Yongdam Yusa and Donggyeong

⁴⁹³ It is said that the concept of Yin and Yang emphasized and pursued in Daesoon Thought advocates Jeong-eum Jeong-yang (Correct Yin Correct Yang; 正陰正陽) and the unity of virtue (Hapdeok 合德) through harmony, and shows that through this an ideal world can be constructed. (Yi Ho-yeol, Daesoon Sasang-ui Eumyang-non-e Gwanhan Yeongu [大巡思想의 陰陽論에 관한 연구; A Study on the Yin-Yang Theory of Daesoon Thought], Master's thesis, Daejin University, 2015)

⁴⁹⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-3.

⁴⁹⁵ Fan Chi asked about wisdom. The Master said: 'Devote yourself to promoting what is right for the people; respect the spirits and demons (guishen) while keeping them at a distance — this may be called wisdom.' (Lunyu [Analects], "Yongye" [Chapter 6])

⁴⁹⁶ Yu Ji-yeon, "Hwang Hyeon (1855-1910)'s Perception and Critique of Donghak: Focusing on Ohagimun [梧下記文; Jottings from Under the Paulownia Tree]," Iwon Haksullonzip [梨院學술논집; Ewha Academic Anthology] 2, 2004, pp.1-54.

Daejeon state that Su-un's recording work was done in a half-dreaming, half-awake state, similar to the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master). If so, like the Jeon-gyeong phrase, "The three gi (energies) are revealed in the Donghak Gasa (Songs)," it means that the Yongdam Yusa and Donggyeong Daejeon also contain much content of the Cheonmyeong (Heavenly Mandate) and Singyo (Divine Teaching). Donghak Thought researchers refer to the Donghak from 1860 to 1864 as early Donghak. The Daesoon Thought related to the Donghak Thought, as claimed by Daesoon Thought, extends up to early Donghak.⁴⁹⁷

Whereas the indigenous ideologies of most colonized countries end up as the ideologies of minority groups, Donghak Thought developed into a new religious movement of the general public. The establishment period of Donghak was a perilous situation for the baekseong (common people) who were ignorant of the international situation, so Donghak became an important opportunity to gather the baekseong who had nowhere to rely on.

Donghak Thought developed into a peasant movement in Gobu, which was suffering the most severe exploitation at the time. At that time, Donghak's jeopju (local leaders) were distributed throughout the country, and when the Gyojo Sinwon Undong (Movement to Exonerate the Founder) occurred and the influence of the Donghak religion became known to the world, it became an object of suppression and, at the same time, an opportunity for vitalization.

Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) is acquired as a result of Su-un's continuous cultivation, as seen in Su-un's comment criticizing Seohak (Western Learning) for believing in Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) without the "gihwa-ji-sin" (spirit of material force transformation). Just as Heaven and Earth all correspond to Earth (Ji) from the perspective of the transcendent Heaven, human cultivation also becomes the domain of johwa (creation-transformation) and gihwa (material force transformation), so Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) is established by Su-un's continuous cultivation.

The change from the Eastern view of Earth (Ji-gwan), which regarded the given land as the view of Earth, to a view of Earth verified through cultivation was a groundbreaking change for its time. In a Confucian society where only the king could receive the Earth's gi (energy) and perform rites to the Earth, the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) that common people could communicate with the transcendent Heaven through cultivation becomes the starting point of indigenous modernity, where the boundary between the sacred and the secular is reorganized.

Liminality Aspects of the Johwajeong (Fixing the Creation-Transformation) View of Earth (Ji-gwan)

The Western modernity's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) and Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) appear in mutually opposing aspects. The Western modernity's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) starts from the

⁴⁹⁷ Kim Gi-seung, "A Chronological Review of the Works of Su-un Choe Je-u," Donghak Hakbo (Journal of Donghak Studies) 3, 2002, pp.159-162.

heliocentric theory, which is moved by the immanent Heaven, breaking from the geocentric theory, which is moved by the transcendent Heaven. In the heliocentric theory, the action of the immanent Heaven takes precedence over the will of the transcendent Heaven. The heliocentric theory, stating that the Earth rotates, not the Heaven, is called a Copernican Revolution and brought about a change that overturned all existing values. Values previously believed to be determined according to God's providence were all subjected to doubt. Sociologically, the heliocentric theory became the theoretical foundation of modernity, with the meaning that the person who works is more important. Donghak Thought also presents the Earth, presided over by the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju), not as the subsidiary nature of the past cheonjon-jibi (Heaven revered, Earth base), but as an existence of life that must be served like the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju).⁴⁹⁸

Furthermore, in Donghak Thought, Earth is interpreted as the action of the transcendent Heaven. In Donghak Thought, where the transcendent Heaven is newly emphasized, the concept of Earth from existing Eastern thought is expanded to the entire action of the transcendent Heaven's johwa (creation-transformation), gihwa (material force transformation), and muwi-ihwa (non-acting transformation). Therefore, compared to the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) in existing Eastern thought, the life-thought (saengmyeong-sasang) is prominent in Donghak Thought's view of Earth. Accordingly, Donghak has attracted attention in later generations as a life-thought and an environmental-thought.

As Donghak is re-examined as a life-thought, Donghak's emphasis on Earth is also re-examined. Today's Korean organic farming method originated from Donghak Thought's Earth-centered thought. However, in Donghak Thought itself, the mention of Earth is not emphasized. Here, Donghak refers only up to early Donghak, so only early Donghak will be considered. What is considered Donghak are the Donghak Gasa (Donghak Songs) and Su-un Gasa (Su-un's Songs).

Heaven and Earth are also gwisin (ghosts-spirits), and gwisin are also yin-yang; how could the worthy gentlemen (hyeon-in gunja) know this, not knowing it as such (Yongdam Yusa, Dodeokga - Song of Morality).⁴⁹⁹

The above example, when applied to Earth, means that Earth is elevated to a yin-yang relationship with Heaven. The yin-yang of the Book of Changes (Juyeok) did not emphasize the expression gwisin

⁴⁹⁸ The great fortune of mountains and rivers all returns to this Way; its source is deepest and its principle extends most far. One must firmly establish the master of the mind (Simju), and then one will know the taste of the Way; when every thought dwells in this, all affairs will go as one wishes. Sweep away murky energy and nurture the clear energy as tenderly as raising a young infant. It is not only a matter of the mind being utmost; it lies only in rectifying the mind. Subtle brilliance naturally emerges in a divine manner, and all things coming in the future will return to one principle. Do not deliberate in your own heart over another's small faults; rather, bestow your own small wisdom upon others. In this way, do not apply great devotion to small matters regarding the great Way. When facing great matters and using all your discernment, help will naturally come. The great fortune of wind and clouds follows one's capacity. The mysterious mechanism does not appear, so do not be hasty in heart. On the other day when merit is accomplished, one will gladly form the destiny of an immortal. The heart-mind is originally empty; even when responding to things, it leaves no trace. Cultivate the heart-mind and you will know virtue; virtue is revealed only in the Way. It lies in virtue, not in other people; it lies in faith, not in study; it lies in what is near, not in what is far; it lies in sincerity, not in seeking — it seems not so, yet it is so; it seems distant, yet it is not distant. Cheondogyo Scriptures (Cheondogyo Gyeongjeon)

⁴⁹⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 3-41.

(ghosts-spirits), thus concealing the importance of Earth. In reality, in Donghak, the first person Su-un propagated the Way (podeok) to was his wife, who symbolized Earth, and he made cherishing women's rights the beginning of Donghak cultivation. The above example from Donghak Thought has hitherto been studied as an expression of the Neo-Confucian view of Earth (Ji-gwan), mainly due to the influence of traditional thought. Although Donghak did not overcome the limitations (jeonheon) of Confucianism, if we infer from the concepts of "jigi" (ultimate energy) and "Mugeuk Daedo" (Great Dao of the Ultimate Void), the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) in Donghak Thought shown in the above example implies the concept of "Ji-gye" (Earthly Realm), similar to Daoism.⁵⁰⁰

Although it has been much emphasized that Donghak commonly implies Daoist elements such as yeongbu (spiritual talismans) and incantations, it has not been emphasized that Donghak also implies the Daoist view of Earth (Ji-gwan). Although Donghak's concept of the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) did not expand to the Ji-gye (Earthly Realm) by applying divine beings, it implied that possibility due to the influence of Daoism, which accommodates the Ji-gye. The above expression "Heaven and Earth are gwisin (ghosts-spirits)" is a concept that also appears in Neo-Confucianism, but in Donghak Thought, which accommodates Daoism, it can be interpreted as expanding beyond the Neo-Confucian concept to the Daoist concept of the Ji-gye (Earthly Realm).

The Daoist concept of the Ji-gye (Earthly Realm) implies the infinite expansion of the yin-yang concept. The infinite expansion of the yin-yang concept signifies a polytheistic system. The Daoist view of Earth (Ji-gwan) implies a polytheistic system (多神體系). However, although it is called polytheism, the Hindu polytheistic system and the Daoist polytheistic system are distinguished from the Hindu polytheistic system in that they have the consistency of the infinite expansion of the yin-yang principle. The Hindu polytheistic system also has room to be interpreted as an infinite expansion of the Indo-European traditional three-function system.

Therefore, the above expression "Heaven and Earth are also gwisin (ghosts-spirits)" is a phrase showing that Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan), like its view of Heaven (Cheon-gwan), shows a view of Earth different from Seohak (Western Learning), possessing the principles of the divine-being realm wherein the Daoist bureaucratic system is inherent. The above example shows that Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) is a new view of Earth, different from the dry view of Earth (Ji-gwan) of materialistic Seohak (Western Learning) which excludes spirit, and also different from the Neo-Confucian view of Earth (Ji-gwan) which moves only according to the system of ibeop (principle-law).

Furthermore, the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) in Donghak Thought shown in the above example shares the commonality with the Daoist view of Earth (Ji-gwan) in being an infinite expansion of yin-yang, but it is different from Donghak Thought in that the Daoist view of Earth (Ji-gwan) does not emphasize the principle according to the Heaven-beyond-Heaven. Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan), which

⁵⁰⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-11.

emphasizes the Heaven-beyond-Heaven, emphasizes the variability of the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) compared to the Daoist thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan). While the Daoist thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) emphasizes the lawfulness according to the principle of geon-gon (Heaven-Earth), Donghak Thought's view of Earth (Ji-gwan) emphasizes the variability by the Heaven-beyond-Heaven. Furthermore, Donghak Thought, in its concepts of Sicheonju (Serving the Lord of Heaven) and jigi (ultimate energy), shows that Earth is also a world that follows the principle of the Lord of Heaven (Cheonju), and thus is a harmonistic view of Earth (Ji-gwan) that can respond to the human who practices Sicheonju.

Donghak Thought, which defined the Earth as a total system of divine spirits (Sinmyeong) following the command of the Heaven above heaven, Sangje, further re-established the center and periphery of the Earth. Donghak Thought implies that the center of the Earth could be Korea, where Sangje appeared, by designating Korea as the location of the Myeongdang (propitious site). This is expressed as Myeongdang, and Myeongdang expands into the issue of Sojunghwa (Minor Sinocentrism) and Daejunghwa (Greater Sinocentrism). In Neo-Confucianism, the Myeongdang was China, and there was an ideology of Korea as Sojunghwa (Minor Sinocentrism), but Donghak emphasized that Korea is the Myeongdang. The content of Donghak's view of Earth, like its view of Heaven, was very innovative, but its value was hidden, and that value is clearly revealed in Daesoon Thought's view of the Earthly Realm (Jigyegwan).

Aspects of Liminality in the Animistic (鬼神論的) Heaven-Earth Relationship in Donghak Thought

Donghak's view of Heaven, which first provided the idea of "serving Heaven," has received the most attention in Donghak Thought. Prior research on the characteristics of Donghak Thought's view of Heaven is largely divided into formal aspects and content-related aspects.

In terms of formal aspects, Donghak Thought's view of Heaven is represented by the view of Heaven-and-Earth based on the traditional Yin-Yang theory that "Heaven and Earth are Gwisin, and Gwisin are Heaven and Earth." The identity of Heaven-and-Earth and Gwisin mentioned in Donghak Thought is the same in expression as the identity of Gwisin and Heaven-and-Earth spoken of in Confucianism, but there is a significant difference in whether the Heaven-and-Earth of the concept is the transcendent Heaven or the immanent Heaven. As the concept of Heaven (Cheon) in Donghak Thought expands to Cheonoecheon (Heaven outside of Heaven), the existing concepts of Heaven-and-Earth and Gwisin are also newly repositioned. Expressions emphasizing the identity of Heaven-and-Earth and Gwisin as the transcendent Heaven appear variously in Donghak Thought.

In Donghak Thought, the concept of Gwisin, which was previously used only as the immanent Heaven, is first applied to the transcendent Heaven.

They know Heaven and Earth, but they do not know Gwisin (spirits/gods); that Gwisin is also Me.⁵⁰¹
(知天地而無知鬼神, 鬼神者吾也)

In the above excerpt, the meaning of "that which is called Gwisin is also I" shows that the term Gwisin, known only as the action of Yin and Yang, i.e., as the Heaven within Heaven-and-Earth, is actually by the action of the Heaven outside of Heaven, the Cheonoecheon. In Donghak Thought, Gwisin as the Cheonoecheon gives spirit (Simnyeong) to the human mind, offering hope that humans are beings who can escape the Heaven-and-Earth filled with suffering. This concept of Gwisin as Cheonoecheon is also used as a criticism against Seohak (Western Learning), which knows only the Cheonoecheon and not the immanent Heaven.

"They speak as if they see Sangjenim (the Supreme God) in the Okgyeongdae (Jade Capital Terrace) in Heaven; setting aside the principles of Yin and Yang (Eumyangirchi), is this not just empty talk (Heomusijiseol)? The Mugo (sorcery) affair of the Han dynasty has been transmitted to our East, and what every household reveres is, by every name, a Gwisin. Look at this kind of perception! That Heaven and Earth are also Gwisin, and Gwisin are also Yin and Yang; since they did not know this, what is the use of examining the scriptures (Gyeongjeon)? Since they did not know the Dao and virtue, how could the worthy scholars (Hyeoningunja) know?"⁵⁰²

In the above excerpt, "They speak as if they see... is this not just empty talk?" is a criticism that Seohak's view of Heaven—which knows the Cheonoecheon but lacks the concept of the immanent Heaven divided into Heaven-and-Earth—lacks the Yin-Yang principles of the immanent Heaven through which one experiences the actual workings of Heaven, and thus can only be making empty claims of baseless wishes. On the other hand, Donghak Thought claims to have presented an integrated perspective capable of penetrating the content of the scriptures by adding the Cheonoecheon view of Heaven, which was lacking in the East, onto the foundation of Eastern thought that valued the immanent Heaven.

Here, Seohak is compared to the Mugojiwha (sorcery catastrophe) of the Han dynasty, which deluded the people by emphasizing power over principle. Mugo refers to an effigy resembling a human body, made of straw, wood, or other materials, for sorcery. The Mugojiwha refers to the incident where countless people died due to Emperor Wu of Han's intervention in the prince succession issue using Mugo. In conclusion, it is said that Seohak, which emphasizes only the transcendent Heaven without the immanent Heaven, will, like Mugo, lead to empty results.

"The movement of a person's limbs, this too is Gwisin;"

"The mind's workings between good and evil, this too is Giun (energy/spirit);"

⁵⁰¹ Kim Sang-jun, "Becoming Yangban Across the Nation: The Mechanism of Confucian Egalitarianism in the Late Joseon Period," *Sahoe-wa Yeoksa* (gu Hanguk Sahoe-sa Hakhoe Nonmunjip) [Society and History (formerly Korean Social History Association Papers)] 63(0), 2003, pp.5-29

⁵⁰² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

"Speaking and laughing, this too is Johwa (creation-transformation)."⁵⁰³

The above excerpt shows that Gwisin as the Cheonoecheon is an entity that also acts upon everyday things (Ilyongsateul) where substance is primary, thereby accommodating the Western view of Heaven as well. Furthermore, the Giun and Johwa connected after Gwisin ultimately show that Gwisin, Johwa, and Giun are the same action.

Compared to Sicheonju, Donghak's Yin-Yang view of Heaven-and-Earth (Eumyangcheonjigwan) has not received attention. Donghak Thought's Yin-Yang view of Heaven-and-Earth has been regarded as a Confucian view of Gwisin (Yugyojeok Gwisinsangwan) due to a tendency within Donghak Thought to follow the precedents of Confucianism. However, the Yin-Yang view of Heaven-and-Earth presented by Donghak Thought was a different concept from the Confucian Heaven-and-Earth-Gwisin view, in that it was a Cheonoecheon's view of Heaven-and-Earth. However, in Donghak, which lacked the concept of Sinmyeong (divine spirits), the Yin-Yang-Heaven-and-Earth view was not sufficiently explained, and it is explained concretely in Daesoon Thought, which includes the concept of Sinmyeong.

The change in the view of Heaven into a transcendent heaven—the 'heaven above heaven'—also transforms the Heaven-human relationship and the Earth-human relationship. Through these altered Heaven-human and Earth-human relationships, autogenous modernity becomes all the more pronounced. Calvin's doctrine of predestination, identified as the harbinger of Western modernity, is representative of the change in the Heaven-human relationship. The doctrine of predestination is said to have laid the cornerstone of modernity—salvation through effort rather than salvation through priests—and Weber called this the Protestant ethic that became the origin of capitalism. The Heaven-Earth and Heaven-human relationships presented by Donghak Thought negate the 'physical nature' (gijiljiseong) of the older Li-Qi theory, in which there was discrimination between yangban and the lowborn. Donghak Thought seeks to take only the strengths from among the Eastern and Western Heaven-Earth and Heaven-human relationships.

The Heaven-Earth relationship in Donghak Thought was expressed in various places as a Gwisin-ron (ghost-spirit/god theory)-based Heaven-Earth relationship. In the case of Cheonjigwisin (Heaven-Earth Ghosts-Spirits), Cheonjigwisin becomes another element that differentiates Donghak from Daoism and Seohak. Cheonjigwisin, unlike in Daoism, means Cheonju (Heavenly Lord) in Donghak Thought, and unlike in Seogyo (Western Religion), it also means immanent transcendence. First, looking at the case where it means a transcendent being, it states Gwisinjaoya (鬼神者吾也, That which is Gwisin is I), specifying Gwisin as the Cheonju, saying "Gwisin is none other than Haneullim (God)." However, this Gwisin is soon depicted as immanent transcendence in various ways. "My mind (of the Cheonju) is none other than your mind (Osimjeugyeosim)," "The mind of Heaven is none other than the mind of man

⁵⁰³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gwonji" (Authority and Foreknowledge) 1-11.

(Cheonsimjeug-insim)," "The movement of a person's hands and feet, that too is Gwisin." It is depicted as such.⁵⁰⁴⁵⁰⁵⁵⁰⁶

Traditionally in the East, it is said that Zhu Xi (朱子, 朱熹, 1130-1200) concisely summarized the principled identity of Heaven (Cheon), Gwisin (ghosts-spirits/gods), and Sangje (Supreme God). "When referring to its manifest form, it is called Heaven (Cheon); when referring to its presiding aspect, it is called Je (帝, Sangje); and when referring to its operational aspect, it is called Gwisin." It is said that even in the Ibeopcheon (Heaven as Principle) of Neo-Confucianism before the emergence of Donghak Thought, the rudiments of a view of Sangje were visible.⁵⁰⁷⁵⁰⁸

Cheonji (Heaven-and-Earth) as Gwisin in Donghak Thought, unlike Zhu Xi's Gwisin in traditional Neo-Confucianism, included the meaning of Cheonju (Heavenly Lord) in addition to the meaning of Yin and Yang. In Donghak Thought's Gwisin, the meanings of a personal god and a god of principle (Ibeopsin) appear simultaneously.

The concept of Heaven-and-Earth as Gwisin, which includes the meaning of Cheonju as it appears in Donghak Thought, provides an anti-structural property of liminality to the Cheonjonjibi (Heaven revered, Earth debased) relationship of Heaven-and-Earth. Following the Heaven-Human and Earth-Human relationships changed through Sicheonju, Sicheonju also changes the Heaven-Earth relationship through Johwa (creation-transformation/harmony). All things and all affairs (Manmulmansa), represented by Heaven and Earth, are integrated into Jigi (Ultimate Gi).

The Gwisin-ron-based Heaven-Earth relationship revitalizes the Cheonjonjibi Heaven-Earth view of Cheondoijideok (Way of Heaven, Virtue of Earth) into the traditional, equal Heaven-Earth relationship of Yin-Yang and the Five Elements. Accordingly, Suun first chose his wife as the subject of his propagation, practicing the harmonized Heaven-Earth relationship of Donghak Thought through a Jeongeumjeongyang (correct Yin, correct Yang) marital relationship, unseen in the Neo-Confucian marital relationship. Following Suun's precedent, Donghak followers made it their first practice to convert the ancient human relationships, such as those between husband and wife or father and son, which were based on the Yin-Yang relationship of Eogeumjonyang (suppressing Yin, revering Yang), into Jeongeumjeongyang relationships.

⁵⁰⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-30; Go Nam-sik, "Kang Jeungsan's Historical Consciousness and View of Joseon in the Late Joseon Period," *Dongasia Godae Hak* (East Asian Ancient Studies) 59, 2020, pp. 239-270. 259.

⁵⁰⁵ Murayama Jijun, "Mugeukdo Chwijiseo" (Manifesto of Mugeukdo), Joseon-ui Yusa Jonggyo (Pseudo-religions of Joseon). Daegu: Gyemyeong Daehakgyo Chulpanbu (Keimyung University Press). 1991.

⁵⁰⁶ Yi Dong-hui, Raipu-nitseu-ga Mannan Jungguk (China as Leibniz Encountered It), Ihaksa, 2003, pp.92-93.

⁵⁰⁷ An Jong-su, "Spinoza and Confucianism (Yuhak)," *Cheolhak Nonchong* (Philosophical Forum) 44(2), 2006, pp.172-173.

⁵⁰⁸ Yi Yeong-jae, "A Reillumination of Gongmeng (Confucian-Mencian) Philosophy through Contemporary Empathy Theory," *Jeongsin Munhwa Yeongu* (Journal of Korean Studies) 35(2), 2012, p.427.

The Gwisin-ron-based Heaven-Earth relationship manifests as the practice of Muwiyihwa (spontaneous transformation). Muwiyihwa was a new concept that simultaneously implied the Muwijayeon (spontaneous nature) based on Yin-Yang and the Five Elements, and the Western Johwa (creation) concept of the four elements. Muwiyihwa was also interpreted in Donghak to mean Naeyusillyeong Oeyugihwa (spirit dwelling within, Gi transforming without), which is a detailed expression concretizing the Johwa concept appearing in Sicheonju. If viewed from the relationship of cheonjonjibi (heaven revered, earth base), sillyeong (divine spirit) and gihwa (materialization/qi-transformation) are also in a hierarchical relationship of noble and base. By serving the Cheonju (Heavenly Lord) who is transcendent above the three realms (samgye), the hierarchical relationship transforms into an equal yin-yang relationship, which can be seen as the meaning of naeyu sillyeong oeyu gihwa (divine spirit within, materialization without). Muu-i-ihwa (effortless transformation) thus develops to signify, in Donghak thought, a state where the harmony of muu-i jayeon (effortless nature) is practiced within the mind through the internal-external relationship of sillyeong and gihwa. While muu-i jayeon was interpreted as the harmony of yin-yang and the five elements in yin-yang and five elements thought, as the yin-yang and five elements became mutually conflicting (sanggeuk), muu-i-ihwa was emphasized in Donghak thought to add the concept of liminality that transforms this conflicting relationship.

Indigenous Modernity of the Yeongsebulmang (Eternal Non-forgetting) View of Humanity (In-gwan)

The Western Developmental (成長論的) View of Humanity

In the Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which look at the world from bottom to top, Humanity, amidst the evolving Heaven and Earth, aims for growth. In the Western tradition that aims for substantiality, Humanity was an individual who focuses on salvation to ascend from Earth back to Heaven after losing paradise in Heaven due to original sin, evolving from a struggling human like Prometheus who realizes the ideals of the Idea in the material of the Earth. In the modern era where God has disappeared, Western Humanity, as a solitary existence separated from Heaven and Earth, becomes a phenomenological growth theory pursuing success alone in a differentiated world, that is, an existential human being.

Unlike Eastern Humanity, whose sense of duty to participate in the creative transformation (hwa-yuk) of Heaven and Earth within a close relationship with Heaven and Earth led to a preoccupation with anxiety (uhwan-uisik), the West prioritized an existential consciousness directly related to the Heaven-beyond-Heaven over an anxiety consciousness related to Heaven and Earth. Western original sin thought, unlike the Eastern theory of inherent evil (seongak-seol), also did not prohibit humans from instrumentally manipulating nature.

The Western growth-oriented view of humanity has been studied in mythology and psychology. In mythology, the Western growth theory has been studied focusing on individual growth, like the hero's cycle.

Scholars like Campbell sometimes interpret all world myths as hero myths. The East, unlike the West, prioritizes the growth of Heaven and Earth, namely the Cheonji-jiyong (Function of Heaven and Earth) of Cheonji-hwa-yuk (Creative Transformation of Heaven and Earth)—such as potae-yangsaeng-yokdae-gwanwang-soebyeong-sajang (conception, nourishment, bathing-girding, capping-flourishing, decline-sickness, death-burial)—even for the same growth.⁵⁰⁹ Western psychology, stating that the Western modern view of humanity has hitherto been biased towards negative views of humanity, such as psychoanalysis or behaviorism, emphasizes growth more with a growth-oriented view of humanity. Eastern psychologists evaluate that Western views of humanity, such as psychoanalysis, which sees all human desires as transformations of sexual desire, or behaviorism, which sees them as material desires, are self-affirmative views of humanity compared to the East.⁵¹⁰

The Western view of humanity is expressed concentratedly in the growth-oriented view of humanity and the recent posthumanism view of humanity, which is its reflection. The growth-oriented view of humanity is the view of humanity in existentialist psychological theory, which views human desire positively and approaches it focusing on the inner spirit, in contrast to behaviorism and psychoanalysis, which viewed human desire negatively and took a technology-oriented approach. According to the growth-oriented view of humanity, human desire is not negative, but humans simply have various needs. The growth-oriented view of humanity is a general term for theories of the view of humanity (In-gwan) that emphasize the growth aspect, assuming that human needs are latent in stages and that these needs appear developmentally from lower (下級) ones to higher ones. The growth-oriented view of humanity presented a view of humanity aiming for self-realization-based problem-solving based on the theory of inherent goodness (seongseon-seol), in contrast to the classical view of humanity aiming for technology-centered problem-solving based on the theory of inherent evil (seongak-seol). Theories of the view of humanity included in such growth theories include Maslow's (A.H. Maslow) hierarchy of needs theory, which appeared in the mid-1940s and later formed the basis of growth theory, as well as McGregor's (D. McGregor) Theory X and Theory Y, Herzberg's (F. Herzberg) two-factor theory (二要因理論), Allport's (G. W. Allport) trait theory, and Argyris's (C. Argyris) immaturity-maturity theory, presented in the 1960s.

Posthumanism is based on the 4th Industrial Revolution, and the 4th Industrial Revolution is also interpreted as the industrial revolution of the self-realization stage spoken of by the growth-oriented view

⁵⁰⁹ Lee Dong-hee, "Geundae Dogil Cheolhakja-ui Daeripjeok Bulgyo Ihae-wa Suyong" [Modern German Philosophers' Conflicting Understandings and Receptions of Buddhism], *Hegel Yeongu* [Hegel Studies] 29, 2011.

⁵¹⁰ Ju Gyeom-ji (author), Jeon Hong-seok (trans.), *Jungguk-i Mandeun Yureop-ui Geundae: Geundae Yureop-ui Jungguk* Munhwa Yeolpung (China's Creation of European Modernity: The Chinese Cultural Craze in Modern Europe), Cheonggye, 2010, p.378.

of humanity.⁵¹¹ Furthermore, it is sometimes said that existentialism is finally being achieved in the posthuman era and aligns with the future prospects spoken of by Korea's new religions.⁵¹²

The positive view of humanity presented by the growth-oriented view of humanity, in contrast to the existing seongak-seol (theory of inherent evil)-based psychological view of humanity, appears, in Maslow's case, as affirmation of desire, growth, and the world, respectively. First, in the case of desire, Maslow affirms desire by stating that the self-actualization need, which appears after all lower-level needs are met, is an individual's yearning for self-enhancement and the desire to realize everything one possesses as potential.

Second, it affirms growth. Maslow regarded the lower four needs in the hierarchy of needs—the 'lower' needs of physiology, safety, belonging, and esteem—as all being 'deficiency motives' that arise from the lack of some external condition. The operation of such deficiency motives generally follows a 'tension-reduction model.' By contrast, the highest need, the need for self-actualization, is a 'growth motive' that seeks one's own growth. This “arises from being (being) itself rather than from a state of deficiency, and pursues an increase of tension rather than a reduction of tension. Hence it is called a 'being motive,' which, by pursuing distant goals connected to the innate impulse to realize the individual's potential, enriches life by broadening experience and thereby increases the joy of living.”⁵¹³

Third, it affirms the world. Maslow criticized the psychopathological aspect of the human being emphasized by psychoanalysis—the first force in American psychology of the time—as well as the mechanistic aspect and the reductionistic, deterministic worldview emphasized by behaviorism, the second force; and he pursued self-actualization while respecting the human potentiality of the individual, grounded in the subjectivity and wholeness of the human being as an integrated being. Pursuing and understanding the truly human nature of the human being, and orienting toward a world that contributes to human growth and happiness, Maslow's psychological theory made him an idol of the young people of that time.⁵¹⁴

It is said that the positive attributes of humans asserted by Maslow are attributes very opposite to the attributes of humans that posthumans can replace. The reason posthuman is very shocking to human society is that machines have surpassed humans in calculation ability, which corresponds to instrumental reason,

⁵¹¹ Heo Jeong-hwa, "A Comparative Study of Avatamsaka (Huayan) Thought and Modern Physics," Master's thesis, Dongguk University, 2003.

⁵¹² In the book *Neijing* [Classic of Internal Medicine], traces of the thought of the Taoist, Mohist, School of Names, and Yin-Yang schools can be found — this is an undeniable fact. Xu Yiming, *Xingli yu Qihuang* (Nature, Principle, and the Yellow Emperor's Classic), China Social Sciences Press, 1997, p.23.

⁵¹³ So Byeong-seon, *Jujahak-gwa Thomism-ui Cheolhakjeok Bigyo* (A Philosophical Comparison of Zhu Xi Studies and Thomism), doctoral dissertation, Academy of Korean Studies, 2005; Bak Jeong-jin, *Cheolhak-ui Seonmul Seonmul-ui Cheolhak* (The Gift of Philosophy, The Philosophy of the Gift), Seoul: Sonamoo, 2012; Yi Jeong-u, Kim Si-cheon, Kim Gyo-bin et al., *Gihak-ui Moheom: 1, Dongseoyang Cheolhakja, Yubae-doen Gi-ui Buhwal-eul Malhada* (The Adventure of Qi Studies: 1, Eastern and Western Philosophers Speak of the Resurrection of Exiled Qi), Seoul: Deulnyeok, 2004.

⁵¹⁴ Matsumoto Kouro, "Theory of Interreligious Dialogue in Islam (The Thought of Interreligious Dialogue — Historical Aspects and Their Dialogue, Panel, Special Issue: Proceedings of the 68th Academic Conference)," *Shukyo Kenkyu* (Journal of Religious Studies) 83-4, Japanese Association for Religious Studies, 2010, pp.180-81, 1272-73.

among reason, which had been regarded as an attribute representing humans that machines could not replace. However, the more artificial intelligence was studied, the more Moravec's paradox appeared: humans have intelligence opposite to artificial intelligence, so what humans are good at, artificial intelligence is bad at, and what humans are bad at, artificial intelligence is good at.⁵¹⁵ This Moravec's paradox, through the Chinese room argument by the critical posthumanist Searle (John Searle), revealed the limitation that even artificial intelligence, which passed the Turing test and was determined to be intelligent, is difficult to regard as having human intelligence like posthumans.⁵¹⁶⁵¹⁷

In the posthuman era, humans must now focus on the intelligence that humans do better than machines for co-evolution to be possible, and the representative one among them pointed out is human growth intelligence. Coincidentally, the Eastern relationship between divine beings and humans also has the characteristic of organic humans and mechanistic divine beings. The reason humans came to have growth intelligence differently from machines is that because survival was the goal for humans for a long time, human intelligence was not artificial narrow intelligence specialized in specific parts, but had the property of artificial general intelligence, which developed slowly but evenly across all fields. Growth intelligence, which can form symbols and communities to achieve self-development, has attracted attention as an intelligence unique to humans.⁵¹⁸ Indeed, humans have made existential efforts to exist for tens of thousands of years, and in that process, they were positive beings who developed intelligence through numerous symbols that artificial intelligence cannot imitate and came to have the motive for self-realization. Humans finally came to achieve self-realization as individuals from the group.⁵¹⁹ Maslow's 4-stage growth process can be compared with the gwanwang (capping-flourishing) of Daesoon Thought and the potae (conception) of Donghak Thought.⁵²⁰

The Western growth-oriented view of humanity led modern scientific and technological development and achieved various social developments, but the dogmatic development of humans, excluding Heaven and Earth, paradoxically led humanity to the verge of annihilation due to the betrayal of Heaven and Earth. The Western view of humanity, which has loosened the reins of desire but has no way to tie them again, came to need a new alternative modernity.

⁵¹⁵ Mircea Eliade (author), Choe Jong-seong and Kim Jae-hyeon (trans.), *Segye Jonggyo Sasangsa 2: Gotama Buddaeseo-buteo Gidokgyo-ui Seungli-kkaji* (A History of Religious Ideas, Vol. 2: From Gautama Buddha to the Triumph of Christianity), Ihaksa, 2005, p.299, pp.490-491.

⁵¹⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 88. Dotong cheonji boeun (Penetrating the Way of Heaven and Earth and repaying grace).

⁵¹⁷ Daesoon Jinrihoe Yoram (Daesoon Jinrihoe Handbook), p.20.

⁵¹⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 2-36.

⁵¹⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoung" (Progress of the Order) 2-41. The utmost treasure is my own spirit-soul (simryeong). When one penetrates the spirit-soul, one can commune with spirits and demons (guishin), and one can share in the ordering of all things. (Gyomuby, "Poyumun" [Proclamation for All], Daesoon Hoebo [Daesoon Newsletter] 184, 2016)

⁵²⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-9.

The Eastern Transformative Contact (接化的) View of Humanity

Unlike the West, which emphasizes the Heaven-beyond-Heaven, the East emphasizes the role of Humanity in connecting the Heaven-within-Heaven, that is, the Heaven and Earth of the immanent Heaven, and the space between Heaven and Earth. Accordingly, the Eastern view of humanity has a grafting (jeophwa) characteristic in which correlative thinking is prominent. Regarding correlative thinking, which enables understanding of the Eastern view of humanity, follow-up research in modern philosophy has been conducted by Shim Gwang-hyeon and others since Kim Sang-il. The Eastern grafting view of humanity, due to the nature of correlative thinking, appears prominently in Korea's aesthetic characteristics among Korea, China, and Japan.⁵²¹

Shim Gwang-hyeon defined the characteristic of Korean culture as fractal, compared it in detail with Western postmodernism, and then applied it to Korean culture in general. Shim Gwang-hyeon states that the Eastern science, which says that the same structure repeats today, is expressed in a word as a fractal structure, and also says that the Hallyu (Korean Wave) receives global support because all cultures have the most fractal characteristics in the world based on Eum-Yang O-Haeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements).⁵²² The Eastern grafting view of humanity is well revealed in the fractal characteristics.⁵²³

The fractal theory, from fractal meaning a part, is the theory that the structure of the whole appears in the structure of the part, meaning that no matter how complex the universe is, like a computer, it is a repetition of the same structure, just like the repetition of 0 and 1, such as yin and yang. The Eastern Eum-Yang O-Haeng, which states that the Eum-Yang O-Haeng structure of Heaven is also in Earth and in Humanity, so if one knows the Eum-Yang O-Haeng structure of Humanity, one can know Earth and also the principles of Heaven, is a typical fractal theory. This has been expressed as ichi (principle) in the East, and the Eastern grafting view of humanity is that humans possess the ichi of Heaven and Earth simultaneously, so humans are beings who can and must participate in the creative transformation (hwa-yuk) of Heaven and Earth.

The Eastern grafting view of humanity shares the commonality with the Western growth-oriented view of humanity in that it views human abilities highly, but what is different is that in the East, Heaven and Earth are not objects on which human abilities must be realized; on the contrary, human abilities are gifts from Heaven and Earth, and humans are beings who must repay the grace to Heaven and Earth. Since the Heaven and Earth of the East were not material and form but assimilation and condensation that creatively transformed all things, the Eastern intellectual's anxiety consciousness (uhwan-uisik) that one could not match and participate in the creative transformation efforts of Heaven and Earth took precedence over the existential consciousness of individual growth.

⁵²¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 2-9.

⁵²² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-24.

⁵²³ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 2-19.

With the modernization of the West, the Eastern grafting view of humanity was dismissed as a pre-modern object of enlightenment even by Eastern intellectuals, but today it is being re-evaluated in various ways according to East-West exchange. First, the researcher who expanded the East's correlative thinking to the level of Western cognitive psychology is Choi In-cheol. Choi In-cheol, in joint research with Nisbett, cognitively and psychologically proved the correlative perception of Eastern thought, creating a field of study in this area. By them, it has also been proven through psychological experiments today that the East and West are represented by collectivism and individualism.⁵²⁴

The person who actually expanded Choi In-cheol's research to Eastern psychology is Cho Gung-ho. Cho Gung-ho showed that the Eastern cognitive system, which grasps the part from the whole, also influenced human psychological ethics, creating a system of Confucian psychology different from the West in the East, especially in Confucianism.⁵²⁵ In reality, the East has emphasized holistic moderation rather than professionalism.⁵²⁶

The researcher who expanded correlative thinking linguistically and pedagogically is Cho Ok-gu. Cho Ok-gu explains the traditional Eastern Cheonjamun (Thousand Character Classic) education, which starts learning from 'Haneul Cheon Tta Ji (Heaven Sky Earth Ground),' and the Western-style modern education, which starts learning from 'Yeonghui-ya Cheolsu-ya (Names),' as differences in Eastern and Western cognitive systems, suggesting that Eastern correlative thinking can be an alternative science to modern civilization.⁵²⁷

Existing senior scholars such as Lee O-young also joined in proposing theories of Donghak's correlative thinking against Western analytical thinking, but the person who synthesized these theories and comprehensively explained the correlative thinking system is Park Jae-ju. Park Jae-ju has comprehensively organized it, centering on Whitehead's thought.⁵²⁸

According to the East's generative thinking, which thinks from top to bottom, in correlative thinking, Humanity's position in the universe becomes an existence that grafts (jeophwa) with Heaven and Earth, as an existence possessing all the attributes of Heaven and Earth. Therefore, Heaven and Earth come to need Humanity for the mediation of Heaven and Earth, and bestow upon Humanity the most outstanding gi (energy) from Heaven and Earth.

⁵²⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 30.

⁵²⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 30.

⁵²⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 30.

⁵²⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsa" (Reordering Works) 1-30; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-30; Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 1-21.

⁵²⁸ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38.

The gi of Eum-Yang O-Haeng flows into the midst of Heaven and Earth; the outstanding becomes Humanity, and the dregs become things. Among the outstanding, the outstanding become saints and sages; among the outstanding, the dregs become foolish people and unworthy people.⁵²⁹

Humans, born from the grafting (jeophwa) of the gi (energies) of Heaven and Earth, have the duty, along with Heaven and Earth, to participate in Heaven and Earth's creative transformation (hwa-yuk) of all things. Heaven and Earth creatively transform (hwa-yuk) Humanity with Seong-Gyeong-Sin (Sincerity, Reverence, Faith), and Humanity becomes an existence that repays this with Seong-Gyeong-Sin.⁵³⁰

Only those who practice utmost Sincerity (誠) under Heaven (天下) can fully realize their own Nature (性); if they can fully realize their own Nature, they can fully realize the Nature of other people. If they can fully realize the Nature of other people, they can fully realize the Nature of things; if they can fully realize the Nature of things, they will be able to assist the Creative Transformation (化育) of Heaven and Earth (天地). If they assist the Creative Transformation of Heaven and Earth, they participate (in the Creative Transformation of Heaven and Earth) along with Heaven and Earth.⁵³¹

In the above example, the grafting (jeophwa) human is an existence that has received the gi (energies) of Heaven and Earth respectively, this is called Nature (性), and appears as an existence that returns this Nature to Heaven and Earth by fulfilling it with Sincerity (誠). Ames and Hall, who have translated Eastern thought through correlative thinking, translate the Doctrine of the Mean (Zhongyong) as 'Focusing on the Familiar,' and say that the Sincerity (誠) of Heaven and Earth, when interpreted from the Western substantial worldview, should be interpreted as the Creativity spoken of by the philosopher of postmodernity, Whitehead, in his process thought. It is said that Whitehead also commented on this.

In all philosophic theory there is an ultimate which is actual in virtue of its accidents. [...] In the philosophy of organism this ultimate is termed 'creativity.' [...] In monistic philosophies [...] this ultimate is God, who is also termed by the name 'the Absolute.' In such monistic philosophical schemes, the ultimate is unjustifiably allowed a final, 'eminent' reality that transcends every accident. From this point of view, the philosophy of organism seems much closer to the philosophical schools of India and China than to the thought of West Asia or Europe.⁵³²

When Sincerity (誠) is interpreted as creativity, Heaven and Earth's saeng-in (giving birth to humans) is also creativity, and what humans return is also creativity. In grafting (jeophwa), the concept of creativity

⁵²⁹ Daesoon Jichim (Daesoon Directives), p.18.

⁵³⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 3-44.

⁵³¹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 2-33; Go Nam-sik, "Yi Jeong Simbeop (Right Determination Mental Teaching) and the Ultimate Orientation of Cultivating the Mind," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Daesoon Thoughts) 13, 2001.

⁵³² Go Nam-sik, "The Prior Heaven (Seoncheon) View of Heaven and the Transcendence of Sangje: Regarding Sangje's Divine Way (Sindo) and the Supreme Authority over the Three Realms (Samgye Daegwon)," Daesoon Sasang Nonchong (Daesoon Thoughts) 8, 1999, pp.562-563.

becomes core. The Eastern grafting view of humanity pursued harmony with nature and did not pursue excessive development, but it became fixed in correlative thinking, entered a fixed state of forgetting the thinking before correlative thinking—that is, the Heaven-beyond-Heaven—and rejecting new things, thus failing to respond properly to Western criticism like that of Matteo Ricci. Accordingly, only after the shock from the West did the East come to seek indigenous modernity.

From the perspective of Lee Young-ran's liminality theory, following heaven (1) and earth (2, 1+2), the human (3, 1+2, 1+2+3) is a being capable of changing beyond the human into a third existence (1+2+3=1'), and this liminal aspect of changeability becomes the jeophwajeok characteristic of humans. Because humans possess the yin and yang bestowed by heaven and earth—namely the hon (spiritual soul) and baek (corporeal soul)—they can change themselves, and thus can become a ji-in (one who knows) capable of recognizing the performance of transformative nourishment (cheonji hwayuk) staged by the universe. Furthermore, humans must reach the stage of being performers themselves in the universe. In the indigenous modernity's view of humanity, which was prompted by the shock from the West, liminality prepares for the realization of the ideal view of humanity.

The Clash and Mutual Antagonism of East-West Views of Humanity in Modernity

The Clash of Views of Humanity

The Eastern and Western views of humanity already contained many problems even before the East and West interacted. As the Eastern and Western views of humanity developed independently, the shortcomings of each view of humanity also became prominent. First, in the case of earth, water, fire, and wind, as the fifth element became monotheized, the divine-being system of earth, water, fire, and wind first disappeared in the West. In the weakened earth-water-fire-wind views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, the divine beings of earth, water, fire, and wind are mistreated and ousted, and the Heaven-Humanity relationship is privatized into a contractual relationship between the monotheistic God and humans. Humanity is relegated to the status of a sinner before the monotheistic God, becoming an existence that must repent and be saved, attaining a status where they can only go to paradise after death. In the East, as correlative thinking solidified, the discrimination between yangban (nobility) and sangnom (commoners) intensified. This encountered an opportunity for change through East-West exchange.⁵³³

Like the economic law that bad money drives out good, as the East and West interact, they exchange strengths, but the shortcomings in their views of humanity become more prominent. As the East and West interact, the West's transcendent-oriented view of humanity first changes to an immanent-oriented view of humanity. The West, having learned from Matteo Ricci that an ethical human society is possible even without a transcendent God, no longer desires God's salvation, and God's place is replaced by material.

⁵³³ Hwang Tae-yeon, "Confucius's Empathetic Non-action and Worldly-ism and the East Asian Origins of Western Tolerance Thought, Part 1," *Hangukak (Korean Studies)* 36(2), 2013, pp.73-74.

The clash of Eastern and Western views of humanity occurs from the imperialist period, which arose after the West, having achieved modernity through Eastern thought, cultivated national power through the policy of *buguk gangbyeong* (rich country, strong military). As the East and West clash, the Heaven of earth, water, fire, and wind—which was originally the mediator of earth, water, fire, and wind as the fifth element—loses its attribute as an immanent god and appears as a transcendent god. To the transcendent monotheistic God, Earth is provided as an object of domination and conquest that humans can enjoy, and the East also corresponds to this.

The Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, unlike their superficial differences, also share a common origin when tracing back to antiquity. In the case of the 36 Heavens, which also appear in Daesoon Thought, they also appear in the Daoist 36 Heavens view, which is related to the common pre-Buddhist East-West origin of the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. It is said that the Daoist 36 Heavens view, which appears in the Daoist *Lingbao* (Spiritual Treasure) scriptures, is related to the Buddhist 28 Heavens view, which appears in the *Abhidharmakośa-sāstra*. The Buddhist 28 Heavens view is vertically divided into the Desire Realm (*yokgye*), Form Realm (*saekgye*), and Formless Realm (*musaekgye*), and the Daoist 36 Heavens are said to also be distinguished by the meaning of horizontal division in the four cardinal directions (East, West, South, North), but the Buddhist 28 Heavens are also said to be related to the 28 lunar mansions (constellations) of astronomy, like Daoism.⁵³⁴ The *Abhidharmakośa-sāstra*, where the Buddhist 28 Heavens first appear, is a Hinayana scripture regarded as Buddhist teaching, but the Buddhist 28 Heavens theory is considered a legacy of the Indo-European trifunctional system, which predates the establishment of Buddhism, and this is said to originate further back from common East-West astronomical thought.⁵³⁵

The trifunctional system is a theory stating that in both the myths and social organizations of the vast region spanning ancient India and Europe, where a common language was spoken, a system of classes appeared, similar to Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven-Earth-Humanity): the religious class like Heaven—Brahman; the warrior (戰士) class like Humanity—Kshatriya (Chal-lijong, 刹利種); and the producer class like Earth—the Vaishya-Shudras lineage. In fact, Dumézil, who first discovered the trifunctional system theory, investigated ancient cultures in over 50 languages and stated that the trifunctional system commonly appears in the Trojan War depicted in Greco-Roman mythology and in Hindu mythology. In fact, the Trojan War of Greek mythology is said to have been a war among Aphrodite, symbolizing production and beauty; Hera, symbolizing religion; and Athena, symbolizing politics. In India's case as well, Mitra of the

⁵³⁴ In Daesoon Thought, the mural painting of Oseon-wigi (Five Immortals Playing Baduk) symbolizing Haewon is expressed as 'ihae' (understanding/resolution). Haewon (Resolution of Grievances) becomes the natural-scientific foundation of Sangsaeng (Mutual Beneficence). (Bak Yong-cheol, "A Study on the Realization of Haewon Sangsaeng," *Daesoon Sasang Nonchong* (Daesoon Thoughts) 4, 1998, pp.213-241)

⁵³⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38; Jo Yeong-suk, "A Study on the Cosmological Ontology of Dongui Bogam [東醫寶鑑; Dongui Bogam: Principles and Practice of Eastern Medicine]," *Dogyo Munhwa Yeongu* (Journal of Taoist Cultural Studies) 33, 2010, p.141; Kim Mi-rim, "A Study on the Concept of Yangsheng (Health Cultivation) in Dongui Bogam," doctoral dissertation, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, 2009, pp.163-165.

Maitreya lineage, who also appears in Buddhism, governs religion along with Varuna, and Vajra, the god of lightning who appears in the Geumgangsan (Diamond Mountain) lineage, governs politics along with Indra.⁵³⁶ It is said that the reason the Abhidharmakośa-śāstra, which is said to be Buddhism's unique teaching, includes pre-Buddhist teachings is related to the process of Mahayana Buddhist doctrines, which conflict with Hinayana Buddhism, being accepted into Buddhism.⁵³⁷ According to Sasaki Shizuka (佐佐木 閑), who is renowned as a scientific interpreter of Buddhist scriptures, the scope of what could be accepted as Buddhist was greatly expanded through two Buddhist councils, as appears in King Ashoka's inscriptions. Therefore, Geumgangsan (Diamond Mountain), which plays a major role in the Buddhist view of the Heavenly Realm that also appears in Daesoon Thought, is structured to form a trifunctional system with Vajra, the god of lightning in ancient Indian mythology.⁵³⁸

If the Buddhist trifunctional system has a temporal vertical character, in the case of the Chinese views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, which were changed by ancient East-West exchange, the Samjae-gwan (Three Powers view) appears more prominently as the spatial arrangement of Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven-Earth-Humanity). The Daoist 36 Heavens view of the Heavenly Realm internally includes the Buddhist 28 Heavens view of the Heavenly Realm. In the case of the East Asian views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, where spatial arrangement is emphasized, the driving force of the Samjae (Three Powers) circulation also appears as the seungbu (victory/defeat or contest) between ancestors and descendants rather than the reincarnation of individual karma.⁵³⁹ Therefore, in East Asia, the views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity mythologically appear with the Gonggong-jok (Gonggong tribe), a representative civilized tribe, as the underworld civilization god, and the underworld god appears as its relic.⁵⁴⁰

In Seohak (Western Learning), Catholicism, the Euro-Indian trifunctional system is also reflected in its views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity. Zoroastrianism, often said to be the origin of the Abrahamic religions, also emphasizes the post-mortem Heavenly Realm and the Court of Judgment (Myeongbu), based on the trifunctional system originating from the god Mithra, who is the origin of Maitreya.⁵⁴¹

Although the Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, represented by the trifunctional system, and the Eastern Samjae-gwan (Three Powers view), represented by Cheon-Ji-In (Heaven-Earth-Humanity), share common points, the two views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity show differences in the method of

⁵³⁶ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Jesaeng" (Saving Lives) 43.

⁵³⁷ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Haengrok" (Acts) 5-38.

⁵³⁸ Choi, Won-hyuk, "Comparative Study on Indigenous Modernity of Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought," *Studies on Humanities and Social Sciences (SHSC)* 6(1), 2024.

⁵³⁹ Yoshiko Kamitsuka (author), Jang Won-cheol and Yi Dong-cheol (trans.), *Dogyo Sasang (Taoist Thought)*, Seoul: AK Communications, 2022, pp.116-121.

⁵⁴⁰ Jeong Jae-seo, *Sarajin Sindoul-ui Gwihwan (The Return of the Vanished Gods)*, Paju: Munhakdongne, 2022.

⁵⁴¹ Kim Yeong-deok, Heo Yong-gu, and Kim Byeong-su (authors), *Jungguk Munhaksa (History of Chinese Literature)*, Seoul: Cheongyeonsa, 1992, p.133; cited in Kim Chae-su, *Altai Munmyeongron (Theory of Altaic Civilization)*, Seoul: Bagijeong, 2013, p.691.

distinguishing the creator of the three realms from the three realms, in addition to the difference in emphasis on time and space. The Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, compared to the Eastern Samjae-gwan (Three Powers view), have the creator continuously intervening, and in Seohak (Western Learning), the gods of the Heavenly, Earthly, and Human realms even disappear, becoming a monotheistic system. On the other hand, in the Eastern Samjae-gwan (Three Powers view), the creator appears as a hidden god (Deus absconditus). Sangje (the Supreme Ruler), who appears in Donghak Thought and Daesoon Thought, simultaneously manifests the attributes of the East's hidden god and the West's monotheistic God, thus appearing as a similar part to Seohak (Western Learning) and Daoism.⁵⁴²

The common origin inherent in Eastern and Western views of humanity becomes the background for forming the view of humanity of indigenous modernity as the East and West interact. The Eastern view of humanity, buried in correlative thinking, also finds an opportunity for change through the intervention of the transcendent Heaven, and the West also finds an opportunity to re-establish the East's immanent Heaven, which it had materialized.

The Mutual Conflict (Sanggeuk-hwa) of the Heaven-Humanity (Cheon-In) and Earth-Humanity (Ji-In) Relationships

As the East and West develop individually, the Eum-Yang O-Haeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) and earth-water-fire-wind views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity become characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict) in different directions, but the two thought systems become sophisticated. In the Eum-Yang O-Haeng (Yin-Yang and Five Elements) worldview, the Heaven-Humanity relationship shifts from the personal Heaven-Humanity relationship of the Classic of Poetry (Shijing) and the Book of Documents (Shujing) to the ibeop (principle-law)-based Heaven-Humanity relationship of good-evil distinction of King Tang and King Jie; during the Warring States period, the Eum-Yang (Yin-Yang), Samjae (Three Powers), and O-Haeng (Five Elements) thoughts are theoretically combined, and later, with the introduction of Buddhism, the three realms (samgye) of the Heavenly Realm, Earthly Realm, and Human Realm, where ibeop (理法, principle-law) is substantiated, are completed in Daoism.⁵⁴³ The transcendental divine-being system completed in the Okchu Bogyeong (Precious Scripture of the Jade Pivot) also weakens, and the immanent yin-yang relationship between humans and gods fades.⁵⁴⁴

⁵⁴² Lao Siguang (勞思光, 1927-2012) states that in ancient Chinese thought, the divine (sin/shen 神) differs from that of Judaism, and that when referring to a monotheistic god (ilsin 一神) like the God of Judaism, the terms 'Cheon (天; Heaven)' or 'Je (帝; Lord), Sangje (上帝; Lord on High)' were used. Lao Siguang, *Zhongguo Zhhexueshi (Gudai Pian) [History of Chinese Philosophy (Ancient Volume)]*, trans. Jeong In-jae, Jungguk Cheolhaksa (Godae Pyeon) [History of Chinese Philosophy (Ancient Volume)], Seoul: Tamgudang, 1988, pp.44-45; cited in Kim Yeong-ho, "A Comparative Study on the Attributes of Cheon (Heaven 天) in Sigyeong (詩經; Book of Odes) and the Attributes of God (神) in Sipyeon (詩篇; Psalms)," *Wonbulgyo Sasang-gwa Jonggyo Munhwa (Won Buddhism Thought and Religious Culture)* 71, pp.201-236.

⁵⁴³ Kim Yeong-ho, "A Comparative Study on the Attributes of Cheon (Heaven 天) in Sigyeong (詩經; Book of Odes) and the Attributes of God (神) in Sipyeon (詩篇; Psalms)," *Wonbulgyo Sasang-gwa Jonggyo Munhwa (Won Buddhism Thought and Religious Culture)* 71, 2017, pp.201-236.

⁵⁴⁴ Lee Seung-jae, *A Scientific Inquiry into the Eight Trigrams*, Seoul: Miraeteo, 2016.

Looking at the Western relationship between divine beings and humans before Matteo Ricci, prior to the clash of Eastern and Western views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity, the Western relationship between divine beings and humans was a structure where there was an omniscient and omnipotent monotheistic God, the absolute God, who presided over all affairs of the universe; below him were angels who performed the monotheistic God's work only in special cases; and human souls existed in heaven and hell. The West had forgotten the Heaven-Earth divine beings (cheonji sinmyeong) who operate nature, but the East had the advantage that the existence of the forgotten divine beings was remembered. The Western monotheistic God, influenced by nomadic culture and wheat farming, was an existence that could do everything arbitrarily without specific laws, rather than presiding according to laws like the East's Sangje (Supreme Ruler), and angels, unlike the East's divine beings, were also not beings specially in charge of specific areas of unique duties. Therefore, the greatest sin of humans and angels was not the failure to perform duties in their own unique areas, as in the East, but disobedience to the arbitrarily changing commands of the monotheistic God. In the West, the authority of the monotheistic God was oppressive but firm.⁵⁴⁶

The traditional Western Heaven-Humanity relationship, which presupposes a transcendent god, is presented by Western thought, represented by Christianity. Christianity, which expressed itself in Aristotelian terms, also presents the model of the transcendent being as Aristotle's fifth element model. Aristotle's god is an existence that observes from a position transcending the circulation of earth, water, fire, and wind, like the fifth element of the earth-water-fire-wind cosmology.⁵⁴⁷

Heaven, the fifth element of earth, water, fire, and wind, which was originally the mediator of earth, water, fire, and wind as the fifth element, loses its attribute as an immanent god and appears as a transcendent god. In the case of the West, approaching the modern era, the earth-water-fire-wind cosmology retains only the character of substance and excludes the correlativity of earth, water, fire, and

⁵⁴⁵ Choe Su-bin, "The Other World as Seen from Taoism: The Taoist World View and Salvation Reflected in the World of Immortals (Sinsin 神仙) and the Dead (Saja 死者)," *Dogyo Munhwa Yeongu* (道教文化研究; Journal of Taoist Cultural Studies) 41, 2014, pp.303-350.

⁵⁴⁶ It is said that the world's views of death appear in two forms: salvation and avatar (doppelganger). (Edgar Morin [author], Kim Myeong-suk [trans.], *Ingan-gwa Jukeum* [Man and Death], Seoul: Dongmunson, 2000, pp.147-164) Max Weber also states that the religions of the world are divided into salvation religions based on other-power faith and non-salvation religions based on self-power faith. (Jeon Seong-u, "Max Weber's Theory of Confucianism: A Critical Reconstruction," *Nammyeonghak Yeongu* [Nammyeong Studies] 16, 2003, pp.310-314) Recent research argues that even within the same East Asia, the mythology of Eurasia — particularly Korean mythology represented by Maitreya and Dangun — is a Manaism of ternary differentiation as Heaven (天), Yang (陽), Fire (火), and Immortal (仙); while Chinese mythology, represented by Buddhism and Taoism, has a dual structure of Animism as Earth (地), Yin (陰), Water (水), and Way (道). (Jeon Je-hun, "A Manaistic Illumination of Ancient Korean Mythology [韓國古代神話의 manaism의 照明]," doctoral dissertation, Wonkwang University [圓光大學校], 2013, pp.11-12)

⁵⁴⁷ As symbolized by the notion of 'the virtue (deok) of Heaven's Way and Earth's Virtue (Cheondo Jideok),' traditionally in the East, the earth has been expressed through the attribute of 'virtue (deok).' Therefore, 'virtue (deok)' becomes a key element for comparing Eastern and Western views of the earth. In particular, the concept of virtue in Aristotle — who played a pivotal role in constructing the Western worldview — is an important subject of comparison with the concept of virtue in Daesoon Thought. (Ju So-yeon, *Daesoon Sasang-ui Deok Yunri Yeongu* [A Study on the Virtue Ethics of Daesoon Thought], doctoral dissertation, Daejin University, 2024.

wind. Accordingly, human arrogance also doubles in accordance with the monotheized cheonjon (Heaven revered).

Not only the Heaven-Humanity relationship but also the Earth-Humanity relationship becomes characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict). In the West, Earth was material and an object of domination, but after East-West exchange, it is now relegated to an object of manipulation, manipulated by immanent science and technology. In the case of the East, Earth's role in the Heaven-Earth relationship becomes fixed, and it is relegated to an existence that only follows Heaven's instructions.

The Heaven-Humanity relationship, regardless of East or West, was originally a sangsaeng (mutual beneficence) relationship. In the case of the West, the human world is the place where the Idea is projected, and God creates humans in His own image. In the case of the East, the Human Realm was a place for cultivation to go to a higher place in the divine-being realm. However, as the Heaven-Humanity relationship and Earth-Humanity relationship become characterized by sanggeuk (mutual conflict), the development of the Heavenly Realm through the Human Realm stops, and the creative transformation (hwa-yuk) of Heaven and Earth is suspended. Furthermore, chaos accelerates throughout the universe, and it enters a state of near annihilation. Accordingly, a rearrangement of the sacred and the secular, namely, the liminality aspect of modernity, is requested in the Heaven-Humanity and Earth-Humanity relationships.

Liminality in Donghak Thought's View of Humanity as Yeongsebulmang (Eternal Unforgetting)

Donghak Thought's Yeongsebulmang (Eternal Non-forgetting) View of Humanity (In-gwan)

The change in the view of Heaven (Cheon-gwan) due to the intervention of the transcendent Heaven brings about changes in the view of Earth (Ji-gwan) as well as changes in the view of Humanity (In-gwan). Just as the concept of Earth changes to the concepts of johwa (creation-transformation) and gihwa (material force transformation) due to the transcendent Heaven, and Earth's status rises, becoming equal to Heaven's status, Humanity is also elevated to an existence that can communicate the same mind with the transcendent Heaven—'Osim-jeug-Yeosim' (My Mind is Your Mind)—and Humanity's status is elevated to an existence of the same class as Heaven and Earth.

Donghak Thought's view of Humanity (In-gwan), like its view of Earth (Ji-gwan), is gradually revealed as Donghak Thought develops. As Donghak Thought develops, Su-un's attitude toward Donghak Thought changes. It continuously changes through the cheonsa-mundap (conversation with the Heavenly Master) and podeok (propagation) activities, martyrdom (sundo), and after martyrdom. Donghak Thought's view of Humanity (In-gwan) changes especially around Su-un's martyrdom.⁵⁴⁸

⁵⁴⁸ Sundo (殉道; dying for the Way) means death through the Way, just as Sungo (殉教; martyrdom) means dying for one's religion.

Although Choe Su-un, the founder of Donghak, disappeared as expected on the execution ground after daring to return to Gyeongju, which was close to suicide, the embers he scattered began to revive through the efforts of Choe Si-hyeong after countless hardships. Choe Si-hyeong revives the memories of the Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam) and the Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Eastern Scripture), which Su-un had painstakingly left behind but had all disappeared, and restores them with the help of his colleagues. The Yongdam Yusa and Donggyeong Daejeon restored by Choe Si-hyeong are distributed throughout the country, and Donghak revives in the form of the Donghak Peasant Movement. Jeungsan (Kang Il-sun) likens this to Chiyu (蚩尤) and says that the jakran (disruption/rebellion) of Donghak began.⁵⁴⁹

The Donghak Peasant Revolution Movement became an unprecedentedly large movement in the history of Korean peasant revolutions and seemed to succeed, but it brought about Japanese intervention, turning into the greatest tragic movement instead. However, the will of Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) revealed in Donghak is widely promulgated, leaving hope. The surviving Donghak followers participate again in new religions or various movements that are transformations of Donghak.⁵⁵⁰

Donghak can be said to be the earliest new religion to appear among the new religions. The influence Donghak had on new religions, based on the research of some new religions, reaches as far as the Unification Church. This is because mentions related to Donghak also appear in Won Buddhism and the Unification Church. Donghak is also the field most researched by intellectuals during the revival period of new religions since the 1980s. On the other hand, the claims of the new religions are contrary to the claims of Donghak. In the new religions after Donghak, it is generally claimed that Donghak was a prelude for the appearance of the new religions after Donghak. The claims of Donghak and the new religions after Donghak can be understood by examining the common doctrinal systems between them. Among the doctrinal systems of Donghak, the doctrinal system held in common, especially with the new religions after Donghak, is the circularity of correlative thinking.⁵⁵¹

If the influence of Donghak on the new religions after Donghak is controversial, then the influence of existing religions on Donghak becomes an issue. The relationship between Donghak's doctrinal system and existing religions is one of the main research tasks for Donghak researchers. However, although the issue of affinity between Donghak and Confucianism, Daoism, and Christianity has been much studied, it has not yet been much studied from the aspect of correlative thinking, which is the circular attribute of Donghak's doctrinal system.

Donghak, like Seondo (Way of the Immortals), formally uses talismans and recites incantations, but internally it has the system of Neo-Confucianism, such as boguk-anmin (protecting the nation and securing

⁵⁴⁹ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 3-30.

⁵⁵⁰ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Yeosi" (Prophetic Elucidations) 6.

⁵⁵¹ Kim Tak, *Hanguk Sinjonggyo-reul Gwan-tonghaneun Inyeom, Ingan Jungsimsimjuui* (The Ideology Penetrating Korean New Religions: Anthropocentrism), Seoul: Minsokwon, 2023, p.405.

peace for the people), chunghyo-yeol (loyalty, filial piety, fidelity), and Seong-Gyeong-Sin (Sincerity, Reverence, Faith). It also shares the term Cheonju (Lord of Heaven), which is the same as in Seogyo (Western Religion). Like Daesoon Jinrihoe's evaluation of Donghak, Donghak is summarized as having advocated Seondo (Way of the Immortals) but failed due to the limitations (jeonheon) of Confucianism.⁵⁵²

The circular doctrinal system of Donghak, which has been re-evaluated centered on the Donghak Society since the 1980s, is the Sam-Taegeuk (Three Supreme Ultimates) system shared not only by Donghak but also by most new religions. While Donghak, in its organized religion period, has the circulation of correlative thinking as its core doctrine, the unique views of Heaven, Earth, and Humanity appearing in Donghak's doctrinal system have not been well studied.⁵⁵³

The circularity of correlative thinking, which has been highly evaluated in Donghak so far, was the part of the egalitarianism of the Donghak Peasant Movement, which is an external circulation, rather than an internal evaluation of the doctrinal system. Donghak claims that the circulation appearing in the new religions after Donghak is the influence of Donghak, but since it shares the Sam-Taegeuk (Three Supreme Ultimates) tradition that appears in common with Donghak, it is difficult to see the correlative thinking that appears very diversely after Donghak as the influence of Donghak.⁵⁵⁴

It is said that the Buryeon-giyeon (Not so, yet so), which appears at the very end of the Donggyeong Daejeon (Great Eastern Scripture), corresponds to the change in human status and the proof of God's existence in Donghak when viewed in the overall context of the Donggyeong Daejeon. The Donggyeong Daejeon focuses on emphasizing the thought of Sangje (the Supreme Ruler) who gave the revelation to Choe Su-un, rather than Choe Su-un's thought. In fact, in the Dowon Giseo (Record of the Origins of the Way), which Haewol (Choe Si-hyeong) wrote about his conversations with Su-un, it is recorded that Su-un had continuously received teachings from Sangje, and after Sangje's teachings ceased, he foresaw his own death and was very anxious.

⁵⁵² Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyoun" (Progress of the Order) 1-9.

⁵⁵³ Choe Min-ja, "Donghak Viewed from the Perspectives of Eastern and Western Thought: Ken Wilber's Holarchic Holism and the Integrated Vision Found in Su-un's Si (侍; Serving/Enshrining)," *Donghak Hakbo* (Journal of Donghak Studies) 23, 2011.

⁵⁵⁴ It is said that 'mosim' (enshrining/serving) carries the meaning of equality from a practical standpoint. The idea is that all Donghak practitioners, through inner cultivation such as reciting incantations (jumun) and prayer, should devotedly serve the Cheonju (Lord of Heaven) enshrined within themselves, and also keep in mind that others whom they encounter in daily life are likewise beings who each enshrine the Cheonju within their own interior — and treat them as the Lord of Heaven (Haeunym). The following passage, frequently cited by Donghak scholars when emphasizing that Donghak's Haeunym is also an inner being of humanity, in fact contains both of these meanings: 'Do not believe in me; believe in the Haeunym. Since [the Haeunym] is enshrined in your body, should one abandon what is near and seek what is far (Sagunchwiwon [捨近取遠])?' (Yongdam Yusa [Songs of Yongdam], 'Gyohunka' [Song of Instruction]) The phrase 'enshrined in your body' signifies ontologically that a person is already a being who has enshrined the Haeunym; while 'Do not believe in me; believe in the Haeunym' signifies, from a practical standpoint, a view of equality — that the act of 'enshrining' (mosim) must occur in both inner and outer directions. ("The Direction of Confucian Reform, View of Equality, and Attitude toward Western Modern Civilization in Choe Je-u and Bak Eun-sik," *Toegye Studies and Confucian Culture* [退溪學과 儒教文化] 49, 2011, p.328)

Donghak after Choe Su-un also shows discontinuity with Choe Su-un's Donghak. Within the Donggyeong Daejeon or Yongdam Yusa, the early period and the later period are also sometimes evaluated differently. As there is discontinuity even within Donghak, it can be seen that Donghak and other new religions are very distant.

Lee Kang-oh's data on new religions focuses mainly on the mergers and divisions of religious orders, paying attention to the commonality of doctrinal systems rather than the differences. The reason Donghak sees the new religions after Donghak as the influence of Donghak is that the figures who believed in the new religions after Donghak were mainly Donghak party members. Donghak party members are active in Southern Buddhism, Won Buddhism, etc., after the failure of Donghak.

The Donghak doctrinal basis for Donghak's claim that the new religions after Donghak are the influence of Donghak is that Donghak also synthesized the three religions of Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism. However, there is little Buddhist influence in Donghak, and although it recites incantations and uses talismans, it also does not emphasize the world of divine beings, including ancestral spirits (seonryeongsin), in which respect it still largely does not deviate from the confines of Confucianism.⁵⁵⁵

It can be said that Donghak's emphasis on the circulation of correlative thinking came after the March 1st Movement in 1919, when Donghak reorganized its theoretical system as new religions emerged after Donghak. Due to Japan's policy of suppressing religions without a doctrinal system, Donghak, centered around Lee Don-hwa, set out to establish a doctrinal system.⁵⁵⁶

The Liminality Aspect of the View of Humanity in 'Never Forgetting through Eternal Ages' (Yeongsebulmang 永世不忘)

The aspect of the Donghak view of humanity, whose status was elevated by the transcendent heaven (choweolcheon), appears differently through its early and later periods. In the early angelic Q&A (cheonsamundap), the elevation of human status to a position capable of "serving the Heavenly Lord" (Si-Cheonju) was due to Su-un's arduous efforts.

Just as the Jeon-gyeong (Daesoon scriptures) mentions that those who participated in the Donghak Peasant Movement outwardly advocated boguk-anmin (protecting the nation and securing peace for the

⁵⁵⁵ There is also research that connects Donghak's Buryeon Giryeon (非然其然; The Not-So but Yet So) with Buddhism and links it to Buddhism in the sense that Choe Su-un always conducted his activities centered on hermitage temples (amja). (Bak Gyeong-hwan, "Donghak and Buddhist Thought," Donghak-gwa Jeontongsasang [Donghak and Traditional Thought], Mosineun Saramdeul, 2004)

⁵⁵⁶ Today there is a movement to understand Donghak as a principle of circulation, centered on the theory of Kim Yong-ok — who claims the original name of Donghak was Mugeukdaedo — and the theory of Sangyunron (distribution/spreading principle), etc. Kim Ji-ha regards Buryeon Giryeon, Yulryeo, etc., as principles of circulation within complex systems. Kim Ji-ha states: 'The core symbol of Chinese historical thinking or the Book of Changes (Juyeok) centered on Heaven and Yang or the Cosmos is the Supreme Ultimate (Taeguk), which advances into Yin-Yang, Four Symbols (Sasang), and Eight Trigrams (Palgwe) — stable numbers, i.e., the order of the Cosmos. On the other hand, Gungung is 1·3·5·7·9 — dynamic numbers. The inherent meaning of our nation and the numerical order of 1·3·5·7·9 consisting of the three poles (Samgeuk) of Heaven-Earth-Human is precisely Chaos.' (Kim Ji-ha, Yegam-e Gaadeukhan Soop-geuneul [The Forest Shade Full of Foreboding], Silcheon Munhaksa, 1999, p.35)

people) but inwardly harbored ambitions of becoming "kings, nobles, generals, and ministers" (wanghu-jangsang), anyone in difficult circumstances is prone to materialism, but Su-un, like Jesus, rejects even heaven's proposals. For Su-un, who had endured all sorts of hardships for over 40 years, the temptation of material wealth was ineffective, much like it was for Lü Dongbin. After continuous tests and Su-un's fasting protest, Sangje reveals the elevation of human status to Su-un, stating, "My mind is your mind" (osim jeuk yeosim).

However, in the end, even in the later period, Su-un fails to fully grasp the meaning of "my mind is your mind." Even though human status was elevated to a position capable of serving Sangje through Si-Cheonju, Su-un fails to fully understand its meaning, unable to overcome the precedents (jeonheon) of Confucianism. Su-un resolves human problems through buryeon (not so) and giyeon (so it is). "What is difficult to understand is Buryeon (not-so), and what is easy to understand is Giyeon (so-it-is)." If Giyeon is the world that can be understood and experienced by human reason, Buryeon is the world that cannot be understood or experienced by human reason. In that case, Buryeon corresponds to Ri (Principle), Do (Dao), Ilsim (One Mind), and Cheon (Heaven). However, what is important here is that Buryeon and Giyeon are not dichotomous opposites. 'Osim-jeuk-Yeosim' (My mind is your mind) is understood to the extent that one can reach the ultimate reality through experience, just as one realizes the truth beyond experience through experience and gains enlightenment from the things before us. While Buryeon-Giyeon is sometimes understood by Donghak scholars as an excellent epistemology, it was an understanding somewhat distant when compared to Daesoon Thought's Dotong-Jin'gyeong (attaining the True State of Unification with the Dao).⁵⁵⁷

The Donghak view of humanity as Yeongse-bulmang (eternal remembrance) differed from Seohak (Western Learning) in two major ways. First and foremost is the abolition of discrimination between priests and believers. Donghak thought criticizes the strict distinction between priests and believers in Western Learning. Donghak thought highly valued the fact that Western Learning viewed humans more equally compared to Confucianism, Buddhism, or Daoism, but it strongly criticized the class-like difference between priests and believers. A prominent feature of Donghak's Yeongse-bulmang view of humanity, in terms of the history of religious thought on humanity, is that it did not distinguish between priests and believers within the scope of "Si-cheonju" (Bearing God). Consequently, in Donghak thought, the distinction between believer and priest disappears, much like in the non-church movement (Mugyohoeju) of figures like Ham Seok-heon today. This becomes the significance of the Jeopju (regional leader) system, a characteristic of the Donghak view of humanity. If the Western Reformation abolished the privileges of the Catholic priest, Donghak thought abolished even the privileges of the Protestant minister.

⁵⁵⁷ Yi Do-heum, "The Possibilities and Limits of Eastern Philosophy as Post-Modern Thought," *Donghak Hakbo* (Journal of Donghak Studies) 10, 2005, p.22.

The second characteristic of the Yeongse-bulmang view of humanity, distinguishing it from Western Learning, is the difference between "Gakja-wisim" (each acting for oneself) and "Gakji-buri" (each knowing and not moving). Whereas Western Learning primarily emphasized the superficial religious characteristic of Cheonju (the Lord of Heaven) as an external being, Donghak's Si-cheonju strongly exhibits the characteristic of a deep religion where Cheonju is internal. Therefore, the method of practice also, in the case of Western Learning, as Weber pointed out, manifests as a form of faith in "Gakja-wisim," where the proof of salvation is worldly success, as in Calvinism. This became the foundation of Western modernity. However, in Donghak thought, since the proof of salvation lies within, it resides in "Gakji-buri," a moral practice of spontaneously implementing internal, reflective ethics.

If the characteristics of the Donghak view of humanity, contrasted with Western Learning, appear as the abolition of discrimination between priests and believers and an emphasis on reflective ethics rather than secular success, then the characteristic of the Donghak view of humanity, contrasted with Confucianism, Buddhism, and Daoism, appears as an emphasis on the microcosmic human being. In later Donghak, this is expanded to the term "In-nae-cheon" (Man is Heaven), but in early Donghak, the view of humanity is strictly that of a human being within Heaven and Earth. However, through Si-cheonju, the human being becomes an existence capable of participating in the Cheonji-hwayuk (transformation and nourishment of Heaven and Earth) according to Cheonju's Muwi-ihwa (spontaneous transformation) through the practice of "Naeyu-sinryeong Oeyu-gihwa" (having divine spirit within and energetic transformation without).

The difference in the views of humanity between Donghak thought and Daesoon Thought arose from the difference in whether the scope of "Naeyu-sinryeong Oeyu-gihwa" could be expanded to "In-nae-cheon." Donghak thought, which later developed into Cheondogyo, expanded the scope of "Naeyu-sinryeong Oeyu-gihwa" to "In-nae-cheon." Consequently, Daesoon Thought, which defines humans merely as beings participating in Cheonji-hwayuk, is sometimes criticized as a pre-modern ideology. The view of humanity in early Donghak thought is actually developed more concretely in Daesoon Thought.⁵⁵⁸

The Donghak view of humanity is expanded into the term "earthly paradise" (Jisang-cheonguk), which manifests when the Si-cheonju-practicing humans of Donghak gather. In later Donghak, "earthly immortal" (Jisang-sinseon) is understood not as a result of the interaction between the human realm and the earthly realm as seen in early Donghak, but as a person who has attained the enlightenment of Si-cheonju. The term "earthly paradise" built by the gathering of "earthly immortals," while in early Donghak it implied a rise in the status of the earth due to the change in the status of heaven and earth from Cheonjon-jibi (heaven

⁵⁵⁸ It is said that the central doctrine of 19th-century Donghak was Siecheonju (侍天主; Enshrining the Lord of Heaven), i.e., enshrining the Haeunym (Lord of Heaven). However, when Donghak was renamed Cheondogyo and organizational restructuring took place, the core doctrine shifted to Innaecheon (人乃天; Humanity is Heaven), and the personality (ingyeokseong) of Cheon (Heaven 天) is said to have greatly weakened. (Hwang Jong-won, "The East-West Philosophical Convergence Characteristics and Life-Philosophy Significance of Yi Don-hwa's Cosmology and View of Humanity: Focusing on 'Sinin Cheolhak' [New-Human Philosophy]," *Yuhak Yeongu* (儒學研究; Confucian Studies) 36, 2016, p.590)

revered, earth base) to Cheonjon-jijon (heaven revered, earth revered) through their mutual interaction, is depicted in later Donghak as a world of indigenous modernity built by the gathering of Si-cheonju-practicing humans. The concept of the earthly paradise in early Donghak is, rather, reinterpreted in Daesoon Thought.

The transcendent Heaven (Chowol-cheon) of Donghak thought, revitalized from the immanent Heaven (Naejae-cheon) of Eastern thought, brought about great changes not only to the view of earth (Jigwan) as Muwi-ihwa but also to the view of humanity. The human being in Donghak thought is elevated to an existence that communicates directly with the transcendent Heaven. Consequently, the sacred-secular relationship was reorganized, and the common people sometimes interpreted this as a rise in status that allowed them to become "kings, marquises, generals, and ministers" (Wanghu-jangsang). As indicated by the expressions "earthly paradise" and "earthly immortal," the initial intention of Donghak was to overcome the traditional limitations (Jeonheon) of Confucianism, but that intention was not fully realized. The Donghak view of humanity repositioned the sacred-secular relationship and provided the motivation for the common people to participate in the liminality of modernity, thereby laying the groundwork for indigenous modernity.

Liminality Aspects in the Cheon-In (Heaven-Human) Relationship of Naeyu-sinryeong (Having Divine Spirit Within) in Donghak Thought

While much research regards Si-cheonju and Gaebyeok (Great Opening) as the core characteristics of Donghak thought, research on "Jhwa" (Harmony/Creation), which connects the two concepts, is rare. Jhwa, the result of Si-cheonju, has been variously interpreted in Donghak thought as Gihwa (energetic transformation) and Jigi (utmost energy). Although the concept of Jigi is new, if it is considered within the extension of the concept of "Gi" (energy), the most characteristic concept that distinguishes Donghak thought from existing Western Learning or Neo-Confucianism is "Jhwa," and it can be said that Naeyu-sinryeong is this Jhwa applied to the human interior, while Gihwa is it applied to the exterior of individual daily affairs. This Jhwa manifests as Sinryeong (divine spirit) in the Heaven-human relationship, and as Gihwa, Muwi-ihwa, and Jhwa (Creation) in the Earth-human relationship.

In Donghak thought, which emphasizes the Heaven above Heaven, the view of earth is also transformed by the Gihwa action of Sangje (the Supreme God); therefore, the relationship between Heaven and humanity is transformed into a relationship of Naeyu-sinryeong.

The "Jhwa" of Si-cheonju manifests as Naeyu-sinryeong, overcoming the Sinjon-inbi (God revered, human base) relationship of Western Learning's monotheistic Heaven-human view. Unlike the strictly separated monotheistic God of Western Learning, the Sangje of Si-cheonju revives the state of Cheonin-habil (union of Heaven and human), which had been discarded, as seen in 'Osim-jeuk-Yeosim'. Although the Heaven above Heaven intervened in Donghak thought, unlike in Western religion, it also included the concept of Cheonji (Heaven and Earth) as the Heaven within Heaven, allowing even ordinary believers to

connect with the Heaven above Heaven through their minds. Thus, Donghak communicated with the Heaven above Heaven, but unlike Western religion, it resulted in a Heaven-human relationship without hierarchy between priests and believers, which consequently also changed the relationship between society and the individual.

In Donghak thought, there was no discrimination based on the Gi endowed by Heaven between yangban (aristocrats) and sangnom (commoners) as in Neo-Confucianism, nor was there a difference between priests and believers as in Western religion; the status of humanity was elevated to an existence where believers, too, could have the same mind as the Heaven above Heaven. Accordingly, the liminality aspect of indigenous modernity, where the boundary between the sacred and the secular is repositioned, is achieved in the Heaven-human and Earth-human relationships of Donghak thought.

Liminality Aspects in the Ji-In (Earth-Human) Relationship of Oeyu-gihwa (Having Energetic Transformation Without) in Donghak Thought

The concept of "Jhwa" (Harmony/Creation) was also a key characteristic of nature at the time of Donghak thought, but Neo-Confucianism primarily emphasized the characteristic of human society called Beomjeol (norms and etiquette) and did not emphasize the characteristics appearing in the Jhwa of nature. Compared to Beomjeol, which is the orderly change in human society, the Jhwa of nature is a concept related to the creativity that gives birth to new life; Joseon society at the time of Donghak overflowed with Beomjeol, but the culture that could foster Jhwa and creativity was suppressed by Confucianism.

It was not only Neo-Confucianism that suppressed Jhwa, which means creation and evolution; in the eyes of the traditional Joseon people of the time, Western Learning was the same. The suppression by the monotheistic God of Western Learning, which dismissed ancestral rites as superstition and maintained a strict hierarchy between priests and believers, approached as an authoritarianism that surpassed Neo-Confucianism. Thus, society faced a situation requiring a new anti-structure and needed a new ideology to harmonize this.⁵⁵⁹

Jhwa (Harmony/Creation) was always a process of resolving the contradictory problems of opposing elements. Like the harmony of Yin and Yang or the harmony of the new and the old, Jhwa always presupposes opposing elements. In the anthropology of religion, the concept closest to Jhwa is that of liminality. Derived from the word 'Limen,' meaning threshold or boundary, liminality was the word meaning the boundary point of opposing elements commonly appearing in most rites of passage studied by the anthropologist Van Gennep. For example, a rite of passage like a wedding ceremony includes rites such as a honeymoon or Dongsangnye (groom-handling ritual), which are periods of anti-structural deviation between the time before marriage and after marriage. Indeed, on the main gate where daily rites of passage always occur, there was Janus with two faces in the West, and the Taegeuk (Supreme Ultimate) in the East.

⁵⁵⁹ Yun Seung-yong, "A Brief Study on the Anti-Structure (Communitas) Character of New Religions (新宗教)," Master's thesis, Seoul National University (서울대학교), 1982.

The Taegeuk and Janus signified the allowance of deviation at the boundary point—that is, Jhwa (Harmony).

The fact that Si-cheonju came to mean Jhwa (Harmony/Creation), or liminality, was largely due to the Heaven-human relationship of Sinjon-inbi (God revered, human base), where Sangguk (mutual conflict/overcoming) was maximized at the time. At that time, the common people (Sangmin) were considered beings full of turbid Gi from the Neo-Confucian perspective and sinners from the Western Learning perspective, but through Si-cheonju, they were provided the liminality to "bear" Sangje.

The change in the Heaven-human relationship that began with Si-cheonju—that is, the liminal Heaven-human relationship—expanded throughout society, centering on Donghak. Consequently, the relationship between earth and people—that is, the relationship between the earth-based society and humans—changed. It is said that Donghak was early on referred to not by "believing" but by "doing," manifesting as the practice of anti-structural actions of the communitas, the anti-structural society brought about by liminality. As creativity and "Jhwa," which were scarcely respected during the Neo-Confucian Joseon Dynasty, came to be respected, the treatment of women and children, the most oppressed groups in the Joseon era, began to be "opened" (Gaebyeok).

The rise in the status of earth and humanity, brought about by the change in the view of Heaven due to the intervention of the transcendent Heaven in Donghak thought, caused an anti-structural aspect of liminality to appear in the traditional Earth-human relationship. In Neo-Confucianism, if the yangban, endowed with the clear Gi of Heaven and Earth, guarded the realm of the sacred (聖), the common people (baekseong), endowed with the turbid Gi, were positioned in the realm of the secular (俗); however, a change occurred with the elevation of human status. Now, the common people also secured the religious justification to become "kings, marquises, generals, and ministers," leading to an indigenous repositioning of the sacred-secular.

Looking closely at the Earth-human relationship, compared to Heaven, which resembles the nature of Hon (spirit-soul) and can move freely, the attributes of Earth—which resembles the nature of Baek (body-soul), has form, and is heavy in nature—meant that even in the East, as seen in Eogeum-jonyang (suppressing Yin, venerating Yang) and Yangjon-eumbi (Yang revered, Yin base), Earth was an existence that approached humans as confinement. As in the term Cheonmun-jiri (astronomy and geography), Earth in the East was an existence that restricted daily life for humans with material laws, much like the Ibeop (principles) of natural science. In the West, of course, Earth was the place to which humans were banished from the Garden of Eden, and in Buddhism too, Earth was a hotbed of suffering.

The Jhwa (Harmony/Creation) emphasized by Donghak thought also brought change to the traditional relationship between Earth and humans. Because Donghak's Si-cheonju "bears" Heaven, it opened a new Heaven, and through "Dasi Gaebyeok" (Again, Great Opening), Donghak thought created a new Earth-human relationship.

Donghak thought seeks to change the role of Earth, which was forbidden in the past, through the Jhwa of Si-cheonju. In Donghak thought, the Earth-human relationship cycles into the Ho-sijeol (Good Times) that follows the Ha-won-gap (Last 60-year cycle). The Earth-human relationship is represented by Ingeol-eun-jiryung (great personages are spiritual energy of the earth), and eminent sages and virtuous scholars (Myeonghyeon-dalsa) convert to become Donghak believers.⁵⁶⁰⁵⁶¹

In Donghak thought, Earth, through Dasi Gaebyeok, becomes a place that can be an earthly paradise and where one can become an earthly immortal. On the earth "opened" by Donghak—the Eastern Learning, where the principles of the earth are different—Donghak thought also gains the strength to overcome Western Learning. Donghak grants Korea the strength to overcome the West, in place of China which was defeated by the West, giving birth to a new nation. The power of the East, manifested in Donghak thought, enables the overcoming of the "vicious Western enemy" that invaded China, through the oath of Daebodan (Altar of Great Gratitude).⁵⁶²

The change in the Heaven-human and Earth-human relationships also brings about a change in the perception of human status in society. As seen in the interrogation of Jeon Myeong-suk, the catalyst for the Donghak Peasant Movement aligns with the project of "the whole country becoming yangban." This appears in the Jeon-gyeong as follows.⁵⁶³

Because Jeon Myeong-suk, when he rose up, held the intention to make sangnom into yangban and to make the lowly (cheonin) noble, he fared well after death and became a judge in the Myeongbu (Realm of Judgment) of Joseon.⁵⁶⁴

Donghak thought further possessed an egalitarian ideology that made the participants of the Donghak Peasant Movement dream of gaining office, aiming for all citizens to become officials. However, the participants' latent desire to become "kings, marquises, generals, and ministers" was still inherent, making Donghak thought an incomplete state of Yoksok-budal (more haste, less speed) for realizing an earthly paradise. It is said that the image of Koreans in the eyes of foreigners at the time was one of having lost the will to work. In a situation where their harvest was taken even if they worked, the path to becoming "kings, marquises, generals, and ministers" was the most realistic. In fact, the Jeon-gyeong states that the reason

⁵⁶⁰ Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam), "Mongjung Noso Mundapga" (Song of Dialogue Between Old and Young in a Dream).

⁵⁶¹ Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam), "Yongdamga" (Song of Yongdam).

⁵⁶² 'Let us swear at the Daebodang altar and avenge the enmity of Korea (Han),' Yongdam Yusa (Songs of Yongdam), "Ansimga" (Song of Solace). Here, the Daebodang refers to the altar first established during the reign of King Sukjong in 1705, in honor of the benevolence of the Ming Emperor Wanli who sent troops to rescue Korea during the Japanese Invasions (Imjinwaeran); it was later renamed Hwangudan (Circular Mound Altar).

⁵⁶³ Kim Sang-jun, "Becoming Yangban Across the Nation: The Mechanism of Confucian Egalitarianism in the Late Joseon Period," *Sahoe-wa Yeoksa* (gu Hanguk Sahoe-sa Hakhoe Nonmunjip) [Society and History (formerly Korean Social History Association Papers)] 63(0), 2003, pp.5-29.

⁵⁶⁴ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gyobeop" (Dharma) 1-2.

many Donghak participants actually joined was to pursue becoming "kings, marquises, generals, and ministers."

Upon entering the twelfth month, Sangje completed various Gongsas (Works) and embarked on the Gongsas to adjust the Yeokdo (degrees of rebellion/adversity). Gyeong-seok, Gwang-chan, and Nae-seong left for Daeheung-ri; Won-il left for Shin Gyeong-won's house; and Hyeong-ryeol and Ja-hyeon left for Donggok. Sangje spoke to the remaining Mun Gong-sin, Hwang Eung-jong, and Shin Gyeong-su, saying, "Gyeong-seok's Seong (Sincerity), Gyeong (Reverence), and Sin (Trust) are so profound that I considered using him differently, but since this is a matter he himself requests, it cannot be helped," and added, "Originally, Donghak's advocacy for Boguk-anmin (protecting the nation and securing peace for the people) was merely a cry for the work of the Later World, but their hearts each desired to become 'kings, marquises, generals, and ministers,' and tens of thousands were dragged away and killed without achieving their desire. Their grievances soared to the heavens, and if those divine beings were left as they are, the governance of the Later World would fall into adversity (Yeokdo) and become chaotic; therefore, I was in the process of appointing a leader for the Haewon (resolution of grievances) of those divine beings, and Gyeong-seok's mention of twelve empires (十二帝國) means he has volunteered for it. His father was a high-ranking leader in Donghak and was captured and killed, and he himself also served as a Donghak Chongdae (representative leader), so from now on, I have attached all the Donghak divine beings to Gyeong-seok; from this seat, the Haewon of the 'kings, marquises, generals, and ministers' shall begin," He said, writing on a piece of paper, forbidding outsiders from entering, and saying, "Watch in the days to come. The expenditure of money will greatly increase, and the number of people will also be greater than in the Gabo year (1894). They must be set free so that there will be no hindrance in the Later World," He concluded.⁵⁶⁵

The passage above shows that most of the people who took part in Donghak outwardly cried out 'supporting the nation and comforting the people' (boguk-anmin) while inwardly scheming to become kings, marquises, generals, and ministers (wanghu-jangsang). The Earth-human relationship of Donghak Thought, which has the character of 'outward qi-transformation' (oeyu-gihwa), expanded in various directions.

⁵⁶⁵ Jeongyeong (The Canonical Scripture), "Gongsas" (Reordering Works) 2-19.